

SATURDAY, AUGUST 1, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 24 PAGES

₹7.00 (₹8 RAIPUR, ₹15 SRINAGAR) • www.indianexpress.com

DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

Happening today

● **PM NARENDRA MODI** will inaugurate the Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport in Andhra Pradesh's Vizianagaram district. He is also expected to lay the foundation and dedicate projects worth Rs 18,000 crore.

TRACK THIS AND MORE ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

THE BIG PICTURE



CHENNAI'S CHESS MATES: INSIDE CLUBS THAT SHAPE GMS **P13**

ATTACK ON BRICK KILN WORKERS IN KULGAM; L-G, POLITICAL PARTIES CONDEMN

Terror targets migrant workers in Valley, one killed, another critical

Second attack in July, comes after months of a lull since Pahalgam

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, July 31

TWO MEN from Chhattisgarh working in a brick kiln in South Kashmir were shot from point-blank range Friday, the second terror attack in the Valley in July. One of them died in the attack, while the other is critical. According to J&K Police Inspector General V K Birdi, the



Security personnel conduct search operations after the attack in J&K's Kulgam, Friday. PTI

attack took place in the village of Kilam in Kulgam district. The deceased, Deepak, and the injured man, Bhupender, both

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Pak crackdown on PoK protests kills 40, India flags 'ruthless' use of force

Divya A
New Delhi, July 31

THE ONGOING crackdown by the Pakistani establishment in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir has resulted in the death of 40 civilians and injuries to many, India said Friday, calling upon the international community to scrutinise Islamabad's "ruthless" use of force against peaceful protesters and hold it accountable for the "atrocities" being committed there.

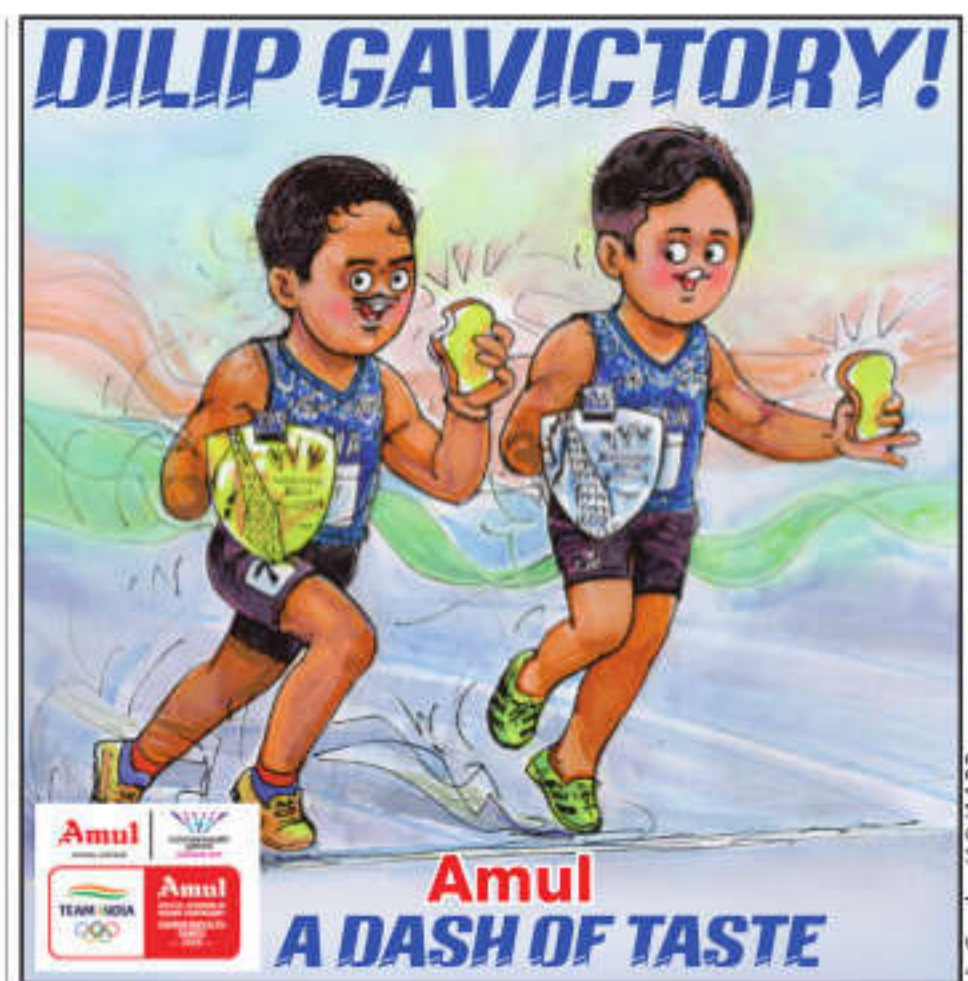
Responding to a question on the situation in PoK during a media briefing, Randhir Jaiswal, spokesperson for the Ministry of External Affairs, said, "As you have yourself witnessed, the Pakistani establishment continues to unleash ruthless force against peaceful civilians in PoJK. This crackdown has resulted in the tragic death of over 40 civilians and serious injuries to many." He called the rigged elections there a rejection of the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

E. EXPLAINED

Why anger in PoK

Protesters say Islamabad has disproportionate control over the PoK Assembly. The ruling party in Pakistan usually wins the PoK elections — Pakistan People's Party in 2011, Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz in 2016 and Imran Khan's Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf in 2021.



daCunha/AB/1123

2020 NORTHEAST DELHI RIOTS

Former AAP leader awarded life sentence over IB man's killing

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 31

SENTENCING FORMER Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) councillor Tahir Hussain and four others to life imprisonment for the murder of Intelligence Bureau (IB) staffer Ankit Sharma during the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots, a Delhi court said Sharma's "body was dragged like an animal" and the crime "was committed with utmost brutality".

The court, however, rejected the police plea seeking the death penalty for the convicts, saying it was a "last resort".



Former AAP councillor Tahir Hussain at Delhi's Karkardooma Court on Friday. ANI

Additional Sessions Judge (ASJ) Praveen Singh of Karkardooma Court stated in the order, »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

PM: I forgive children who abused me, let's show them the way

Children are ours... instead of punishing them, dragging them through courts, society should guide them, says Modi

Jatin Anand & Alok Singh
New Delhi, July 31

AMID POLICE notices and FIRs over derogatory social media posts about him during the student protests in Delhi, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said Friday he wanted to forgive all those children who had abused not only him but also his late mother.

In a video message late at night, Modi said punishing them or making them "run around courts" was not going to change the circumstances. "I want to forgive them, and society too should accept this."

He sought to reassure the nation's youth that he believed in them in spite of the abuses hurled at him and said "mistakes happen in childhood", but these mistakes also lay the foundation for learning.

"Some *shararat* (mischievous) children gave vulgar abuses and used words that do



PM Narendra Modi put out a video message late Friday

not behave any civilised society. Not just me, my departed mother was also abused. One does not know the extent of this. But I want to say today that mistakes happen in childhood but it (childhood) also provides the opportunity for change. This is what childhood is about."

He said he can understand the "aakrosh" (outcry) in society. "It is a cultural shock. How can our daughters speak like this?"

He, however, said it was time to embrace these children

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Taslima in Kolkata after 19 yrs

EXILED BANGLADESHI author Taslima Nasrin arrived in Kolkata, Friday, her first visit to the city nearly two decades after she was forced to leave following protests against her work. She is set to take part in a public event on Saturday.

Taslima Nasrin at the airport in Kolkata, Friday. PARTHA PAUL
REPORT, PAGE 10

Suvendu aide murder: CBI arrests 2 BJP men, TMC past under lens

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, July 31

IN WHAT is likely to raise a political storm in West Bengal, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested two BJP workers, who were earlier with the Trinamool Congress, in connection with the murder of Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari's aide Chandranath Rath. CBI sources said the investi-

gation has revealed that the two accused arrested now had allegedly hired the shooters who killed Rath.

Rath was shot dead in Madhyamgram near Kolkata on May 6, shortly after the BJP swept the Assembly polls in Bengal, defeating the Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress, which had been in power in Bengal since 2011.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Hotels are replacing Udaipur hills, policy framed by pvt agencies: HC

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, July 31

WHILE SLAMMING the Rajasthan government over the extent of the construction in the Aravalli Hills surrounding Udaipur, the Rajasthan High Court has said that its 2018 Hill Policy seemed to be authored by "certain private agencies".

Expressing alarm over the hills being pushed to "the verge of extinction", the High Court sought names of authors of the



Glaringly evident that hills and mountains have been brutally cut, says bench. FILE

state's Hill Policy of 2018 and 2024, as well as the names and

designations of the top officers who had granted permissions for construction and commercial activities.

The court ironically was hearing the petition by a hotelier, Basant Hotels Private Ltd, that it had already attained due permissions under the 2018 policy, and that the provisions of the Hill Policy 2024 should not be applied to it.

A Bench of Justice Sameer Jain said last week — the order

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

INSIDE



FAMILIES OF COPS INJURED IN CJP PROTESTS SEEK DAY IN COURT **PAGE 4**

JAISHANKAR TO ARAGHCHI: DON'T ATTACK MERCHANT VESSELS **PAGE 6**

● **TIRKEY, A FORMER INDIA CAPTAIN, WRITES TO EXECUTIVE BOARD ON JERSEY COLOUR CHANGE**

Who took the call and why, asks Hockey India chief as jersey blue turns saffron

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, July 31

A FORTNIGHT before the FIH Hockey World Cup gets underway in Belgium and the Netherlands, a row is brewing in India over the decision to change the national team's traditional blue jersey to saffron.

On Friday, Hockey India president Dilip Tirkey shot off two separate emails to senior office-bearers and Executive Board members, seeking an explanation over the decision to change the

jersey colour.

In the emails, Tirkey, a former India captain, said the decision had been implemented without being placed before the Executive Board or brought to his notice, and directed officials to provide a detailed account of how it was approved.

The development comes a day after *The Indian Express* reported that the jersey change had been made without consulting the players, with several members of the Indian team learning about the new design only after it was pres-



Hockey India president and former India captain Dilip Tirkey

ented to them earlier this week. In the first email, sent

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

WHICH GIRL IS IMPRESSED WITH JACK?

SCAN TO KNOW MORE

IT'S SWEET. IT'S SALTY.

Follow @wearekrackjack

Like our video

Drop a one-word comment

And stand a chance to win Amazon vouchers*.

*Conditions Apply

INDUSTRIES CITE RISING COSTS LINKED TO THE WEST ASIA CRISIS, SUPPLY CHAIN DELAYS

91% of industries in NCR fail to comply with emission norms, get 2 more months

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, July 31

MORE THAN 2,100 large or medium industrial units across Delhi-NCR, around 91% of such units across the region, have failed to comply with stricter particulate matter (PM) emission norms, including installation or retrofitting of air pollution control devices (APCDs), which were to come into force from August 1, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

This prompted the Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas (CAQM) on Thursday to defer the deadline by two months — until October 1 — after industries cited rising costs linked to the West Asia crisis, supply chain delays and shortage of technical agencies to assess existing systems.

200-odd units comply

Of the 2,321 industrial units identified for installation or retrofitting of APCDs, only around 200 had complied by July 31. The figure also included those pending verification, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The remaining 2,121 or 91.4% units had not complied with the order, officials said.

Industrial emissions in NCR are a precursor to secondary particulate matter, which, at 27%, has been identified as a major cause of winter pollution, followed by direct industrial emissions at 9%, according to CAQM records.

Air pollution control devices are industrial filtration systems installed on exhaust stacks to capture emissions. The primary technology used include Baghouses, which use fabric filters to trap over 99% of dust; Electrostatic Precipitators, which utilise high voltage electricity to collect charged particles from massive exhaust volumes; Cyclone Separators, affordable pre-filters that use centrifugal force to spin out coarse ash and Scrubbers, which wash out fine dust and toxic gases using liquid sprays or powders.

New deadline

The CAQM, through an amendment on Thursday postponed the implementation of the revised PM emission standard of 50 mg/Nm³ from August 1 to Oc-

INDUSTRIAL EMISSIONS AT A GLANCE

SOURCES

Furnaces, boilers, metal casting, refining operations, coal combustion, dry fly ash ponds, the burning of heavy oils

MAJOR CHALLENGES

A large number of unorganised units including plastic recycling and small-scale manufacturing operating in unauthorised or peripheral areas
Illegal burning of non-hazardous industrial waste along with fugitive emissions.

AIR QUALITY EXPERT panel set up



by CAQM in a February report stated that small-scale units utilise small boilers and furnaces and called for a transition to cleaner fuels

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

tober 1 for the identified industries. It said the decision followed recommendations of the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) and representations from industries and associations.

The commission had identified 17 categories of high-polluting industries —including food processing units, textiles with boilers and metal furnaces, among others — ordering them to cap PM emissions at 50 mg/Nm³, down from the

previous 80 mg/Nm³.

While large or medium plants had to comply by this limit — based on CPCB and Indian Institute of Technology (IIT)-Kanpur studies — by August, smaller units had to follow suit by October.

The CAQM said that the revised emission limit remains "technically feasible and environmentally necessary", and acknowledged that industries had faced practical constraints in meeting the deadline.

Challenges cited

Among the challenges flagged by industry associations was the prevailing geopolitical situation, which they said had imposed an additional financial burden on them.

Sources familiar with the discussions said manufacturers referred to disruptions arising from the ongoing West Asia crisis, which has increased costs and affected the procurement of components needed for pollution control equipment. According to the order, industries cited long delay in the supply of air pollution control devices, limited availability of agencies to carry out technical adequacy assessments of existing systems, and a shortage of laboratories recognised under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986, to verify compliance with the revised emission standards. These factors had slowed installation, retrofitting and certification of across the region.

While industry associations had sought an extension ranging from three months to one pollution season, the CPCB recommended extending the timeline until October 1, said officials.



1 lakh saplings planted in a day

Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu led the Delhi Development Authority's mega plantation drive, in which over one lakh native trees and shrubs were planted across 77 locations in the Capital on Thursday. [X/@LTGOVDELHI](#)

2020 Northeast Delhi riots: HC seeks police reply on Umar Khalid's bail plea

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, July 31

THE DELHI High Court Friday issued notice to the prosecution on a plea by former JNU student leader Umar Khalid, who is seeking interim as well as regular bail in the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots 'larger conspiracy case'.

Umar, represented by senior advocate Trideep Pais, sought interim bail on the same ground on which two co-accused — Tasleem Ahmad and Abdul Khalid Saifi — were granted six months' interim bail by the SC in May, after another bench questioned the approach adopted in an earlier bail ruling in January. AHC division bench of Justices Prathiba Singh and



Umar Khalid. FILE

Vikas Mahajan will hear Umar's bail plea on August 27, along with the regular bail plea by co-accused activist Sharjeel Imam.

Umar's bail pleas were rejected twice by the Delhi HC earlier -- in October 2022 and September 2025. Both times, the Supreme Court had upheld the Delhi HC's order. In its January

5 order, the SC refused bail to Umar and Sharjeel, while granting bail to five other co-accused in the case, and establishing the "hierarchy of participation". In this hierarchy, Umar and Sharjeel were classified to be on a "higher footing" compared to the other five. But in a judgment in May, another bench had differed from the January judgment and expressed "serious reservations".

Granting relief to Ahmad and Saifi, the court had observed that the CJJ should constitute a bench to "settle the correct approach to bail under special statutes where Article 21 (right to life and personal liberty), prolonged incarceration, and statutory restrictions intersect".

Delhi CM distributes cycles to over 3,000 Class 9 girls of govt schools

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 31

CHIEF MINISTER Rekha Gupta launched the government's 'Vidya Vahini' scheme on Friday, distributing free bicycles to more than 3,000 Class IX girl students of government schools, officials said.

As per officials, around 1,40,000 girl students of government schools in Delhi are set to receive free bicycles under the scheme, which will be rolled out in phases. Speaking at the event on Friday, Gupta

said the scheme would ensure safe and convenient travel to school, save students' time, improve attendance, and reduce dropout rates among girls.

"Education is the strongest foundation for empowerment," she said, adding that when a girl is educated, she not only gains knowledge but also develops confidence to make informed decisions.

Education Minister Ashish Sood said the scheme was translating the Centre's vision of women-led development "into reality."

Registration and Document Download Begins : 01.08.2026, 10:00 AM

Last date for submission of Catalogue, Processing Fee & EMD by bidder: 20.08.2026, 06:00 PM

Last date for Final Online Documents Submission : 21.08.2026, 06:00 PM

Online E-Bidding Starts : 25.08.2026, 10:00 AM to 01:00 PM

Industrial Plots are also available for allotment on 'Nivesh Mitra Portal'

Note : For registration & Other details please visit Auction Portal <https://upsida.project247.in>

For Information regarding the registration & e-auction process -

HELPLINE NO: Vasu Patel-9510974587 (Monday to Friday 10:00 AM to 7:00 PM and 1st & 3rd Saturday 10:00 AM to 6:00 PM)

CONTACT ON EMAIL: eauction@upsida.co.in vasu.patel@procure247.com

MEGA E-AUCTION

GOLDEN OPPORTUNITY TO GET PLOT IN INDUSTRIAL AREA

Allotment through E-Auction

INDUSTRIAL PLOTS

•AMETHI •BANDA •JHANSI •HAPUR •JALAUH •ETAH •HARDOL •MATHURA •FATEHPUR •VARANASI •HAMIRPUR •MAINPURI •SAHARANPUR BARABANKI •MUZAFAR NAGAR

FLATTED FACTORY - SURAJPUR

WAREHOUSING PLOTS : BARABANKI, PRAYAGRAJ

COMMERCIAL PLOTS

MULTIPLEX: Prayagraj

WORKING WOMEN HOSTEL: TGC-Unnao

CLUB: TGC-Unnao, TDS City-Ghaziabad

OFFICE/BPO: TGC-Unnao

SCHOOL: Hardol, TGC-Unnao, Barabanki, TDS City-Ghaziabad

GROUP HOUSING: Barabanki, Hamirpur, TGC-Unnao, Prayagraj, TDS City-Ghaziabad

HOTEL: TGC-Unnao, Prayagraj

PETROL PUMP/CNG FILLING STATION CUM SERVICE CENTRE: Prayagraj, TGC-Unnao

WORKSHOP/SERVICE STATION: Amethi

HOSPITAL/NURSING HOME/DISPENSARY: Prayagraj, TGC-Unnao, TDS City-Ghaziabad

COMMUNITY CENTRE: TGC-Unnao

WEIGH BRIDGE: TGC-Unnao

BANQUET HALL/ MULTIPURPOSE HALL-2 (BARATGHAR): TGC-Unnao, TDS City Ghaziabad

SHOPPING CENTRE: Hamirpur, Hapur

Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Authority

UPSIDA Complex A 1/4 Lakhnapur, Kanpur-208024

Introducing the Kia Syros EV.

Superior beyond belief.

Price starts at ₹ 13 49 900*

Peace of mind with Lifetime Warranty* on High Voltage Battery

Assured Buyback Program Introductory resale-value* up to 80% after 3 years

Flexible ownership BaaS starts at ₹ 7.99 lakh & battery EMI at ₹ 3.3k/m**

Kia Syros EV

Superior beyond belief

Superior isn't one extraordinary feature. It's everything working in your favour. From best-in-segment range with a choice of two battery packs - 51.4 kWh (526 km) or 42 kWh (443 km), to charging speed and power, the Kia Syros EV is engineered to inspire confidence. Advanced Level 2 ADAS** and 25 robust standard safety features add reassurance to every drive, while Kia Connect 2.0* with 95+ connected car features keeps you connected and in control, and an extensive ownership package brings you lasting peace of mind. An EV this compelling almost defies belief.

All-round superiority

BEST-IN-CLASS

76.20 cm (30") Wide Trinity Panoramic Display Panel

V2L - Vehicle-to-Load* (Internal)

Kia Connect 2.0* with Over-the-Air (OTA) Software Updates

Rear Seat Recline and Slide Function with Seat Ventilation (Seat only)

Digital Key* with Auto Flush Door Handles

Dual Pane Panoramic Sunroof

Kia Service

Connected • Adaptive • Responsive • Engage

274+ EV Ready Kia Workshops within your reach

Warranty** 3 Years Unlimited km Warranty. Extendable up to 5 Years*

My Convenience e-Plus Program** for Extended Warranty, RSA & scheduled maintenance

24x7 | 3 Years Nationwide RSA*

K-Charge*

20 000+ charging points nationwide

23 leading CPOs Charge Point Operators (CPOs) integrated

Fast EV Charging network spanning across India

Book now

Call 1800 108 5005

093195 91407

Visit www.kia.com

Kia Syros EV

Look for "Kia India" @

Scan to know more

*Terms & Conditions Apply. V2L (Vehicle-to-load), ADAS Level 2 & Digital Key is available in X-Line only. Class refers to segment which is defined as vehicle with length between 3 990 mm - 3 999 mm and height - 1 670 mm. Charger is not a part of the standard fitment and is available for purchase separately as an accessory. Features and specifications as shown may not be part of standard fitment and may vary. The colors shown are subject to availability and may not be available across all variants and may differ slightly from those shown in this ad. The specifications and features may vary depending on models/ variants. Kia India Pvt. Ltd. (Formerly known as Kia Motors India Private Limited) reserves the right to make any changes with respect to the trims, colors, specifications, Kia Connect features and other details of any model as mentioned in this print ad or to discontinue any model without prior notice. Kia India Pvt. Ltd. urges you to follow traffic rules, these are meant to keep you safe on roads. We do not endorse vandalism or illegal activities related to road safety. Safety is a top priority, and we urge responsible behavior regarding traffic regulations and road safety. For more details visit your local Kia dealership. For detailed T&C on Syros EV, please visit URL

For Information Contact: **DELHI:** Frontier Kia: Safdarjung, Ph: 9873943152, Jayanti Motors: Lajpat Nagar, Ph: 7290070428; Mathura Road, Ph: 9167068714 **Automotive Kia:** Dwarka, Sector 20, Ph: 9953800193; Rajapuri, Ph: 7289022062 **Ritu Kia:** Mayapuri, Ph: 7419798999; Moti Nagar, Ph: 7419595999 **Speedingo Kia:** Gokulpuri, Ph: 9555289289; Patparganj Industrial Area, Ph: 9555125125; Dilshad Garden, Ph: 955170170 **Zedex Kia:** MB Road, Saket, Ph: 9899415800 **Malwa Kia:** Narela, Ph: 7496961800 **Shuban Sai Kia:** Vikaspuri, Ph: 9218039120, **Allied Kia:** Connaught Place, Ph: 08047363017; Karol Bagh, Ph: 08045888886; **Sparsh Kia:** Moti Nagar, Ph: 7428380700 **Lohia Kia:** Peeragarhi, Ph: 8929300642; Wazirpur, Ph: 8929247777 **GURGAON:** Frontier Kia: MG Road, Ph: 09654264367; Golf Course Road, Ph: 9205080960 **DAP Kia:** Golf Course Extn Road, Ph: 8800185551 **Dhingra Kia:** Old Gurgaon, Ph: 8745900045 **Allied Kia:** Sohna Road, Ph: 9899486666 **MANESAR:** Harish Kia: Ph: 7056662703 **SOHNA:** Dhingra Kia: Sohna, Ph: 8929600045 **FARIDABAD:** Dhingra Kia: Badhkal Chowk, Ph: 8743900045 **NOIDA:** Allied Kia: Sector 6, Ph: 9899476666, **Lohia Kia:** Sec-63 Noida, Ph: 8929300525 **Jayanti Kia:** Salarpur, Sec-49, Khadar, Noida, Ph: 8929119911, **GREATER NOIDA:** NRL Kia: B-1 Surajpur, Ph: 8929484657, **GHAZIABAD:** ASB Kia: Ghaziabad, Ph: 7042540551 | Ph: 8505815555 **SAHIBABAD:** Ph: 8505935555, Pandav Nagar, Ph: 7042540555

epaper.indianexpress.com

NUMBER OF ELECTORS DECLINE BY NEARLY 30%

Gurgaon SIR draft roll out, 1 in 3 names missing

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, July 31

NEARLY ONE in three voters recorded in Gurgaon two months ago is missing from the district's draft electoral rolls published on Friday under the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR), with the electorate shrinking by around 30% — from 15,55,034 on June 1 to 11,01,955.

The draft rolls show that 4,53,468 voters were excluded after their enumeration forms could not be collected or were categorised as Absent, Shifted, Dead and Duplicate (ASDD). Also, there were 2,17,080 electors with data anomalies as well

as 19,206 unmapped voters across the district's 1,504 polling stations.

"The names of both my husband and I are missing, while my son's is there," said Kusum Sharma, a resident of Suncity township off Golf Course Road.

The revised electorate comprises 5,73,404 male voters, 5,28,521 female voters, 30 third gender voters and 5,791 service electors.

The SIR exercise, ordered by the Election Commission on May 14, is being carried out across 16 states and three Union Territories. Field enumeration in Haryana began on June 15 to include all eligible citizens who turned 18 on or before July 1,

2026, and also remove ineligible entries.

Among Gurgaon's four Assembly constituencies, Badshahpur recorded the steepest decline, with its electorate falling from 5,41,895 on June 1 to 3,66,017 across 518 polling stations. As per data, there were 68,893 voters with anomalies and 6,433 unmapped voters in the constituency.

In Gurgaon Assembly constituency, the electorate dropped from 4,50,200 to 2,71,210 across 435 polling stations. It also saw 51,869 anomaly entries and 5,706 unmapped voters.

Sohna, meanwhile, saw its voter count decline from 3,03,243 to 2,45,335 across 292

• NUMBER GAME

11,01,955

TOTAL ELECTORS IN DRAFT ROLLS AS ON JULY 31

15,55,034

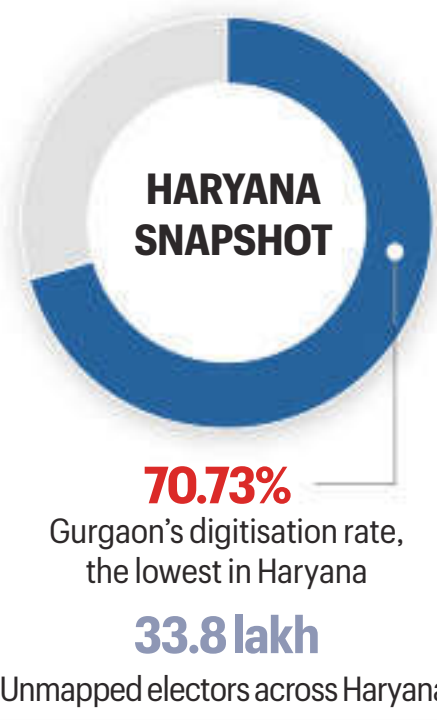
ELECTORS ON JUNE 1

4,53,079

NEARLY 30% DECLINE IN ELECTORATE

4,53,468

ENUMERATION FORMS UNCOLLECTED/ASDD



Among the four Assembly constituencies, Badshahpur recorded the steepest decline

polling stations. The data flagged 57,507 anomaly entries and 3,490 unmapped voters.

In Pataudi, the number of voters decreased from 2,59,696 on June 1 to 2,19,393 across 259 polling stations. It also recorded 39,052 voter anomalies and 3,577 unmapped electors.

The District Election Office said notices would be issued to

all 2,17,080 voters with anomalies and 19,206 unmapped electors, who will have to appear before election officials with supporting documents on scheduled dates.

Due to the large-scale exclusions, election officials urged residents to verify their names on the draft rolls through their Booth Level Officers (BLOs) or on the CEO Haryana website.

A district administration spokesperson said, "A month-long window for filing claims and objections has been opened from July 31 to August 30. Citizens whose names are missing or who failed to submit enumeration forms before July 24 can apply for inclusion by

submitting Form 6 along with a declaration form. Form 7 can be submitted for raising objections or requesting deletions, while Form 8 is designated for corrections or address modifications. Submissions can be processed offline through BLO or online via ECI Net and the voters portal."

Across Gurgaon and Faridabad, over 9.7 lakh voters were classified as "uncollectable" during the exercise. According to the data, Gurgaon recorded Haryana's lowest digitisation rate at 70.73%. Of its 15.5 lakh registered voters, 10.9 lakh enumeration forms were digitised, while 4.55 lakh were categorised as uncollectable.

• Skywatch



Forecast: August 1, 2026

Generally cloudy sky, spell

of very light to light rain

MAX: 33-35

0.6°C above normal

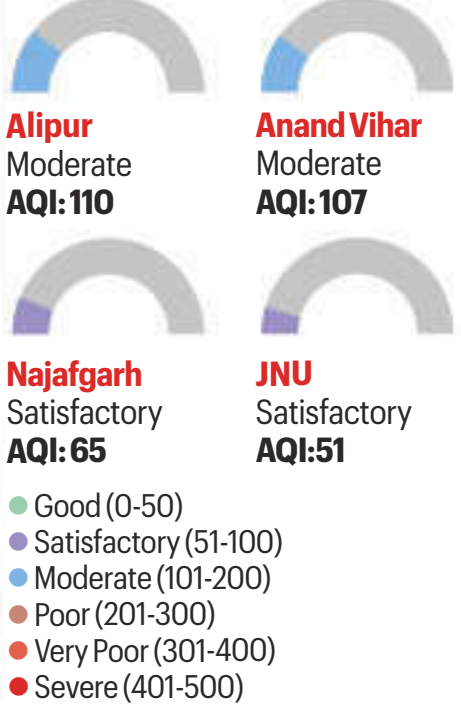
MIN: 24-26

3.1°C above normal

• Sunrise: 5:43 AM (August 2)

• Sunset: 7:12 PM (August 1)

• AQI Tracker



Delhi HC seeks speedy proceedings in BPCL plea on suspension of unit held by retd judge

Sohini Ghosh

New Delhi, July 31

A DIVISION bench of the Delhi High Court on Friday urged a single-judge bench to ensure a faster resolution on an appeal by the Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) as the oil and gas public sector unit (PSU) sought the removal of a stay on the suspension of a disputed distributorship in the Capital. The request came even as the HC refused to entertain the appeal by the BPCL regarding the unit, which was under the proprietorship of retired High Court judge Siddharth Mridul.

He was appointed as an additional judge at the Delhi HC in 2008 and retired as the Chief Justice of Manipur High Court in November 2024. In 1995, while he was a practicing advocate, he was granted LPG distributorship M/s Kitchen Flame. He continued to be its sole proprietor until at least May 2025. According to BPCL, continuing as proprietor — even during his tenure as a judge — was a breach of agreement.

On Friday, BPCL approached a division bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia, appealing against the two HC orders of July 13 and July 20 by a single-judge bench. While seeking that the two orders be set aside, BPCL also sought that the interim stay order be vacated on its suspension of supplies to the distributorship over alleged violation of the agreement.

The division bench observed that BPCL is pursuing "parallel

proceedings". "In our opinion, such a course is not available to (BPCL)," the bench recorded, refusing to issue any directions on the appeal.

While reserving the liberty of all parties to approach the appropriate forum, the division bench recorded in its order, "We however request the single judge to expedite the proceedings on (BPCL's) application seeking vacation of stay."

The single-judge bench of Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma is expected to hear the matter on August 28.

The distributorship's day-to-day operations were being run by a man identified Deepak Yadav, who has died, according to his wife Monika Yadav. She first approached the HC in April, seeking that she be granted the proprietorship. The court, however, disposed of her plea with a direction to BPCL to take a decision. Following the suspension of the distributorship by BPCL amid complaints regarding Mridul, Yadav again moved the HC with a contempt petition. BPCL submitted it passed a recent order rejecting her application.

On July 13, a single-judge bench of Justice Harish Vaidyanathan Shankar, while issuing notice on Yadav's petition to both BPCL and Mridul, stayed the operation of the suspension order.

BPCL, on July 17, moved an application, seeking vacation of the interim stay. On July 20, Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma of the High Court only issued notice to Yadav on BPCL's plea seeking a vacation of the stay.

{ JANTAR MANTAR PROTEST }

Blood-soaked uniforms, broken helmets: Families of cops injured during clashes seek day in court



Family members of injured Delhi Police personnel speak to the media on Friday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Alok Singh

New Delhi, July 31

"BETA, IT'S nothing. These things happen in our line of duty."

That was all a Delhi Police sub-inspector told his family when he returned home on July 25, his uniform soaked in blood after the violence at Jantar Mantar during the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) protest over the NEET-UG paper leak.

His daughter, Kunjal, would only later learn that he had been attacked while on duty, remained unconscious in hospital for nearly four hours before reaching home around 10 pm.

But it was the following morning, she said, when she saw social media posts calling injured police personnel "criminals", that something changed.

"That's when we decided to approach the court," she said.

Kunjal was on Friday joined by the families of three other injured police personnel, who have decided to move court, at the Constitution Club.

All had the same story to

tell. Their family members had returned home with broken helmets and stitched heads but their account of the clashes had gone unheard.

Demanding a transparent probe, the families alleged that anti-social elements had infiltrated the protest and attacked police personnel deployed on duty during the multiple clashes that broke out between students and police last week.

The press conference came a day after the Delhi government ordered that while no action would be taken against students involved in the protest, those with criminal backgrounds would be investigated.

Kunjal said her father, who had earlier served for 15 years in the Navy as a marine commando, had repeatedly told the family that the protest had ceased to be a student movement and that anti-social elements had entered the crowd.

On July 25, she said, he was deployed at the frontline barricade at Jantar Mantar when he was attacked around 2 pm.

"He was almost lynched... He remained unconscious in the hospital for nearly four

hours and reached home only around 10 pm... The next day, I saw on social media that protesters were calling my father and other police personnel criminals and were approaching court. That's when I decided to seek justice through the courts. Later, other families also extended their support," Kunjal added.

Seema, wife of an assistant sub-inspector injured during the clashes on July 20 during CJP's 'Sansad Chalo' march, said her husband came home with a head injury and a shattered helmet.

"My husband has served in the force for 33 years... On July 20, when I called him around 11 am, he told me the crowd was huge and becoming unmanageable. I asked him to take care," she added.

Around 7 pm, she heard that he had been admitted to Lok Nayak Hospital after a blow to the head.

"He told me the mob had turned violent and that some outsiders had joined in, throwing sandals, stones and whatever they could find. When he returned home at 11 pm, I saw

his helmet was broken. Someone later told us that had he not been wearing his helmet, he would not have survived," Seema claimed.

Seema appealed to the government and parliamentary representatives to remember that police personnel have families too.

Lakshya Bisht, son of an assistant commissioner of police (ACP), said he received a photograph of his father with a part of his head shaved and four stitches after he was injured while trying to shield senior officers from stone-pelting on July 25.

"Around 2 pm, a friend called to tell me my father had been injured... I was terrified."

"My father said rowdy and disruptive elements had exploited the protest and tried to create mayhem. The stone-pelting began suddenly while he was briefing his staff. He tried to shield his seniors but was attacked," Lakshya said.

Upneet Kaur, whose husband is also an ACP, said he was injured on July 20. "He returned home with a head injury that night."

12 RAF among 16 CRPF units to be withdrawn from Delhi Police duties

Express News Service

New Delhi, July 31

SIXTEEN COMPANIES of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), including 12 of its Rapid Action Force (RAF), were on Friday ordered to be withdrawn from Delhi Police duties with immediate effect, days after RAF came under scrutiny over the use of pellet guns against protesters during the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) march to Parliament on July 20.

The order, issued by the DCP (1st Battalion) of Delhi Armed Police, follows a Ministry of Home Affairs direction dated July 30. It said that the companies, identified by CRPF authorities, may be "relieved/de-inducted" from Delhi Police deployment from July 31.

The communication also asked for necessary directions to be issued at the earliest regarding the deployment of relieving or substitute forces in the city.

The order comes amid scrutiny of the RAF's handling of the crowd during the July 20 protest.

The Indian Express had earlier reported that an internal review by the RAF flagged serious operational lapses during the march, with Inspector General (RAF) Seema Dhundhia allegedly telling personnel that the "force gradient" adopted that day was not in accordance with prescribed standards or RAF

training. In policing, a force gradient refers to different levels of force that police may use depending on the threat or resistance they face.

The observation came after an internal review flagged serious operational lapses when protesters were marching towards the Parliament, with at least three persons receiving pellet gun injuries.

The CRPF later went on to order an inquiry into the sequence of events.

Around 150 Central Armed Police Force (CAPF) companies, each comprising around 100 personnel, had been deployed across Central Delhi during the CJP protest, with several companies airlifted from Chhattisgarh and West Bengal.

CRPF Director General Gyanendra Pratap Singh had on Monday backed his personnel acting in the "bona fide discharge of their duties".

"As the Director General of CRPF, I want to assure each one of you that whether it is an operational battalion or a law and order unit, whatever decisions you take and whatever actions you carry out in the bona fide discharge of your duties, I take responsibility for all those decisions and actions," he had said at the force's investiture ceremony.

A specialised unit of CRPF, RAF was raised in 1992 to deal with riots and other public disturbances.



Connaught Place during Sansad Chalo march on July 20. FILE

• NCLT APPROVES Rs 300-CRORE RESOLUTION PLAN FOR THE LONG-DELAYED ANSAL FERNHILL PROJECT

'15-yr mental ordeal': 600 Gurgaon homebuyers win legal battle for dream homes

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, July 31

IN 2011, IT professional Narender Yadav had booked his flat at the 'Ansal Fernhill' group housing project in Gurgaon's Sector 91, hoping to get his dream home within six-seven years.

He, however, found himself fighting legal battles just to get construction restarted. "Half my working life has gone into this," Narender said. "I was in my 30s when I booked the flat and would tell my children we would soon have a place of our own. Instead, it has been an emotional and mental ordeal for our family."

Now, more than 15 years later, there is finally some reason to cheer for homebuyers like Narender.

In a significant relief for around 600-odd buyers, the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on July 2 approved a Rs 300-crore resolution plan for the long-delayed Ansal Fernhill project. Work is set to resume from next week. The Tribunal, in a subsequent order on July 24, categorically rejected claims of co-developer Samyak Projects Private Limited, ordering it to hand over peaceful possession of the site and stop obstructing the resolution process.

It also slammed Samyak's persistent legal challenges and

attempts to stall the proceedings as "vexatious" and "a sort of juggle with the process", and gave its final seal of approval to the resolution plan propounded by Successful Resolution Applicant (SRA) Krish Infrastructure Private Limited (KIPL).

The verdicts mark the culmination of a tortuous journey for buyers who poured their life savings into the project between 2011 and 2013, only to see construction grind to a halt amid alleged financial siphoning, corporate misconduct and bitter inter-promoter feuds.

Maresh Jain, homebuyer and chairperson of the Fernhill Homebuyers Welfare Association, called it a big win. "Earlier



The 14,412-acre project in Gurgaon's Sector 19 offered 712 flats across 14 towers, 28 villas, and 9 shops. EXPRESS

this week, police accompanied us to the site and served notices to Samyak's guards to hand over possession, which they are expected to do on Monday morning

(August 3). This is a major victory for homebuyers who booked their flats in 2011 after being promised possession by 2018." Initially promoted by

Ansal Properties & Infrastructure Limited, the 14,412-acre project in Mewka village offered 712 flats across 14 towers, 28 villas, and 9 shops. Buyers had collectively paid over Rs 274 crore under a tripartite Builder-Buyer Agreement involving them, Ansal, and the then landowner, Samyak. Two of the towers are 95% complete, and these are expected to be allotted first.

Under the approved resolution plan, the Fernhill Project will be de-merged into a fresh corporate entity fully taken over and managed by Krish Infrastructure. The NCLT ordered that the moratorium under Section 14 of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) shall

cease immediately, clearing decks for construction to resume.

In its July 24 order, the Tribunal tightened the construction schedule across all phases compared to what the SRA originally proposed:

■ **Phase I (Towers A, B, C, D, N, P & shops):** Possession to be offered within 10 months from the Real Estate Regulatory Authority's (RERA) implementation date, advanced by two months from the SRA's proposed 12-month timeline.

■ **Phase II (Towers E, F, I & M):** Possession to be offered within 24 months from the RERA implementation date. This brings forward the delivery

for Towers E & F by 6 months.

■ **Phase III (Towers G, H, J, K & villas):** Possession to be offered within 34 months (plus a 6-month grace period) from the RERA implementation date. This shaves off eight months off the base 42-month proposal.

The Tribunal directed that allottees who had obtained refund decrees from consumer courts or H-RERA will no longer be forced to accept a cash payout. Instead, they can either receive a refund of their principal amount with interest or choose unit allotment at par with other buyers. It also ruled homebuyers cannot be burdened with any insolvency cost beyond a capped Rs 4 crore.



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली



प्रतिमाह

**दिल्ली की जरूरतमंद बहनों के लिए
आत्मनिर्भरता की नई शुरुआत**



योजना की पात्रता, आवश्यक
दस्तावेज़ एवं आवेदन प्रक्रिया की
विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए
QR स्कैन करें

महिला एवं बाल विकास विभाग, राष्ट्रीय राजधानी क्षेत्र, दिल्ली सरकार



Not on Same Page

ALL DOESN'T seem well between newly appointed AICC in-charge for Uttar Pradesh Rajendra Pal Gautam and state unit president Ajay Rai. Recently, Rai and Gautam visited Mohammad Ali Jauhar University in Rampur, which has been facing a demolition threat, on the same day. However, the two did not come face to face as Gautam reached the campus a little late and Rai left without waiting for him. Party insiders say Gautam has been lobbying for a new state unit chief and also wants changes in AICC secretaries for UP, and this has not gone down well with Rai and his supporters.

Exit & Entry

THE LAST day of the month in government offices is often earmarked for the farewell of officials who are moving to another department or retiring. July 31, however, was slightly different in the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, which was recently bifurcated into two departments. The ministry held a 'farewell-cum-welcome event' where it bid adieu to senior officials who have been transferred and welcomed the newly appointed secretary of the Department of Urban Development, Satendra Singh, it is learnt.

'Misled House': Venugopal moves privilege motion against Jitendra Singh

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 31

CONGRESS LEADER K C Venugopal moved a privilege motion against Union Minister Jitendra Singh Friday over his remark that no firing took place when student-protesters' Parliament march on July 20. Venugopal alleged that the minister has deliberately provided incorrect information and misled the House. "LoP Rahul Gandhi met a pellet gun victim in front of the media... there are countless media reports documenting victims of such firing and hospital records have also emerged of victims suffering from injuries from such firing," Venugopal said. "The government cannot get away with such obvious falsehoods in Parliament. There should be action against the minister," he said. Venugopal said the statement was made Wednesday at 3pm, when Singh was replying to the discussion on what the government has said is a strengthened anti-exam paper leaks legislation. "While replying in the House, Dr Jitendra Singh categorically stated, 'Secondly, it has been repeatedly clarified that no firing took place at all, tear gas was used; so when no firing took place at all, the question of giving an order does not arise'," he said, giving an English translation of Singh's remarks.

"Contrary to the honourable minister's assertions, firing did occur," Venugopal claimed, "and the injured person is still under medication, with data available in public domain. By falsely claiming on floor of the House that no firing took place, the minister has knowingly and deliberately provided incorrect information and misled the House." Parliament on Thursday passed the tough anti-exam paper leak Bill.

LS CLEARS REGISTRATION OF BIRTHS & DEATHS (AMENDMENT) BILL, 2026 BY VOICE VOTE

Ruckus in both Houses as Opp keeps heat on Govt over police crackdown

You are in Emergency mood, don't want to listen to anyone: RS Chairman to Opp

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 31

AMID PROTESTS and sloganeering by Opposition MPs against police crackdown during the July 20 'Sansad Chalo' march who also demanded the presence of Union Home Minister Amit Shah, the Lok Sabha on Friday passed the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026 by a voice vote as Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju expressed displeasure over the Opposition's disruption. When Lok Sabha reconvened at 11 am, Opposition MPs raised slogans and demanded that Shah come to the House and explain the police action on protesters. Speaker Om Birla urged them to return to their seats and allow the Question Hour as many of them had trooped into the Well. However, as the ruckus continued, it was adjourned for an hour.

The House sat again at noon and MoS (Home) Nityanand

Rai moved the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026, which seeks to amend provisions of the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969, to encourage timely reporting of vital events. Opposition MPs continued to protest and amid the din, the Bill was passed without discussion. Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said, "It is unfortunate that no Opposition MP took part in the discussion ... People who sent you to Parliament will seek answers from you ... then you go out and say that Bills are being passed without discussion. You have been sent to the House for discussion, not for hungama (ruckus)." Soon after the Bill's passage, LS was adjourned for the day. The Bill seeks to make delayed registration of births and deaths more stringent by requiring an order from a judicial magistrate (first class) for registrations made more than two years after the event. In Rajya Sabha, as the Zero



Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju in LS on Friday. PTI

Hour commenced and papers were laid on the table, several Opposition MPs were on their feet demanding that LoP Mallikarjun Kharge be allowed to speak. Vice President and Chairman C P Radhakrishnan said that the Opposition was still in "Emergency mood". Radhakrishnan said he had allowed Kharge to speak previously as well though he thought the point of order was not valid. "Every time I am yielding to LoP but you are not listening to others. Is that correct? That will not strengthen democracy... You are in Emergency

mood till today, you want everybody to listen, but you don't want to listen to anyone." He later permitted Kharge to speak, but ruled that no notices under Rule 267 will be admitted after the LoP sought to raise some issues under the provision. The LoP notice under Rule 267 pertained to the alleged fund misappropriation and irregularities in land acquisition for Ram temple. Opposition MPs raised slogans against the government over alleged paper leaks, and also demanded that Shah come to the House. The Chairman, however, said, "What does the Home Minister have to do with the Zero Hour?" Opposition has been seeking a statement from the Home Minister on police action on protesters on July 20, including the use of pellet guns. Speaking in RS Thursday, Kharge questioned the use of force against students and demanded Shah's resignation. With Opposition MPs raising slogans, Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan accused them of indulging in "sadak-chhap (crass)" politics. "They just want to create drama and they don't really want to have a discussion."

Express News Service
Chandigarh, New Delhi, July 31

THE DRAFT roll of Haryana's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) published on Friday showed 16.39% deletions, the third-highest among states where the exercise has been held so far. Only Arunachal Pradesh, where the draft SIR electoral roll was published on July 21, and Uttar Pradesh, where the drive was completed in April this year, have recorded higher deletions in the draft stage at 19.09% and 18.7% respectively.

According to a statement released by the state's Chief Electoral Officer, 83.61% of the state's registered voters had submitted their enumeration forms, making it to the draft roll. The remaining 16.39% electors were marked shifted/absent/others, deceased and enrolled at multiple places, leading to their deletion from the draft roll.

Currently, the third phase of the SIR is on in 16 states and three UTs, with 10 states and three UTs having completed the exercise so far. The draft roll of Andhra Pradesh was also published Friday, showing 10.78% deletions.

Data released by the Haryana Election Department shows that "as on July 24, 2026, out of 2,06,55,929 electors, a total of 1,72,72,627 electors have submitted their Enumeration Forms, reflecting overwhelming participation during the Enumeration Phase of SIR", which is approximately 83.6% of the state's total electorate.

According to officials, "as part of the exercise, BLOs carried out door-to-door verification of registered voters across the state. The department described the campaign as one of the most comprehensive voter verification exercises in the state's history. Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Vn2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

Electoral Roll Call

In Haryana

- Enumeration Forms collected: **1.72 crore (83.61%)**
- Permanently Shifted/Absent/Others electors: **24.13 lakh (11.68%)**
- Deceased: **7.66 lakh (3.71%)**
- Enrolled at Multiple Places: **2.04 lakh (0.99%)**

SOURCE: ELECTION COMMISSION OF INDIA

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGt9mJmZg1 tion drives undertaken so far".

During the verification process, 24.13 lakh voters, representing 11.68% of the electorate, could not be traced at their registered addresses. According to the election department, many of these individuals had relocated to another city or state, had been absent for an extended period, or failed to submit their enumeration forms within the stipulated timeframe.

The exercise also revealed that 7.66 lakh voters, or 3.71% of the electorate, were deceased. In addition, 2.04 lakh voters, accounting for 0.99% of the electorate, were found to have their names registered in the electoral rolls of two or more constituencies.

Election officials said after verification of documents, such voters will be allowed to retain their registration at only one location, while duplicate entries will be removed.

The Election Department emphasised that the objective of the SIR is not merely to enroll new voters but to create a clean, reliable and up-to-date electoral roll by removing the names of deceased, migrated and duplicate voters. The revised voter list will serve as the basis for conducting the upcoming elections. The department also clarified that the exercise is a

Top 5 states in deletions at draft stage

States	Deletions
Arunachal Pradesh	19.09%
Uttar Pradesh	18.70%
Haryana	16.39%
Tamil Nadu	15.19%
Gujarat	14.50%

A claims and objections period will be held from July 31 to August 30, 2026, during which eligible citizens can submit applications along with the required documents. During this period, voters will be able to apply for inclusion of their names, request deletions or corrections, or file objections against any entry in the electoral roll. A total of 90 EROs and 1,601 AEROs will be scrutinising such cases.

According to the Election Department, all claims and objections received during the designated period will undergo detailed scrutiny before a final decision is taken. Only after this verification process is completed will the final electoral roll be published.

"The successful completion of the enumeration phase is the result of coordinated efforts of District Election Officers of all 23 districts, 90 EROs, 1,594 AEROs, 2,244 BLO Supervisors and 20,629 BLOs deployed at 20,629 polling stations, supported by volunteers," the Election Commission said in a release issued this evening.

Jaishankar to Iran's Araghchi: No matter what, do not attack merchant vessels

Divya A
New Delhi, July 31

A DAY after the government informed Parliament that 16 Indian nationals, including 10 seafarers, had been killed and another 75 injured in West Asia since the start of the conflict in February, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar spoke to his Iranian counterpart Syed Abbas Araghchi Friday and "strongly urged" Iran to avoid attacks on commercial shipping and seafarers under any circumstances.

Jaishankar's phone conversation with Araghchi came a day after he conveyed India's concern over attacks on cargo vessels and seafarers to Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha

"Had a tele-conversation with FM Araghchi of Iran this evening. Conveyed our deep concerns at the ongoing hostilities in the region," Jaishankar said after the conversation.

"Strongly urged that attacks on commercial shipping and seafarers be avoided under any circumstance," he said in a post on X, adding, "India condemns any such attack by any party."

"Was apprised of Iran's perspective of current developments and discussions under-

way," Jaishankar said, underlining that "India is always supportive of dialogue and diplomacy".

Over the past few days, New Delhi has expressed deep worry over a spate of attacks on merchant vessels in the Strait of Hormuz and the Black Sea, which have resulted in the death of Indian seafarers. It has condemned such actions by any party in the conflict.

This is the first time India has framed such a strong response and conveyed it to all parties concerned, having lost 10 seafarers in the West Asia conflict in attacks by either Iran or the US.

MoS for External Affairs Kirti Vardhan Singh told Rajya Sabha Thursday that 16 Indian nationals, including 10 seafarers, were killed and another 75 injured in the West Asia conflict since February.

On July 14, the Ministry of External Affairs had summoned Iranian Deputy Chief of Mission, Mohammad Javed Hosseini, to register a "strong protest" after an Indian sailor died and several were seriously injured when two UAE-flagged energy tankers carrying Indian seafarers were hit by Iranian cruise missiles earlier in the day.

Robust conflict of interest policy in place: Govt on selecting firms for RDI funds

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 31

THE SELECTION of companies for receiving money from newly created Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) Fund followed "robust evaluation mechanisms", "strict conflict of interest guidelines" and "merit-based selection processes", Ministry of Science & Technology said in a statement on Friday.

This came a day after Science and Technology Minister Jitendra Singh said in a written reply in RS that 7 of 11 members of one of the selection panels had a personal investment in several of companies that had been selected for receiving funds under RDI scheme.

On Friday, the ministry said that no member of the selection panel participated in evaluation of any company in which they had a personal interest. Any such interest was disclosed in advance, in accordance with the conflict of interest policy, it said.

"A comprehensive and robust Conflict of Interest policy is firmly in place at TDB (Technology Development Board, one of the fund managers responsible for disbursement of money from RDI fund). This policy has been followed systematically over a long period..." the ministry statement said. "Prior to the commencement of the 1st Investment Committee meeting (investment committee acts as the selection panel), TDB framed detailed Pre-Investment Guidelines/SoPs. These guidelines explicitly lay down the conditions under which a potential conflict of interest arises. Whenever a member has a potential conflict, the policy mandates full disclosure and complete recusal of concerned member from all discussions and decision-making processes regarding that entity."

All funding decisions were taken on merit as per Implementation Guidelines of RDI Fund, with zero involvement of conflicted members during evaluation or sanction process, it said.

Donation 'theft' skit: A Rahul cameo and Pappu Yadav in centrestage

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, July 31

IN A sign that the Opposition would step up its offensive over the alleged Ram temple donation theft during the Monsoon Session, Independent MP Rajesh Ranjan performed a skit on Parliament premises Friday.

Ranjan, better known as Pappu Yadav, came to Parliament in a monk's attire and performed a skit. He takes cash from the donation box and stuffs it into his pocket. Opposition MPs are seen playacting a public thrashing after they discover the theft. Yadav tries to flee, but is caught in time.

In his cameo, Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi deposited cash in the donation box.

Yadav's saffron attire did not go unnoticed inside the Lok Sabha. Without naming the Purnea MP, Speaker Om Birla, issued a warning to "members who wear different costumes to the House".

Outside the House, while Yadav played the lead role — ostensibly of the chief priest — SP MPs Ruchi Veera (Moradabad) and Awadhesh Prasad (Faizabad) were also involved in the skit. SP MP Dharmendra Yadav said the skit was Pappu Yadav's idea, but added that the Opposition is united on demanding a discussion on the alleged donation theft.

"I have given an adjournment notice on the issue every day since the Parliament has been in session. We want the issue to be discussed but it is always conveyed that the government is not ready," he said.

Congress MPs mostly looked on from behind a banner questioning why Home Minister Amit Shah was "missing" from Parliament.

Among the Congress MPs seen watching the skit were Rahul Gandhi, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra.



Lok Sabha LoP Rahul Gandhi, Independent MP Rajesh Ranjan and other Opposition members protest over alleged Ram temple donation theft, outside Parliament on Friday. PTI

5 QUESTIONS

INDEPENDENT MP RAJESH RANJAN PERFORMED A SKIT ON PARLIAMENT PREMISES ON RAM TEMPLE DONATION "THEFT". HE SPEAKS TO ASAD REHMAN ON HIS UNIQUE PROTEST AND OTHER ISSUES HE WANTS TO RAISE IN THE HOUSE

Betrayal of faith: Pappu Yadav slams Govt over temple donation 'theft'

What was the idea behind the skit performed by you and other Opposition MPs on Parliament premises?

There has been regular toying with the faith of the people of Sanatan (Dharma)... To sell the dignity of Lord Ram and to play with the faith in him... There have been thefts at so many temples, which is a betrayal of (the trust of) crores of people. Our saints are raising their voice on this issue. But (not) our government, which set up the committee and appointed the treasurer for the Ram Temple... Why hasn't the treasurer been arrested? He has been associated with RSS. The committee members have committed the theft, and this has made the devotees feel cheated. The government doesn't want to say anything. They say they brought Lord Ram (with the temple), but now when theft has happened at the temple, they are quiet. Our protest today was symbolic; all the Opposition members are standing for protecting Sanatan. God doesn't belong only to the RSS and the Treasurer of the

Ram Temple Trust can't be God.

Were all Opposition parties on board for this kind of protest?

Protests have been happening every day... Lord Ram reflects in all of us. This kind of theft is shameful. The country wants the culprits to be arrested and wants the PM to speak on this.

Speaker Om Birla has taken cognizance of your protest and Union Minister Kiren Rijiju and other BJP leaders have been critical of it. If the Speaker takes any action, are you ready for it?

We didn't use any unparliamentary language, and didn't do anything undignified... The Speaker is most respected by all of us. We are ready for any sacrifice for our religion and temples.

The Opposition has been demanding a statement from Union Home Minister Amit Shah. Will that demand continue on Monday?

We will raise this question

leader, into the Upper House. Accompanied by Bihar BJP chief Sanjay Saraogi, Devesh submitted his resignation to Legislative Council Chairman Awadhesh Singh, sources said. On Thursday, a three-judge Bench headed by CJI Surya Kant, hearing a plea challenging Prakash's reappointment as a minister without being elected as a legislator, asked the Bihar government's counsel: "It is a pure legal issue. How are you retaining a minister beyond six



RLM leader Deepak Prakash. @DEEPAKRLM

months when he is not elected?" The SC posted the matter for hearing next on August 4. Prakash, 36, son of RLM chief Upendra Kushwaha, was first inducted as Panchayati Raj Minister by the then CM Nitish Kumar on November 20, 2025. Following Nitish's resignation, Samrat took charge as the CM on April 15, 2026, inducting Prakash as the Panchayati Raj Minister on May 7, thereby leaving a gap of 22 days during which the latter was not a minister.

The challenge in Prakash's case also stems from his cumulative non-elected tenure across two different cabinets within the same legislative term exceeding the six-month constitutional limit: four months and 26 days during the Nitish's tenure and 2 months and 24 days in Samrat's ministry as of July 31. NDA government has tried to claim that in neither stint, Prakash has crossed six months' deadline. Responding to such questions during one of his press

conferences in June, Samrat had said, "He (Prakash) can remain a minister till five months and 29 days," while remaining silent about his double stints.

BJP's decision to get its MLC Devesh Kumar to resign is aimed at accommodating its ally in the Samrat ministry by ensuring Prakash's election in his place. Prakash's father Upendra Kushwaha is a prominent NDA leader, who belongs to OBC Kushwaha community which forms a sizeable chunk of Bihar voters.

Himanshu Harsh & Santosh Singh
Patna, July 31

A DAY after the Supreme Court questioned the BJP-led NDA government in Bihar over the continuance of Panchayati Raj Minister Deepak Prakash despite not being a member of either House of the state legislature, BJP MLC Devesh Kumar resigned from the Legislative Council Friday in a bid to facilitate the entry of Prakash, a RLM



Inauguration & Foundation Stone Laying for
Power Transmission, Civil Aviation, Highways
& Semiconductor Projects
Worth about ₹18,000 crore

by
Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister

Saturday, 01st August, 2026 from 10:00 am onwards | Bhogapuram, Andhra Pradesh



Inauguration of

 **Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport**

 **Transmission Scheme for Solar Energy Zone in Ananthapuram (Ananthpur) (2500 MW) and Kurnool (1000 MW)**

 **Khammam-Devarapalle Package V**
Four lane Access Controlled Green field highway from Gurvaygudem to Devarapalle section of NH-365BG

 **Transmission System for Kurnool Wind Energy Zone / Solar Energy Zone (AP) - Part-A & Part-B**

 **Khammam-Devarapalle Package IV**
Four lane Access Controlled Green field highway from Recherla to Gurvaygudem section of NH-365BG

 **Four-Lane Tadipatri Bypass**
Four lane Tadipatri Bypass on NH-67

Foundation Stone Laying for

 **Transmission System for Integration of Kurnool-IV REZ - Phase-I (for 4.5 GW)**

 **High-Level Bridge on NH-565**
High-level Bridge at Lingasamudram on Penchalakona - Yerpedu section of NH-565

 **Semiconductor packaging and testing facility Projects in Tarluvada, Vishakhapatnam phase I**

Benefits

- Boost economic growth, investment, industrialization and employment in Andhra Pradesh
- Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport will enhance air connectivity for North Andhra, South Odisha and Chhattisgarh, supporting tourism, trade and logistics
- Power Transmission projects will facilitate integration of renewable energy from Kurnool and Ananthapuram RE zone into National Grid and improve power availability across Southern India
- Support India's energy transition and sustainable development goals
- High-level Bridge at Lingasamudram on Penchalakona-Yerpedu link will enhance connectivity to key religious destinations - Penchalakona, Tirupati (Lord Balaji) and Sri Kalahasti Temples
- Improve regional connectivity, road safety and travel efficiency between Andhra Pradesh and Telangana through the four-lane Khammam-Devarapalle highway
- Reduce congestion and enhances road safety through the Tadipatri Bypass
- Semiconductor Project in Tarluvada, Visakhapatnam will create job opportunities and reduces import dependence, strengthening India's semiconductor value chain

in the august presence of

Shri S. Abdul Nazeer
Governor, Andhra Pradesh

Shri N. Chandrababu Naidu
Chief Minister, Andhra Pradesh

Shri Nitin Gadkari
Union Minister of Road Transport & Highways

Shri Manohar Lal
Union Minister of Housing & Urban Affairs; and Power

Shri Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu
Union Minister of Civil Aviation

Shri Ashwini Vaishnav
Union Minister of Railway, Information and Broadcasting; and Electronics and Information Technology

Shri Shripad Naik
Union Minister of State of Power and New & Renewable Energy

Shri Jitin Prasada
Union Minister of State of Commerce and Industry and Electronics and Information Technology

Shri Ajay Tamta
Union Minister of State of Road Transport & Highways

Shri Harsh Malhotra
Union Minister of State of Road Transport & Highways and Corporate Affairs

Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani
Union MoS of Rural Development; and Communications

Shri Bhupathi Raju Srinivasa
Union Minister of State of Heavy Industries; and Steel

Shri Murlidhar Mohol
Union MoS of Cooperation; and Civil Aviation

Shri K. Pawan Kalyan
Deputy Chief Minister, Andhra Pradesh

Shri Nara Lokesh
Minister, Govt. of Andhra Pradesh

Shri B.C. Janardhan Reddy
Minister for Road & Buildings, Infrastructure and Investments, Andhra Pradesh

Shri Gottipati Ravi Kumar
Minister of Energy, Andhra Pradesh

Shri Appalanaidu Kaliseti
Member of Parliament

Shri Bastipati Nagaraju Panchalingala
Member of Parliament

Smt. Dr. Byreddy Shabari
Member of Parliament

Shri Lavu Sri Krishna Devarayalu
Member of Parliament

Shri Ambica G. Lakshminarayana Valmiki
Member of Parliament

Shri Maddila Gurumoorthy
Member of Parliament

Smt. Daggubati Purandeswari
Member of Parliament

Shri Putta Mahesh Kumar
Member of Parliament

DD Watch the Event live on DD News

Bihar encounter: STF constable arrested as probe intensifies

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, July 31

A BIHAR Special Task Force (STF) constable, Akshay Kumar, was arrested in Ara on Friday in connection with the killing of Bharat Bhushan Tiwari (28), in a police encounter in Bhojpur last month — the first arrest of a policeman in a case that became a political flashpoint in the state.

Bhojpur SP Raj told *The Indian Express*, “Legal proceedings are underway, and the probe is continuing in accordance with the law.” The arrest came after a DIG-monitored committee looked into the killing after Tiwari’s family alleged the encounter was staged. Police sources said the inquiry concluded that Kumar had used “excessive force” against Tiwari. “The constable was found to have fired three bullets into Tiwari’s leg,” an officer said.

The killing led to murder charges being filed against Jagdishpur DSP and Shahpur SHO on June 22. While the Shahpur SHO is one of four policemen suspended since then, Jagdishpur SDPO has been transferred.

The encounter took place on June 17 after a two-day standoff between Tiwari and police in Bilauti village. Moments before it, Tiwari live-streamed on Facebook, saying, “If the demands are fulfilled, I have no problem laying down my weapon”.

‘Jaish member’ held in Bengal, police say he was tracking CM

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, July 31

A SUSPECTED member of terror outfit Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM) has been arrested in West Bengal’s Purba Bardhaman, police said, adding that the material recovered from his phone suggests that he was collecting information about Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari.

The West Bengal Police’s Special Task Force (STF) arrested Hamid Mondal from his Bardhaman residence late Thursday night. Police sources said that Mondal is suspected to be associated with JeM, and was in touch with a Pak-based handler. Originally from Howrah, he had been living in Bardhaman for the past two months and working in a garment factory. The STF and Bardhaman police are questioning Mondal.

Asked about the arrest, Adhikari said, “It’s a sensitive issue. STF and senior police officers are handling the case... The STF will hold a press conference on Saturday.” Preliminary information suggests that he had been tracking the movements of Adhikari and routes his convoy took. An analysis of his phone and digital records has revealed that he was in touch with Pak-based handlers.

10 killed as building declared unsafe collapses in Bhiwandi

Nayonika Bose & G S Poorvi
Mumbai, July 31

TEN PEOPLE were killed and three others sustained grievous injuries after a four-storey building, classified as structurally unsafe by the Bhiwandi Nizampur City Municipal Corporation (BNCMC), collapsed during repair work late Thursday night.

According to civic officials, the building, which had 28 residential units, had been issued repeated notices since 2020 to undergo a structural audit and was ordered to be vacated earlier this month. An FIR has been registered against the contractor, with officials alleging that repair work on multiple pillars at the same time triggered the collapse.

The incident was reported around 11.20 pm when the B wing of the ground-plus-four-storey Kohinoor building in Gangaramwadi came crashing down. Constructed in 2007, the building had been classified as C1, the highest risk category for structures deemed unsafe and unfit for occupation.

The deceased were identified as Krishna Kumar, Ranjit Singh (45), Radhe Shyam (45), Shiraj Rasool Shaikh (34), San-



Rescue personnel at the building collapse site in Maharashtra's Bhiwandi on Friday. DEEPAK JOSHI

tosh Kumar Pandey (42), Shameem Ansari (30), Rakesh Paswan (25), Mukesh Paswan (35), Ashok Paswan (42) and Shyamji Pal (48). The injured have been identified as Deepak Yadav (25), Abhay Yadav (26) and Sangita Prajapati (36).

Residents said portions of the building had started sinking on Thursday evening, prompting several families to leave hours before the collapse. According to civic officials, around 25 resi-

dents were evacuated after repeated warnings about the building’s condition, but labourers engaged in the repair work and a few occupants were inside.

BNCMC records show that the first notice directing residents to conduct a structural audit was issued on September 7, 2020. A reminder followed on April 22, 2022, after no audit was carried out. Officials said the occupants did not conduct a structural audit over the next four

years. On July 5 this year, the civic body issued fresh notices directing residents to immediately vacate the building owing to its deteriorating condition. Water and electricity connections were subsequently disconnected.

Despite this, some residents began repair work on the structure. A ward officer who visited the building on Thursday found it to be in an extremely poor condition. “After our official noted that there was very heavy

and high risk, he proactively urged all residents to move out hours before the tragedy. Unfortunately, some laborers and residents stayed back,” said a senior BNCMC official.

Officials said preliminary findings suggest the collapse occurred because repairs were carried out simultaneously on several load bearing pillars. “When a structure is declared C1, residents try to buy some time and carry out repair works in order to avoid evacuation. The building owner had appointed the contractor to carry out repairs on the beams of the building. However, instead of fixing the pillar one by one, the contractor carelessly worked on all the pillars at one go, leading to the collapse,” a senior official told *The Indian Express*.

Teams of the NDRF, Thane Disaster Response Force and the fire brigade began rescue operations shortly after the collapse.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said authorities must ensure dangerous buildings are evacuated. He has announced financial assistance for the families of those killed and said he had directed the municipal commissioner to initiate legal action against the contractor.

• BRIEFLY



SDRF personnel conduct rescue operation in Haridwar on Friday. PTI

UTTARAKHAND

Four Kanwariyas from Chandigarh drown in Haridwar canal

FOUR MINOR Kanwar pilgrims from Chandigarh drowned in the Ganga Canal near Jatwara Bridge in Haridwar Friday after they ventured into the midstream, allegedly misjudging the depth of the water amid low water levels caused by silt-cleaning operations. The deceased, aged between 16 and 18, were part of a group that had come to Haridwar for the Kanwar Yatra. Haridwar SP (City) Abhay Pratap Singh said that all the four bodies have been recovered from the canal. The deceased were identified as Shivanshu (16), Nitesh (17) and Bharat (17) — all residents of Chandigarh Sector 16, and Rohit Prajapati (18), from Sector 26/30. PTI

In a 1st, Manipur CM meets Zomi groups in Imphal

MANIPUR CM Yumnam Khemchand Singh Friday met representatives of three major Zomi organisations from Imphal’s Churachandpur, marking the first such meeting since ethnic violence erupted in the state in 2023. The 14-member delegation included representatives of Unified Zou Organisation, Zomi Chiefs Association and Zomi Council. The delegation briefed the CM on issues affecting the state and expressed support for government’s efforts to restore peace and normalcy. ENS

Gujarat: 3 killed amid heavy rain, 16,500 evacuated

WITH HEAVY rain lashing several parts of Gujarat Friday, three persons died of electrocution after a tempo truck carrying labourers came in contact with a live high-tension overhead electric wire in Navsari district. By the end of the day, more than 16,500 people were evacuated to safer locations across the state, as well as 41 people were rescued, as per a statement from the government. Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel reviewed the situation during a late night visit to the State Emergency Operations Centre. ENS

‘Derogatory’ posts against Modi: Meta India head named in Telangana cases

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, July 31

TELANGANA’S CYBERCRIME police have registered two cases over alleged morphed and objectionable social media content targeting Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the BJP protests, naming operators of Facebook and Instagram accounts, and Meta India’s head.

“We are in touch with the agencies concerned, and are co-operating with them to resolve the matter,” a Meta spokesperson told *The Indian Express*.

Meanwhile, sources said some content was removed because Meta secured valid legal orders requiring its removal. “The content which has not yet been removed has been found to be non-violative of Meta’s policies,” they said.

The cases were registered on July 29 on complaints by BJP supporters who alleged that manipulated videos and images of

the PM were circulated on social media. In Telangana, a Congress government under CM A Revanth Reddy is in power. Police are, however, tracing operators of the social media handles.

BJP spokesperson N V Subhash said, “Democracy permits disagreement, not digital lynching... We welcome criticism, political opposition and democratic debate. PM Narendra Modi has perhaps faced more criticism than any other political leader in contemporary India. Criticism is not the issue. Organised and vulgar abuse masquerading as political activism is.”

One of the complainants said 20 Facebook and Instagram accounts were allegedly using morphed content and sought action against Meta for hosting it. Telangana Police have invoked relevant sections of the BNS and the IT Act, naming operators of identified accounts and Meta’s India head as co-accused. All links became inactive by July 30.

EXPRESS special

Man who turned stones to gold: Tulu Mondal is latest TMC supporter in BJP crosshairs

Sweetie Kumari
Kolkata, July 31

ONCE HE was a daily wager. Now Md Nizamuddin alias Tulu Mondal has joined the list of names in West Bengal linked to cupboards full of riches — at last count, Rs 28.50 crore in cash, and 15 kg gold valued at Rs 22 crore, reportedly seized from the house of his nephew, Minar Mondal, a former government bus driver.

Birbhum SP V R Bhundesh said Minar was Tulu’s “manager”. While Minar is under arrest, Tulu is absconding, with a non-bailable warrant against him on charges of organised crime and criminal conspiracy, among others. “His house has been sealed,” Bhundesh said.

Public Prosecutor Bivas Chatterjee claimed Minar had “confessed” that the money and gold belonged to Tulu. “Land grabbing, extortion and economic offences may be involved.”

As per sources, Tulu used to make a living loading stones onto dumper trucks and lorries, from where he moved to quarrying and crushing of stones, and supply and logistics. Around 2014-15, Tulu’s fortunes changed when he entered the circle of then ruling TMC, through proximity to Saigal Hossain, a personal guard of then TMC heavyweight Anubrata Mondal.

However, Tulu never for-



(Clockwise from above) Tulu Mondal; gold and bags of cash seized from the house of his nephew, who has been nabbed. Police recovered Rs 28 crore cash and gold worth Rs 22 crore from his associate and kin



mally joined TMC or held any post in the party. Soon, he had a fleet of over 200 vehicles, including dumper trucks, working in his stone quarrying, coal transport and sand mining operations. An acquaintance who did not want to be identified said marriage with a tribal woman helped Tulu’s rise as it allowed him access to land to establish his stone quarry. There were companies registered in the names of his wife and daughter.

In a demonstration of his hold on the area, Tulu once announced he would construct a private bridge across Mayurakshi river to allow his dumper trucks to bypass weight curbs on Tilpara reservoir. This was halted

after public outcry. In 2022, when CBI first knocked on Anubrata’s doors, it also searched Tulu’s premises. Later that year, police arrested Tulu in a murder case, and he spent nearly a month in judicial custody. His rivals termed it a bid to ensure Central agencies didn’t get to Tulu.

In 2024, Tulu came to statewide attention when he hosted a lavish wedding for his daughter, spending crores and hosting a guest list including many celebrities. Over 500 vehicles brought people from Kolkata to Birbhum for the wedding, as per locals. Just ahead of the 2026 polls which the BJP won, the authorities again suspected Tulu after a recovery of

Rs 5 crore from New Town.

On Friday, Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari praised Birbhum Police for recoveries from Tulu, adding that apart from the cash and jewellery seized, “we have found clues regarding 21 properties, including houses, a farmhouse, 2 petrol pumps, 82 trucks and cars, and 300 bighas of land... We will seize these.” Targeting his predecessor Mamata Banerjee, he said, “It (the scam) doesn’t happen without government support. Such a massive racket was going on for so long, everyone in the government must have been involved.”

Now in the rebel camp, former Mamata aide Madan Mitra backed the allegation.

• UNLESS STATES BECOME ENGINES OF EDUCATIONAL REFORMS, INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP RATHER THAN MERE PRODUCERS OF DEGREE-HOLDERS, GAPS BETWEEN ASPIRATIONS & OPPORTUNITIES WILL ONLY WIDEN

Exam leaks to education revolution: Why states have task cut out, Punjab to HP



NORTHERN LIGHTS
BY MANRAJ GREWAL SHARMA

A WEEKLY DISPATCH ON THE POLITICS AND IDEAS SHAPING NORTH INDIA

WHILE IT may have been triggered by the NEET-UG exam paper leak, the Jantar Mantar agitation of students and youths has brought education to the centre of conversations in drawing rooms across India besides making it a recurring theme in current political discourse.

In Punjab, education emerged as a major plank in the 2022 Assembly polls when the AAP swept the state on its twin promises of “*baddlav* (change)” and “*sikhya kranti* (education revolution)”. The then AAP-led

Delhi government’s perceived success in revamping government schools there resonated with the Punjab voters long accustomed to spending heavily on private schools whose main selling point has been the “English-medium” label. Even today, education remains one of the Bhagwant Mann-led AAP government’s key political USPs.

The neighbouring Himachal Pradesh has also traditionally enjoyed an enviable record in school education. It was among the first states in North India to achieve near-universal literacy, with literacy rising from 63.9% in 1991 to over 99% in 2025. Its success rested on early political commitment, geography-adapted systems and strong community ownership.

Founding Himachal chief minister Y S Parmar was known to trek from village to village, equipped with a typewriter, so he could sanction a school wherever he found a habitation. High male migration boosted female literacy, while parent-teacher associations and pan-chayats kept teachers on their

toes. More recently, CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu sought to sustain the momentum by directing deputy commissioners to adopt government schools.

Punjab has continued to bask in the success of its school-focused initiatives. Education Minister Harjot Singh Bains says the state has climbed from 27th place in 2020 to first rank in the NITI Aayog’s Education Quality Report 2026 after the AAP government, he added, raised the education budget by 50%, recruited more teachers and sent them for training to Singapore and Finland.

Government school students also topped the 2024 PARAKH Rashtriya Sarvekshan held by NCERT, while the number of NEET qualifiers from the government schools has risen from about 80 before 2022 to 882 in 2026. Punjab has become the first state to introduce AI as a subject from Class I. Yet, education is not just a collection of disparate institutions but an integrated pipeline linking schools with competitive exams and universities, which in turn feed the la-



Congress MPs Amrinder Singh Raja Warring, Amar Singh, Gurjeet Singh Aujla and Dharamvira Gandhi protest outside Parliament. ANI

bour market. Failures at any stage undermine the system.

In Punjab, the Opposition leaders have alleged leaks even as the Mann government denies any pre-exam breach. The latest exam row erupted after police busted an inter-state cheating racket during the pharmacy officer recruitment exam.

Haryana, too, has faced repeated allegations of exam malpractices, while Himachal’s 2022 police recruitment paper leak eventually led to a CBI probe, over 170 arrests and dissolution

of the Staff Selection Commission. The Sukhu government has since enacted one of India’s toughest anti-paper leak laws, with punishments of up to 10-year jail term and a fine of up to Rs 1 crore. Any paper leak, however small, is an outrage because it erodes common people’s trust in the promise of meritocracy.

In these three states, which continue to witness large-scale migration of their youths — Haryana has even set up a bureau to facilitate overseas employment — every paper leak,

whether local or national, becomes another push factor. While these states have invested heavily in schools, higher education has increasingly been outsourced to private universities with gleaming campuses and equally steep fees.

Punjab can count its quality public universities on the fingers of one hand. All the state’s leading public varsities were set up over 5 decades ago. Panjab University was established in 1882, while Panjab University and Panjab Agricultural University were founded in 1962. Guru Nanak Dev University came into existence in 1969. Today, these institutions soldier on despite chronic financial constraints. The explosion of private universities over the past two decades — Punjab is home to 21 such campuses, while Haryana and Himachal account for 25 and 17 respectively, as per the UGC — has not necessarily led to better educational outcomes.

The problem is not merely rooted in access but also connected with quality. The region has yet to build a robust eco-

system of research, innovation and industry collaboration. India spends about 0.8% of its GDP on research and development, well below most innovation-driven economies. Many universities thus remain teaching institutions rather than the centres of discovery and excellence. More campuses do not automatically translate into more patents, start-ups or globally competitive graduates.

These challenges come at a critical moment. With a median age of about 29 years, India enjoys one of the world’s youngest populations. But demographic dividends are realised only when education leads to productivity. Otherwise, it may become a demographic burden. For Punjab, Haryana and Himachal, affected by rampant out-migration, the stakes could not be higher. And then, there is a crisis of unemployment which has been a constant refrain among employers, reflected in shrinking campus placements. For many parents spending heavily on their children’s education, the results of their efforts have

increasingly become uncertain.

The Haryana government under the previous CM, Manohar Lal Khattar, had tried to introduce a 75% quota for locals in the private sector through a legislation, with an eye on Gurgaon which attracts investment and talent. The 2020 law was struck down by the Punjab and Haryana High Court in 2023. The NEP is being projected as part of a solution through an emphasis on vocational education. But skills alone can’t create start-ups if the ecosystem is not conducive to enterprise. Unless the states become engines of educational reforms, innovation and entrepreneurship rather than merely producers of degree-holders, the gaps between aspirations and opportunities will only widen.

In the final analysis, a paper leak does not just betray a compromised exam, it exposes the gaps between an education system that teaches rote tests and one that delivers opportunities. Bridging those gaps, not merely plugging leaks, would mark the real education revolution the states in the region must deliver.

‘Will take partnership to new heights’: PM Modi speaks to UK counterpart

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 31

AFTER HIS first call with newly elected UK Prime Minister Andy Burnham, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday said that both countries would strengthen cooperation across technology, defence and security sectors, while also taking the recently operationalised India-UK Comprehensive Strategic Partnership to new heights.

In a post on X, PM Modi said he was delighted to speak with

the UK PM and congratulated him on assuming office.

“We agreed to work together across sectors such as technology, innovation, defence, security, clean energy, education and people-to-people ties and take the India-UK Comprehensive Strategic Partnership to new heights,” he said. “We will also collaborate closely to fully harness the trade and investment opportunities presented by the recently operationalised India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement, for the

shared prosperity and well-being of both our people.”

According to the statement from the UK Government, Burnham — who took over as PM on July 20 — discussed the strength of the UK-India partnership. The leaders also exchanged views on the situation in West Asia and agreed to continue working closely towards de-escalation and the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, it said.

“The PM began by reflecting on the strength of the UK-India partnership and the

significant impact it has had on local communities across the UK. The PM set out his ambitions to further enhance the UK-India relationship, including through the UK-India Vision 2035 framework and strong people-to-people links.”

Burnham also underlined the potential of the India-UK CETA and noted that this will create opportunities for people in both countries. Both Prime Ministers expressed their desire to continue discussions and meet in person at the earliest opportunity.

Cabinet clears 5-yr extension for PM-KISAN

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 31

THE CENTRE on Friday approved continuation of the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN) Scheme for the next five years. A decision of this effect was taken during the Cabinet meeting chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

According to an official statement issued after the Cabinet meeting, the PM-KISAN will continue for the next five years from 2026-27 to 2030-31. “A total financial outlay of Rs.3.15 lakh crore has been approved for the Scheme during this period,” it said.

“The approval reiterates the Government’s commitment that the prosperity of farmers forms the foundation of the nation’s prosperity. Through the PM-KISAN Scheme, timely and transparent income support is being provided to eligible farmer families through the Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) system, enabling farmers to increase agricultural investment and strengthen their livelihoods,” the statement said.

The scheme was launched on February 24, 2019, ahead of the Lok Sabha elections.

NSA invoked by Assam against activist day after he gets bail

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, July 31

A DAY after a local court granted bail to land rights activist Pranab Doley, who was arrested on July 12 in connection with protests against a proposed luxury hotel project in Kaziranga, the Assam government invoked the National Security Act (NSA) against him, stating that his activities “are prejudicial to the maintenance of public order as well as security of the state”.

Doley is a prominent indigenous and land rights activist who was arrested by the Golaghat police in connection with June 28 protest against a proposed luxury hotel project in Inglay Pathar, adjoining the

Kaziranga National Park. Four other activists were also arrested in connection with this. Doley has been leading protests for years, raising concerns about potential ecological impact of the project and displacement of indigenous villagers.

In its FIR, police alleged Doley and “about fifty other persons” “trespassed” to the project site “with pre-planned manner, being armed with deadly weapons like machete, sharp sticks, etc”, assaulted police personnel, “instigated the crowd” and “threatened” further agitation, among other allegations.

In a July 29 order granting bail to Doley, an Additional Sessions Judge in Golaghat observed that there is prima facie

absence of footage demonstrating these allegations and no “deadly weapon” was seized during investigation.

While Doley was still in the district jail, the state government issued an order for his preventive detention under the NSA, citing a report by the SSP of Golaghat.

The order states that the government “has considered the nature, gravity, frequency and potential consequences of the activities attributed to the detainee and is satisfied that there is a real and imminent possibility of the detainee continuing to indulge in activities prejudicial to the maintenance of public order and security of the State, if he is not prevented from doing so.”

Cauvery: DKS defers meeting with Vijay, calls all-party meet on Aug 2

Express News Service
Bengaluru, July 31

A DAY after the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) endorsed a directive of the Cauvery Water Regulatory Committee (CWRC) to Karnataka to release 3,500 cuses of water to Tamil Nadu, the D K Shivakumar government deferred the August 3 meeting with Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Vijay Joseph, called an all-party meeting on August 2 on the issue and pro-Kannada groups announced a state bandh on August 13.

Despite Karnataka’s request to the CWMA to delay the implementation of a CWRC order dated July 28 by a fortnight, the Authority on Thursday upheld the CWRC order and directed the Karnataka government to immediately release water to Tamil Nadu for 15 days.

The CWMA order is the first Cauvery crisis encountered by the two new CMs of Karnataka and Tamil Nadu — D K Shivakumar and C Joseph Vijay — whose parties are political allies.

Pro-Kannada groups, which have traditionally been against the release of Cauvery



Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar chairs a meeting in the wake of CWMA order, in Bengaluru on Friday.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 (CWRC) order to release water to Tamil Nadu must be strongly opposed. There will be a bandh in the whole of Karnataka on August 13 from 6 am to 6 pm. The Karnataka Film Association, the state employees association, hotel associations and others are supporting this bandh. We call for moral support from everyone and ask that no one should oppose the bandh,” said veteran Kannada activist Vatal Nagaraj.

Earlier this week, Karnataka CM Shivakumar had invited Vijay to the state for a meeting on the Cauvery issue on August 3 and suggested a joint aerial survey to understand the water crisis due to a deficient Monsoon.

On Friday, Shivakumar said the meeting with Vijay was postponed. “It was decided that the Tamil Nadu CM would come on August 3. The situation is not good now... If they intend to protect the interests of their state, we intend to protect the interests of our state...” he said.

On Thursday, following the CWMA’s confirmation of the CWRC July 28 order, the Karnataka CM said another appeal had been filed before the Authority and an all-party meeting on the Cauvery water issue will be held on Sunday, August 2.

“We have discussed this issue with (BJP) MPs and Union Min-

E. EXPLAINED

No mechanism for distress years

The contention of political parties in Karnataka and Tamil Nadu is that Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal and the Supreme Court order on sharing of Cauvery water have only spelt out the norms during normal Monsoon and not distress years. The parties have in the past called for the PM’s intervention to create a mechanism for redressal of the dispute in distress years.

isters Pralhad Joshi, V Somanna, Jagadish Shettar and Basavaraj Bommai, and they are making utmost efforts for the welfare of the state,” Shivakumar said.

“The entire country must work together,” he said regarding the possibility of tensions escalating on the issue with the Opposition parties in the two states looking to capitalise on the quandary of the allies.

MANEKSHAW CENTRE
PARADE ROAD, DELHI CANTT-10
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
1. ADG, Adm & Coord invites sealed tender from vendors for hiring agency for 96 civil allied manpower at Manekshaw Centre, Delhi Cantt-10 for a period of three years extendable as per the terms and conditions.
2. The tender documents (RFP) may be collected from Main Office, Manekshaw Centre, Delhi Cantt-10, between 1000hrs to 1700 hrs wef 05 August 2026 to 17 August 2026 on any working day against submission of tender documents fee of Rs 2500/- (Rupees Two Thousand and Five Hundred only) in the form of Demand Draft/Bankers cheque in favour of 'Manekshaw Centre Main Acct' or Cash.
3. Sealed tender documents as per RFP will be dropped in the tender box placed at the Main Office of Manekshaw Centre by 1700hrs on 30 August 2026.

ARMY WELFARE EDUCATION SOCIETY
(Registered under Societies Registration Act XXI of 1860)
REQUIREMENT OF AGENCY FOR CONDUCT OF ONLINE SCREENING TEST
1. Army Welfare Education Society (AWES) invites tenders from registered, eligible agencies for conduct of 'ONLINE SCREENING TEST' for selection of teachers for Army Public Schools under Army Welfare Education Society.
2. "REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)" for tender is available on the website www.awesindia.com.

UTTAR PRADESH JAL NIGAM (URBAN), OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, GANGA JAL PROJECT UNIT, U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN), PRATAP VIHAR, GHAZIABAD.
Letter No. 1266/Nivida/64
Dated: 30/07/2026
E-Tender Notice
U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) online e-tenders for execution of "C.C. Road Work at Primary Treatment Works under 50 Cusec Water Supply Scheme" Bids are invited in two bid system on percentage rate basis from eligible reputed and experienced bidders.
E-tender documents will be available for download from 05.08.2026 at 17:00 Hrs., Pre-Bid meeting will be held on dated 12.08.2026 at 14:30 hrs. in the office of under signed. E-bid can be submitted till 05.09.2026 up to 14:00 Hrs, and technical bid shall be opened on 05.09.2026 at 16:30 Hrs. in the office of The Executive Engineer, Gangajal Project Unit, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Ghaziabad in presence of contractor or their authorized representative. E-tender Cost is Rs. 5000.00+GST @18%. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal <http://etender.up.nic.in> and U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website www.upnsdc.gov.in.

NORTHERN RAILWAY (E-Auction Notice)
The 7th PUBE-Auction/NIT-2026
No. The Divisional Commercial Manager/G, Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in/>) for allotment of Misc contracts of NFR at following railway stations:

E-Catalogue No.	Type of Asset	Station	Date & Time for e-auction
AdvT-Aug-01-26	Passenger Announcement System (PAS)	New Delhi, Delhi, Hazrat Nizamuddin, Anand Vihar Terminal, Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Karnal, Kurukshetra, Panipat, Sonapat, Meerut Cantt., Meerut City, Muzaffarnagar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Rohtak, Delhi Shahdara, Faridabad, Palwal.	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
26 AdvT-Aug-01-	Vinyl Stickers/ Wrapping Exterior	Train No. 22479/80 and 22485/86	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-01-26	DDIS UTS	290 UTS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-01-26	DDIS PRS	165 PRS Counters over Delhi Division.	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-01-26	Glow Ball Towers	4 Glow Ball Towers at Hazrat Nizamuddin.	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-01-26	Head Rest Covers	Train No. 22439/40, 22435/36, 22447/48, 22469/70 & 22425/26	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-01-26	Procurement and Supply of Linen Bag	Reserved Coaches of Mail/Express Trains of Delhi Division.	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-01-26	Unipole OOH	Cluster-A, C, D, E, F & G	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-01-26	Unipole	Modinagar.	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-01-26	Waiting Rooms	Baghat Road, Shamli, Khehra, Jakhal & Mansa, Railway Station	Start: 13-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-02-26	Unipole OOH	Cluster-B	Start: 17-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs
AdvT-Aug-02-26	Vinyl Stickers/ Wrapping Exterior	Train No. 14041/42	Start: 17-08-2026 at 11:00 hrs

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen. : <https://ireps.gov.in/> (E-Auction-Leasing)
2657/2026
Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/G Northern Railway, Delhi division, New Delhi
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

HAFFKINE BIO-PHARMACEUTICAL CORPORATION LTD.
(Govt. of Maharashtra Undertaking)
Acharya Donde Marg, Parel, (East) Mumbai - 400012, Maharashtra, India
Phone No. 022-2417564/ 24129320-22, Email:- mm@vaccinehaffkine.com
E-TENDER NOTICE 2026-2027
Haffkine Bio Pharmaceutical Corporation Ltd. (HBPCL) A UN accredited Govt. of Maharashtra Undertaking Company, engaged in the manufacturing of Life Saving Vaccines, Anti-Sera and Pharmaceutical formulations and publishing e-tenders for following Material & Services for our Parel Mumbai unit, Pimpri Pune unit and our subsidiary company, Haffkine Ajintha Pharmaceuticals Ltd., (HAPL) Jalgaon unit.

Sr. No.	Description
A. Raw Materials, Consumables & Packing Materials	
1	Various API & Excipients, Packing materials including Corrugated boxes, Pharmaceutical Consumables for our Parel Mumbai, Pimpri Pune and Jalgaon unit
2	3, 5, 10 & 20 ml. Molded Glass Vials for various vaccine filling
3	Grey Butyl Rubber Stoppers (RFS)
4	Aluminum Seals & Aluminum Foils
5	OPV Plastic Droppers
6	Thermocol Box as per our specification
7	Dry Hay (सुके गवत) for equine feeding purpose at ATS Dept. Pimpri, Pune
B Services	
8	Transportation of Horses and mules from Uttarakhand, Uttarpradesh to Pimpri Pune
9	Providing Integrated Facility Management Services (Housekeeping, Gardening, Sanitation and allied support services at Anti Toxin & Sera (ATS) Dept. Pimpri unit.
10	Various services including Security services, Labour Contractor services, Transport services and other related services to Pharmaceutical operations
11	Various miscellaneous and Quality Control Lab testing services

All e-tenders are published exclusively on <https://mahatenders.gov.in> and small & local purchase requirements may be displayed on HBPL website www.vaccinehaffkine.com time to time. Interested bidders/suppliers are requested to visit the above mentioned website regularly to understand that supply requirements of HBPL & HAPL and submit their bids within the stipulated time period mentioned in each tender.
Managing Director
Haffkine Bio-Pharmaceutical Corporation Ltd.
DGIPR/2026-27/2028

TENDER NOTICE
PBABHA ENERGY LIMITED
Corporate Office : 12A, Abhisree Corporate Park, Opp. Swagat Bungalows BRTS Bus Stop, Ambli Bopal Road, Ambli, Ahmedabad-380058
Phone: 02717-488 611, E-mail: pnacmd2@prabhaenergy.com
1 Tender no. **PEL/CBM/KN BLOCK/HIRING OF WORKOVER RIG/07/26**
Description of Work Hiring of WORKOVER RIG Services
Last date of submission of bid 14 August 2026 at 17:00 Hrs. IST
PEL, as joint operator, on behalf of consortium comprising with PEL, ONGCL and IOCL, invites tender from reputed and experienced Service Providers for above mentioned services at North Karanpura CBM Block, Jharkhand, India.
Interested agency may please visit <https://pepel.tenders.in>. Tender Documents are available for download on e-tender portal.

APPLICATION FOR ALLOTMENT OF CAMERO SI REGIMENTAL SHOP
1. Air Officer Commanding, Air Force Central Accounts Office, Subroto Park, New Delhi-10 invites applications from War Widows/ Widows of Defence personnel killed while on duty, Disabled soldiers/Ex Servicemen and spouses/Widows of Ex servicemen etc for allotment of under mentioned shops in Subroto Park Complex at New Delhi.
AFCAO, Cafeteria at AFCAO
2. The applicable terms and conditions are mentioned in application form.
3. The application form is available from 03 Aug 26 at Service Institute, AFCAO, Subroto Park, New Delhi-10 between 0800 hrs to 1400 hrs on every day except Saturday, Sunday and holidays (Tele No. 011-25690477/23307359). The application form for tendering may be collected on payment of Rs. 500/- per application. The last date of deposit / receipt of completed application is 17 Aug 26 by 1400 hrs along with EMD (Earnest Money Deposit) of Rs. 5000 /- (Rupees Five Thousand only). The EMD should be in the form of Demand Draft drawn in favour of **OIC SI Fund, Payable at New Delhi**. After scrutiny of documents, eligible candidates will be intimated about the date and time of auction through candidate provided E-mail and telephone number (both).

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Shahdat Khan S/o Abdul Khan Makim R/o H.No. F-44, D-35/431, New Seemapuri, Jain Mandir, Shahdara, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 479/2021 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC at PS: Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shahdat Khan** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shahdat Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shahdat Khan** of **FIR No. 479/2021 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC of PS: Jagatpuri, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 01.09.2026.**
By order
Anushtha Srivastava
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Shahdara Distt. Room No. 07,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/10214/SHD/2026

डॉ० राजेन्द्र प्रसाद केन्द्रीय कृषि विश्वविद्यालय
Dr. Rajendra Prasad Central Agricultural University
पूसा, समस्तीपुर, बिहार . ८४८१२५
Pusa, Samastipur, Bihar - 848125
Short Advertisement
Dr. Rajendra Prasad Central Agricultural University, Pusa invites applications for various Teaching Positions on Direct Recruitment basis vide Advertisement No. RPCAU/03/2026 dated 31.07.2026.
For more details kindly visit: www.rpcau.ac.in
Recruitment Section
RPCAU, Pusa
For India Exposition Mart Ltd.
Sd/-
Anupam Sharma
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	19260632	ELASTIC RING ACLATHAN RING FOR WAG-9, WAP-7 and WAP-5 ELECTRIC LOCOMOTIVES	381 NOS	28.08.2026
02	19260629	SUSPENSION TUBE COMPLETE FOR WAP-7/WAG-9	97 NOS	28.08.2026
03	19261697	PANTO FOOT INSULATOR	390 NOS	28.08.2026
04	19261766	METALIZED CARBON STRIP	2009 NOS	28.08.2026
05	19264439	DOUBLE ROW SELF ALIGNING SPHERICAL ROLLER BEARING	247 NOS	29.08.2026

Note:- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details.
2. No manual offer will be entertained.
Tender Notice No.: 31/2026-2027 Dated: 31.07.2026 2662/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

INDIA EXPOSITION MART LTD
CIN: U99999DL2001PLC110396
Regd. Office: Plot No. 1, 210 - Atlantic Plaza, 2nd Floor, Local Shopping Centre, Mayur Vihar Phase-I, Delhi - 110091 Tel.: +91-120-2328011-20, Fax: +91-120-2328010 Email id: cs@indiaexpcentre.com, Website : www.indiaexpomart.com
NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS
TRANSFER OF UNCLAIMED DIVIDEND & EQUITY SHARES TO THE INVESTOR EDUCATION AND PROTECTION FUND AUTHORITY (IEPF)
Shareholders of the company are hereby informed that in terms of the requirements of Section 124(6) of the Companies Act, 2013 read with the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016 as amended from time to time, the **Dividend declared for the financial year 2018-19**, which remained unclaimed for a period of seven years will be credited to the IEPF within 30 days from the due date i.e., **Sunday, November 1, 2026**. The corresponding shares on which dividends were unclaimed for seven consecutive years will also be transferred as per the procedures set out in the Rules.
The company has sent individual notices to all the shareholders concerned whose shares are liable to be transferred to IEPF as per the aforesaid Rules. The details of such shareholders have also been uploaded on the Company's website at www.indiaexpomart.com under the tab "Investor Relation".
In this connection, please note that for shares held in physical form, a duplicate share certificate(s) will be issued and transferred to IEPF. The original share certificate which is registered in your name(s) for the shares held by you will stand automatically cancelled.
In the event the valid claim is not received on or before **Saturday, October 24, 2026**, the Company shall proceed to transfer the liable dividend, and corresponding equity shares to the IEPF without any further notice. Please note that after such transfer, shareholders/claimants can claim the transferred shares along with dividend from the IEPF Authority for which details are available at www.iepf.gov.in, subject to obtaining "Entitlement Letter" from the Company. No claim shall lie against the Company in respect of unpaid/ unclaimed dividend and shares transferred to IEPF pursuant to the said Rules.
In case of any clarification/ assistance in this regard, the concerned shareholder(s) may write to the Company at its corporate office at India Exposition Mart Ltd. Plot No. 23 -25 & 27- 29, Knowledge Park - II, Gautam Budh Nagar, Greater Noida- 201306 or by sending an email to the Company at cs@indiaexpcentre.com.
For India Exposition Mart Ltd.
Sd/-
Anupam Sharma
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
August 1, 2026
Delhi

Citing unforeseen circumstances, TISS defers convocation

Pallavi Smart
Mumbai, July 31

MUMBAI'S TATA Institute of Social Sciences (TISS) has postponed its 86th convocation, scheduled for August 2, just two days before the event, citing “unforeseen circumstances”.

The official email didn't specify a reason. Officials and students said there were discussions on campus over security arrangements, since Chief Justice of India Surya Kant was scheduled to attend as chief guest. They said there were concerns that protests linked to the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) movement could break out during the event.

“Although this was not publicly announced anywhere, it was common knowledge on campus. Considering the current situation surrounding the CJP, there were concerns over whether there would be any protest or other activity targeting the chief guest on campus,” an official said, adding that no official reason had been communicated for the postponement.

In an email to students, the institute's Registrar said: “We sincerely regret to inform you that, due to unforeseen circumstances, TISS's 86th Convoca-



CJI Surya Kant was scheduled to attend as the chief guest

tion, scheduled for August 2, 2026, has been postponed.”

The email said a revised date would be announced later and apologised for the inconvenience to graduating students and their families. The last-minute call has left many students upset. Several said they'd already made travel arrangements for parents and relatives to attend.

Students and officials said police personnel had visited the campus in the days before the event, which many believed was part of security preparations for the CJI's visit. “There was no official communication from the administration regarding the CJI's visit. However, messages circulated by groups associated with the right-wing warned students of consequences if any dissenting activity was held on campus during the convocation,” a student said.

Taslima returns to Kolkata after 19 yrs: ‘Good to be back’

Sweetie Kumari
Kolkata, July 31

WEARING A traditional Bengali lal paar shada saree (white saree with red borders), a smiling Taslima Nasrin stepped out of Kolkata airport onto a hot and humid Friday afternoon to the sound of conch shells and a cheering crowd.

For the Bangladeshi author who has been living in exile for decades, it marked an emotional return to a city that is her second home, one she had been forced to flee almost overnight nearly two decades ago.

Greeting the crowd, which had been waiting patiently for her and welcomed her with flowers, a beaming Nasrin said, “It feels extremely good to be back.”

Leading the welcome party was BJP MLA Sourav Sikdar. “Her arrival is a perfect example of ‘bhoy out, bharosa in’ (fear out, confidence in),” said the legislator from Dum Dum North. “Kolkata is her favourite city and she has time and again said this. She could only come because of Chief Minister Suvenud Adhikari. Had she not been given that security and assurance, she wouldn't have come. Wherever



Bangladeshi author Taslima Nasrin at the airport in Kolkata, Friday. PARTHA PAUL

she wants to go as per law and whatever she wants to eat, she can. I would like her to enjoy her stay, eat phuchka, and speak her mind. Kolkata is waiting to hear her tomorrow.”

The event at the Rabindra Sadan cultural centre on Saturday will be Nasrin's first public appearance in Kolkata in 19 years.

On November 21, 2007, tensions over the second volume of her autobiography, *Dwikhondito* (Split: A Life), spilled

onto the streets as demonstrations organised by the All India Minority Forum led to road blockades and incidents of arson in parts of Kolkata. To bring the situation under control, the Left Front government led by Buddhadeb Bhattacharya called in the Army to help restore order. Facing political pressure and worried about the situation spiralling out of control if Nasrin remained in the city, the government pressured her to leave the city. She lived in New Delhi for a few months after that before leaving the country and moving to the US for a few years.

Nasrin's writings have faced opposition from conservative groups since she published her best-known novel *Lajja* (Shame) in 1993. The book was about the persecution of a fictitious Hindu family in Bangladesh in the aftermath of the Babri Masjid's demolition. She left Bangladesh the following year following death threats and protests and lived across Europe, including Germany, and North America.

During this period, Sweden granted her citizenship. She subsequently found refuge in Kolkata, the city culturally closest to her home. In 1998,

Nasrin published *Meyebela* (My Bengali Girlhood), the first volume of her autobiography. *Dwikhondito* was the second part of the autobiography and ran into legal challenges and opposition from conservatives. In 2004, she moved to Kolkata after receiving a temporary residence permit.

The Rabindra Sadan event — where Nasrin's poems will be read and may see the author discuss the circumstances under which she left Kolkata and her years away from the city — is being organised by NGOs Secular Mission, Paschimbonger Jonno (For West Bengal), and Human Rights Beyond Frontiers. Chief Minister Suvenud Adhikari and author Shirshendu Mukhopadhyay are expected to attend the event.

“We will not bow down before fundamentalists. We expect her to come here more and stay. The courage Suvenud Adhikari has shown by inviting her, no other person could have done that,” Santanu Singha, a committee member of Human Rights Beyond Frontiers, told *The Indian Express*.

As per her tentative schedule, Nasrin will meet the press on August 3 and leave the following day.

MAHAGENCO'S COAL MINE

SC: Fresh public hearing must for clearance, but mining to continue

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 31

THE SUPREME Court has held that a fresh public consultation was required before granting the Environmental Clearance (EC) for Maharashtra State Power Generation Company Limited's (MAHAGENCO) Gare Palma Sector-II coal mine in Chhattisgarh. But there would be no restriction, the court clarified, on the company's mining activities “merely because the requisite fresh public consultation has not been undertaken so far”.

The judgment, delivered on July 24 by a Bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joyimalya Bagchi and V Mohana, was uploaded subsequently.

The EC for the Gare Palma Sector-II Coal Mine was granted to MAHAGENCO in July 2022. The grant of EC was challenged before the National Green Tribunal (NGT), which, in January 2024, quashed the EC after noting deficiencies in the appraisal process and directed the Environment Ministry to “re-examine the matter from the stage of conducting public consultation afresh”.

Following the NGT's order, MAHAGENCO resubmitted the project for appraisal, the ministry's Expert Appraisal Committee (EAC) reconsidered it, and a fresh EC was granted in August 2024, without conducting a fresh public hearing.

The fresh EC was also challenged before the NGT. In its order dated April 17, the NGT upheld the EC, observing that the appraisal process had re-

considered the earlier public hearing through videography, records and further examination by the authorities.

The petitioners challenged the NGT's order before the Supreme Court, which held that the expression “afresh” used in the NGT's earlier order required the authorities to undertake a fresh public consultation.

The Bench observed: “In our considered opinion, the expression ‘afresh’ connotes that it was obligatory upon the authorities to conduct afresh public consultation. Since such an exercise has not been carried out, the contrary view taken by the NGT in the impugned judgment does not seem to be sustainable.”

However, the court clarified that MAHAGENCO's mining operations need not be halted solely on account of the pending fresh public consultation “since substantial compliance has already taken place”.

The July 24 order said: “It is clarified that there shall not be any impediment to respondent No. 4 (MAHAGENCO) merely because the requisite fresh public consultation has not been undertaken so far. At the same time, we have no doubt that ‘afresh public consultation’ ought to have been undertaken before the grant of EC.”

Accordingly, the SC remitted the matter to the NGT, directing it to monitor completion of the fresh public consultation process and pass an appropriate order thereafter. The NGT was directed to take up the matter on August 3 and decide it expeditiously.

Land allotted near Bhojshala site, Muslims hold Friday namaz amid protests by locals

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, July 31

FOR THE first time since the Madhya Pradesh High Court held the disputed Bhojshala complex in Dhar to be Hindu in character, members of the Muslim community offered Friday namaz on a site adjacent to the medieval monument, amidst protests by locals.

The prayers were held on Khasra No. 612, adjoining the boundary wall of the Bhojshala complex and within sight of the Kamal Maula Mosque located within it.

The namaz site was identified by the state administration after the Supreme Court directed it on July 14 to provide land near the mosque, to which access is denied to the Muslim community now.

The namaz was held at the new site amid heavy police deployment. With rain turning the open ground into slush, the administration laid tarpaulin sheets over it, levelled parts of the land and erected barricades around the area.

Abdul Samad, a representative of the Kamal Maula Welfare Society, said they “did not



Muslims offer Friday prayers on the premises of a dargah adjacent to the disputed Bhojshala Complex in Dhar, Madhya Pradesh. PTI

face any difficulty in reading the namaz” and the prayers were peaceful. However, he added, the field requires significant infrastructure if it is to become a regular prayer site.

“Levelling needs to be done. We need a dry spot, access roads, water facilities and waterproof tents. We need a ceiling,” Samad said, adding that if more ground was available, above 500 people could offer namaz together here. “Today, the devotees spilled over into the mud and crops.”

There was tension when some local residents objected to the prayers, claiming ownership of the land. “They have been asked to produce their papers,” Samad said.

The protesters included residents of Vikram Nagar, who alleged that the land on which namaz was offered was privately owned and had been cultivated by their families for generations. Pushpa Bijwa said the administration had arrived without prior notice. “This is our father's and grandfather's

land. Why should we let them offer namaz?,” she said.

Another resident, Chandrakant Devda, claimed the land belonged to three members of his family and was their primary source of livelihood. “We will not allow prayers to be offered here.”

Sub-Divisional Magistrate Rajkumar Halidar and other officials reached the spot to ensure there was no trouble due to the protests. They assured the residents that their objections would be heard, following which the protesters dispersed and the namaz proceeded under police supervision.

“The Kamal Maula Mosque is visible from this land. That is why we agreed to offer namaz here,” Samad said, adding that both the community and the administration would abide by any future interim or final orders passed by the Supreme Court.

Before the order upholding the Bhojshala complex as Hindu, under an arrangement framed by the Archaeological Survey of India in 2003, Hindus were permitted to perform puja there on Tuesdays while Muslims offered Friday namaz at the Kamal Maula Mosque.

Allahabad HC judge recuses self from hearing bail

Bhupendra Pandey
Lucknow, July 31

OBSERVING THAT the incident marked a “black day in the history of the court”, Justice Krishan Pahal of the Allahabad High Court has recused himself from hearing dozens of bail pleas after litigants attempted to approach the judge during the pendency of the matters.

The single-judge bench of Justice Pahal was hearing one of the 75 bail applications of the accused lodged in jail since 2025 facing multiple cases in the al-

leged cough syrup smuggling racket, originating from UP and spread across various states and nations bordering India.

Remarking that such conduct strikes at the very heart of judicial independence, the judge directed that all the 75 pleas be placed before the Chief Justice of Allahabad HC for assignment to an appropriate bench.

The remarks came while the court was hearing the bail application of Bhola Prasad Jaiswal, father of the fugitive kingpin of the codeine-based syrup racket Shubham Jaiswal.

The court stated in its order passed on July 30, “...this Court had fixed all the matters to be heard today finally and order might have been delivered at a later point of time. Subsequently, efforts were made by the litigating parties to secure access to and approach the Presiding Judge. Such conduct, if permitted to pass unnoticed, strikes at the very heart of judicial independence and erodes public confidence in the purity of the adjudicatory process.”

The bench of Justice Pahal observed, “This Court records,

with profound anguish and an abiding sense of institutional responsibility, that the present episode marks a black day in the history of this Court. The very edifice of the judicial institution rests upon the unwavering confidence of the public that justice is administered impartially, fearlessly, and without any extraneous influence. Any attempt, however subtle or clandestine, to interfere with or influence the judicial decision-making process constitutes a direct assault upon the majesty of the Rule of Law.”

Goa protests: CM says ‘won’t allow any anti-national movement’

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, July 31

DAYS AFTER the Goa Police questioned two activists who had attended a recent protest in the coastal state against the NEET paper leaks, Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant told *The Indian Express* that “none would be allowed to run an anti-national movement”. One of those detained allegedly carried a “Free Umar Khalid” poster.

The activists, who joined a protest in Mapusa on July 24, were asked by the police to fill a questionnaire, The Indian Express reported on Thursday.

On the sidelines of the National Conclave for Goan Architecture and Sustainability, Sawant, when asked about the interrogation, said, “*Ek hi baat kahoonga main. Ko anti-national movement ko chalaaye to nahin chalega. Humne aur kisi ko arrest nahin kiya hai. Jo anti-national movement Goa mein chalana chaah rahe the iss protest ke sahaare unheeen ko arrest kiya hai* (I will say only one thing. If someone wants to run an anti-national movement, it won't work. We haven't arrested anyone else. We have arrested only those who were trying to run an anti-national movement in Goa on the back of this protest).”

Asked about the “Free Umar Khalid” placard, he said, “It is the same thing. That is why we have arrested them.” The activists were detained and questioned, but were not arrested and charged.

The Goa CM said that “everyone has a right to protest; if there is an issue, people will protest”. Asserting that “we have never said no to that”, Sa-



Goa CM Pramod Sawant

want insisted that “the cause of the protest has to be identified”.

On the evening of July 25, the day after the protest, the Goa Police detained a man for allegedly carrying a “Free Umar Khalid” placard at Panaji's Azad Maidan. At least two were summoned — one on July 26 and the other on July 27 — and questioned by the police, based on an “application” submitted by a local group called “Citizens of Mapusa”.

They were also made to fill a police questionnaire that included at least 240 questions, including: “Who was leading the protest?; Are you a member of any WhatsApp, Telegram or Signal group related to the protest?; How did you travel to the venue?; What did you intend to achieve through the protest?; and Are you associated with any political party, social organisation, student organisation, NGO or activist group?”

Many of the questions were about Khalid, an activist and a JNU alumnus who is facing charges of criminal conspiracy under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act in connection with the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots.

Blinded by pellets in 2016, J&K woman gets her Rs 41-lakh due

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, July 31

A DAY after the J&K government approved the release of compensation in her favour, Insha Mushtaq, one of Kashmir's youngest pellet victims from the 2016 unrest, said that the weapon “should never be used anywhere in India because pellets destroy lives”.

Insha was 15 when she was blinded, three days after the killing of Hizbul Mujahideen's Burhan Wani. There were protests in her village of Sedow, and she had opened the window of her home to see the commotion outside when scores of pellets hit her face. She also suffered fractures to her face and skull.

An LPG distributorship was sanctioned in her favour in 2018, but the funds were not released as the PDP-BJP government fell and soon after, the Assembly was dissolved.

“Justice delayed but not denied. Insha Mushtaq lost her eyesight to pellets in 2016; her LPG distributorship was sanctioned in 2018 but left incomplete. Under Chief Minister Omar Abdullah, we have approved the release of the Rs 41.16 lakh balance to finally

take this case to its logical conclusion,” J&K Food and Civil Supplies minister Satish Sharma announced.

On Friday, Sharma told *The Indian Express* that when the assistance was announced for Insha during the previous government, about Rs 20 lakh had been released to her for this agency, but the balance of over Rs 41 lakh has been cleared just now. “This was not done under any government scheme or programme; we have made special provision for her,” he said.

“Pellets should never be used anywhere in India because they destroy lives...” Insha said Friday. She said that thousands have suffered like her in Kashmir and “pellets should be banned.” Having undergone a lot of difficulties adjusting to a new life without her sight, Insha said, “I used to think I would not be able to do anything with my life. God helped me, and my parents motivated me to push forth in life.”

In 2018, Insha cleared her Class 10 exam with the help of a scribe. She is currently in the final year of her bachelor's degree. “I fought this over the last ten years, and it was a struggle, but now I am grateful for where I am,” she said.

{GENERAL VN SHARMA • 1930-2026}

Ex-Army Chief who oversaw IPKF withdrawal from Lanka

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, July 31

GENERAL VISHWA Nath Sharma (ret'd), who led the Army from 1988 to 1990, died in New Delhi on Friday. He was 96. A cavalry officer, the General is known to have refused to carry out a withdrawal of forces facing the Chinese Army in the Wangdung crisis — also called the Sumdorong Chu stand-off of 1987-88 — while serving as Eastern Army Commander.

Known in Army circles as ‘Tich’ Sharma, the veteran officer will be cremated at Brar Square Crematorium in Delhi Cantonment at 10.30 am on Saturday.

In 1987, Gen Sharma replaced Lt Gen J K Puri as Eastern Army Commander when the stand-off with China in the Wangdung area was already in

progress. Lt Gen Puri, who was six months senior to Gen Sharma, proceeded as Vice Chief of Army Staff. Lt Gen N S Narahari was General Officer Commanding (GOC) 4 Corps, and he was the commander who was dealing with the area where the Chinese had made an ingress.

In an interview to Maj Gen Nilendra Kumar on YouTube for the channel ‘Lex Consilium Foundation’ in 2025, Gen Sharma had said the Army Headquarters had laid down a limit of patrolling on the Line of Actual Control (LAC) because they did not want to provoke a war with China. “This limit was 15 km as set by Rajiv Gandhi's government,” he said.

“I had visited Narahari's Corps at the time and flew over the entire area in question in a helicopter, including the places



General Vishwa Nath Sharma

where the Chinese had made an ingress. So I straightaway gave the orders, ‘no withdrawal’,” he said.

When this order was relayed to Army HQs, Gen Sharma got a call from the then Director General Military Operations (DGMO) Lt Gen Bipin Joshi, who later became the Army

Chief. “He said, ‘Sir, you are disobeying the orders of the Government of India’. So I said, ‘This is not disobedience of orders; your orders themselves are incorrect. Under the Army Act, I am only supposed to obey the lawful command of the superior officer’. Then the Chief (Gen K Sundarji) called me up and said, ‘This is ridiculous’. I said, ‘Go to the Supreme Court and check if it is lawful’,” he said.

The strong military response by India in the crisis eventually led to the stand-off getting resolved, and the armies of the two countries moved back under mutual agreement.

As Army Chief, Gen Sharma oversaw the orderly withdrawal of the Indian Peace Keeping Force (IPKF) from Sri Lanka.

While serving as Additional Director General Military Oper-

ations (ADGMO) in the Military Operations (MO) Directorate, Gen Sharma had advised the then Army Chief General A S Vaidya in 1984 that they should not get involved in any operation to flush out Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale and his supporters from the Golden Temple as it was a political move.

Born on June 4, 1930, he hailed from a distinguished military family. Son of late Major General Amar Nath Sharma, he was commissioned in 16 Light Cavalry and commanded 66 Armoured Regiment. The family hails from Dadh Village in Kangra district of Himachal Pradesh.

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh condoled his demise and said, “A distinguished military leader, General Sharma served the Nation with unwavering dedication, courage and honour.”

Express News Service
Bhopal, July 31

A FATHER watched helplessly as his 21-year-old son gasped for breath and died in his lap after the oxygen supply in the government ambulance transporting him to a hospital allegedly ran out midway in Madhya Pradesh's Mandla district. The death has triggered allegations of gross negligence, with the district administration ordering a four-member inquiry.

The deceased, Ajit Baraiya, a resident of Sunhera Mal village under Bamhani police station limits, had been suffering from chronic kidney disease and was undergoing regular dialysis at Mandla District Hospital.

According to his family, Ajit's condition deteriorated on July 27, following which he was taken to the Community

Health Centre (CHC), Bamhani. Doctors there reportedly placed him on oxygen support before referring him to Mandla District Hospital for advanced treatment.

His family alleges that the 108 ambulance arrived nearly an hour after it was called, despite repeated requests stressing the patient's critical condition and need for oxygen support. They further claim that although the ambulance initially had oxygen, the cylinder was exhausted during the journey.

Speaking after the incident, Ajit's father broke down while recounting his son's final moments. “My son struggled for every breath until we reached Mandla and then died. If oxygen had been available, my son would still be alive. The ambulance came almost an hour after we called. I kept telling

them he urgently needed oxygen. I was even ready to arrange an oxygen cylinder from Bamhani myself,” he said.

The family has also alleged that despite Ajit's worsening condition, their request to reschedule his dialysis was not accommodated.

Mandla Collector Rahul Namdev ordered a four-member inquiry committee to investigate the circumstances surrounding the death. The committee, comprising doctors and a revenue department officer, had been instructed to submit its findings at the earliest.

Officials said the inquiry would also examine the maintenance, functioning and operational protocols of the 108 ambulance service, including if mandatory checks of oxygen cylinders were carried out before the van was dispatched.



CHHATTISGARH

TRANSFORMING GOVERNANCE THROUGH TRANSPARENCY & TECHNOLOGY

Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai is leading Chhattisgarh towards a future driven by transparency, innovation and inclusive development. Through governance reforms, digital transformation, renewable energy investments and flagship welfare programmes like the Mahtari Vandan Yojana, the State is empowering citizens, attracting investments and delivering efficient public services. Chhattisgarh today stands as a model of accountable governance and sustainable progress.



REFORMING GOVERNANCE, ACCELERATING GROWTH



- Department of Good Governance & Convergence established to drive policy coordination and administrative excellence.
- E-Governance & e-Office systems transforming government functioning through faster, paperless and transparent administration.
- Atal Dashboard enabling real-time monitoring of government programmes and service delivery.
- Chief Minister's Good Governance Fellowship engaging young professionals in governance and public policy innovation.
- CM Helpline 1076 strengthening responsive, citizen-centric grievance redressal.

REVENUE & REGISTRATION REFORMS

- 119 Registration Offices transforming to modern Smart Registration Centres.
- Geo-referencing of land records helping prevent disputes and improve property management.
- Simplified property registration through 10 landmark reforms and the Sugam App, making services faster and more convenient.
- Forest Rights Titles (Patta) granting ownership rights and securing livelihoods for eligible beneficiaries

EASE OF DOING BUSINESS

- First State to implement Jan Vishwas 2.0, reinforcing trust-based governance.
- Invest Chhattisgarh Portal offering single-window, one-click approvals for faster investment clearances.
- Startup & Innovation Policy 2025-30 fostering entrepreneurship and a vibrant innovation ecosystem.
- Recognised as a "High Performer" among landlocked States/UTs in the LEADS 2025



rankings by the Government of India.

DIGITAL PUBLIC SERVICE DELIVERY

- 6,000+ Atal Panchayat Digital Suvudha Kendras expanding digital access to government services in rural areas.
- 650+ citizen services available online through the Sewa Setu Portal.
- Fully digital temporary electricity connection process ensuring faster and hassle-free service delivery.

TRANSPARENCY & ACCOUNTABILITY

- Government procurement through the GeM Portal promoting efficiency and transparency.
- Fair & transparent recruitment strengthened by stringent anti-cheating laws.
- Digital mineral transit pass system enhancing accountability in mineral transportation.
- Transparent e-auctions of timber and mineral blocks ensuring fairness and maximising public value.

POWERING CHHATTISGARH'S GREEN FUTURE WITH RENEWABLE ENERGY

- SUBSIDY OF UP TO ₹1.08 LAKH FOR INSTALLING SOLAR PANELS:** In Chhattisgarh, the central and state governments are jointly providing a total subsidy of up to ₹1.08 lakh for installing solar panels on rooftops under the 'Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana'. This scheme enables households to receive up to 300 units of free electricity per month, effectively bringing the electricity bill down to zero. For the installation of a solar plant with a capacity of up to 3 kW, a total financial benefit of up to ₹1,08,000 is available; this comprises up to ₹78,000 from the central government and additional assistance from the state government (such as up to ₹30,000 in certain cases). A



provision of ₹400 crore has been made in the current budget for this scheme. Under the scheme, solar panels have been installed in more than 76,000 homes so far.

- ₹11,155 CRORE GREEN INVESTMENT:** Four renewable energy projects with a combined capacity of 8,300 MW approved, attracting investments of ₹11,155 crore.

- 6,700 JOBS TO BE CREATED:** Renewable energy initiatives expected to generate nearly 6,700 direct and indirect employment opportunities.
- POWERING TOMORROW:** Expansion of solar and pumped storage infrastructure to meet rising energy demand while positioning Chhattisgarh as a clean, sustainable and energy-secure growth hub.

MAHTARI VANDAN YOJANA

EMPOWERING EVERY WOMAN, STRENGTHENING EVERY FAMILY

- ₹1,000 Every Month:** Around 68.5 lakh eligible married women receive ₹1,000 every month directly into their bank accounts, ensuring financial security and dignity.
- ₹18,800 Crore Direct Benefit:** Over ₹18,800 crore has been transferred through 29 instalments, making it one of Chhattisgarh's largest women-centric welfare initiatives.
- ₹8,200 Crore Budget Support:** A dedicated allocation of ₹8,200 crore underscores the Government's commitment to women's economic empowerment.
- Promoting Self-Reliance:** Women are using the assistance to start small businesses, support their children's education and strengthen household incomes.
- Empowering Families & Communities:** The scheme has enhanced women's financial independence and decision-making, while inspiring community initiatives such as the construction of a Lord Ram Temple in Danasra village.



epaper.indianexpress.com



BENEFICIARY

The financial assistance I receive every month gave me the confidence to start a small bangle business. It has not only increased my income but also strengthened my family's financial security.

-Mrs. Meena Dewangan,
Balodabazar District

The monthly assistance has helped me pay my children's school fees without financial stress. This support has made a meaningful difference in securing their education and our family's future.

-Mrs. Saroj,
Raipur District

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,Abida Begum w/o Mohd Saleem,R/o 6299 Gali Marwadi Nawab Road, Sadar Bazar,Delhi-110006,have changed my name to Abida Saleem. 0040869360-6

I,ILma PARVEEN D/o Mohd.Salim R/o-14-B/1, 4Th.Floor, Gali No.7-A,Vijay Mohalla,Maujpur, Delhi-110053,have changed my name to ILMA for all purposes 0040869252-1

I, AJAY KUMAR PANDEY C/o RP Pandey, T/301, Akroti Township, Narol, Ahmedabad, Gujarat-382405, have changed my name to AJAY PANDEY. 0071051408-1

I,Lakshya sharma S/o Sanjeev sharma R/o 0-65 vans vihar uttam nagar new delhi-110059 have changed my name to Lakshya. 0040869356-2

I,Dharmendra Jain S/O Dhanpal Jain R/O. 78C, Metro Apartment, Near Sai Mandir, Sector-71, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301 have changed my name From DHARMENDRA JAIN to DHARMENDRA KUMAR JAIN for all future Purposes. 0071051231-1

I, YOGESH KUMAR BHARTI S/O Matadin Bharti, C-311, Camp No-4, Jwalapur, Sunder Vihar, Delhi-87 have changed my name to YOGESH BHARTI. 0071051375-1

I,Manju,W/o-Raj Kumar Kukreja & D/o Jai Kishan Verma Resident of West Delhi-18,have changed my name to Manju Kukreja,for all purposes 0040869349-10

I,Charat Lal Aggarwal,S/O late,Parasram Aggarwal,R/O-39 Model Town Rewari-123401 have changed my name to CHARAT AGGARWAL Permanently 0040869356-11

I,ASHMA W/o Mohd Alam R/O T H 123 S M-Shastri Mohalla, Patparganj, Delhi-110091,have changed my name to AISHA. 0040869360-8

I Parth S/o Anil Kumar Singh resident of B-460, GNA- 2, Gaur City 2, G. Noida West, UP, change my name to Parth Singh. 0130067468-1

I, Mukesh Kumar Bhakta alias Mukesh Bhagat S/o Rameshwari Bhagat R/o Kh No 7/12,Gali No 12, Block D, Kamal Vihar, Kamal Pur, Burari, North Delhi-110084, havechanged my name to Mukesh Bhagat. 0071051409-1

I,KAVITA BUDHIRAJA,w/o PRAVEEN KUMAR BUDHIRAJA R/O A-94-U FLOOR BLOCK-A VIVEK VIHAR-1 SHAHDARA, DELHI -110095,have changed my name to KAVITA. 0040869356-4

I,Firoz Qureshi S/o Mohammad Yaqoob R/O-1113, Masjid Teliyan, Sohrab Gate, Meerut have changed my name to Mohammad Firoz Bhura Qureshi. 0071051232-1

I,Ram Chabila S/o Sh. Chalit Ram R/o,H.No.326,Block-U,Prem Nagar-2, Kirari Suleman Nagar, Delhi-110086,declare that name of mine and my wife wrongly mentioned in my Son's (Love Kumar) school record as Ram Chhabila Yadav and Babita Devi. The actual name of mine and my wife are Ram Chabila and Vinita Devi for all purposes. 0040869285-1

I,Shanta mother of Shrikant Patil presently residing at Vill- Kurihal, Post-Kurihal,Teh-Belagavi, Distt.Belagavi, State-Karnataka,Pin-591143,have changed my name from Shanta to Shanta Yallappa Patil. 0040869349-1

I, MOHD SHAKIR ANSARI S/O TAHIR HUSSAIN, residing at 1/11414 C, GALI No.10, SUBHASH PARK EXTN. SHAHDARA NORTH EAST DELHI 110032, have changed my name to SHAKIR HUSAIN, vide affidavit dated 27/07/2026 at DELHI. 0050294131-1

I,KUNDAN KUMAR TIWARI, resident of,RZ-11B,Rajnagar Part-I,Palam-110045,New-Delhi,have changed my daughter's name from ANUKRITI to ANUKRITI TIWARI,vide-affidavit dated 29-07-2026. 0040869365-4

I,ANJANA KUMARI D/O AJMEL SINGH R/O ANJU GENERAL STORE BANGANA UNA HIMACHAL PRADESH-174307, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ANJANA. 0040869360-1

I,MOHD AZEEM,S/O-ALLAUDDIN, R/O-3604,IST FLOOR KATRA DEENA,BAIG NEAR-HAMDARD, DAWA KHANA LAL-KUAN, DELHI-6,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD AZEEM ANSARI 0040869360-11

I,JAYRAM S/O-BAIJNATH R/O-PILOT NO.-20,2ND FLOOR, RIGHT SIDE,BLOCK-B1, SANJAY ENCLAVE,UTTAM NAGAR,Delhi-110059 have changed my name to JAYRAM JAISWAL 0040869349-5

I,Meenakshi,D/o Radha Sharma,R/o-1/3-D,Street No.7, East Azad-Nagar,Krishna Nagar,Delhi-110051,have changed my name,from Meenakshi to Meenakshi Verma for all future purpose. 0040869356-6

I Sunder Singh S/o Vijay Pal Singh, R/o H.No. A-395/1, Street No.1, Ambedkar Basti, Brahmapur, North East Delhi-110053 have changed the name of my minor son from Krishna Rathl alias Shivang Choudhary to Shivang Choudhary for all purposes. 0040869253-2

I,Allamehar S/o Hafijuddin R/o 369/GH, Patahankot, Baraut, Baghpatt, UP have changed my name to Alla Mahar. 0071051233-1

I,Yallappa father of Shrikant Patil presently residing at Vill-Kurihal, Post-Kurihal,Teh-Belagavi, Distt.Belagavi, State-Karnataka,Pin-591143,have changed my name from Yallappa to Yallappa Kallappa Patil. 0040869349-3

I, Kiran W/o Tilak Raj R/o 3013/F-2, Gali No-16, Ranjeet Nagar, Delhi-110008, have changed my name to Kiran Bala for all future purposes. 0040869277-1

I, SUNIL KUMAR SHARMA S/O SURESH CHAND SHARMA R/O 179/8, GALI NO.-1, PADAM NAGAR, KISHAN GANJ, DELHI-110007 HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR DAUGHTER NAME FROM PRAGYA KAUSHIK TO PRAGYA SHARMA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071051221-1

I, Ghanshyam S/o Gopal Dass R/o H.No. 400, Sector 8, Faridabad have changed my name to Ghanshyam Binani. 0040869360-3

I,MOHAN S/O LAL JI SINGH,R/O VILLAGE-CHILLA SARODA KHADAR,MAYUR VIHAR Phase-1,DELHI-110091,have changed,my name to MOHAN SINGH for,all future,purposes. 0040869365-1

I, RATHAN GOLDAR S/o Narendran Nath Goldar, B-2-656, JJ Colony, Madanpur Khadar, Delhi-110076 have changed my name to RATAN GOLDAR. 0071051351-1

I,RAKESH KUMAR ARORA,S/o Shri Chand Arora R/o House No-92,First Floor,Pocket-8,Sector-21,Rohini,Pooth Kalan Delhi-110086 have changed my name to RAKESH ARORA. 0040869349-7

I,MUSKAN GUPTA,W/O-AAKASH GARG,R/O-T-6/802,PARSVNATH REGELIA,RAJ BAGH SAHIBABAD, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH U.P.-201005 have changed My Name To MUSKAN GARG permanently. 0040869356-8

I Himanshu S/o Mukesh Kumar R/o WZ-15, Om Vihar Phase-1, Shiv Shankar Road, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059 have changed my name to Himanshu Rajput for all purposes. 0040869253-1

I,hitherto known as KISLAY MISHRA,S/O-ARVIND MISHRA, R/O,Flat.No. S-4, Plot.No.212, Sector-6, Vaishali,Ghaziabad U.P.201010,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as KAUSTUBH MISHRA. 0040869360-5

I,Kola Jayalaxmi Is Legal Dependent M/O Gs Rao R/o Presently Residing At T 16/103, AFSSR, Gurugram 122001 Have Changed My Name From Kola Jayalaxmi To Kola Jayalakshmi Vide Affidavit Dt 12-05-2026 Before High Court Delhi 0040869268-1

I, Sahab Husain Ansari S/o Akhtar Ansari R/o F-221, First Floor, Madipur Colony,Paschim Vihar, West Delhi, 110063 have changed my name to Sahab Hussain for all future purposes 0071051339-1

I, Anisha Taneja D/o Prem Sagar Taneja W/o Vikas Sibal R/O A-503 5/F Plot No 1439-40 Ahinsha Vatika Ram Nagar Loni Road Shahdara North East Delhi-110032, have changed my name to Anisha Sibal 0071051407-1

I,HARPREET PAL SINGH CHAUHAN,HOUSE.NO.99,SAVIT A VIHAR,NEAR SAI MANDIR, DELHI-110092,have changed my minor daughter name MEHAR KAUR to MEHAR KAUR CHAUHAN. 0040869356-1

I,Indra Kumar Maheshwari S/o Deo Kishan Bhatler R/o 23-A, Kalakar Street, Kolkata, West Bengal-700007, have changed my name to Indra Kumar Bhatler 0071051213-1

I Hari Prem, S/o Late Sh. Sant Lal Sharma, R/o A-1/26, Sector-14, Prashant Vihar, Delhi-110085 is also known as Hari Prem Sharma and Hari Prem Parashar. All names are of one and the same person. 0040869253-3

I,Kuldeep Mane,S/o-Laxman Mane,R/O-D2/602,BPCL-Housing Complex,Sector-56,Noida,Gautam-Buddha-Nagar,U.P.201301,have changed my name KULDEEP MANE to KULDEEP LAXMAN MANE,for all,future,purposes. 0040869365-3

I,Jebru Nisha W/o MD Abbas R/o H-13/23, Sangam Vihar, Humdard Nagar, Delhi- 110062 have changed my name to Jaibun Nisha. 0071051371-1

I,Shankar Shah S/o Late Sukhal Sah R/o 997A, Gali No-09,Nehru Nagar,Delhi-110008 changed my name to Shankar Sah 0040869349-9

I,Shant Kaur Batra,W/o-Late Sh.Mohinder Singh Batra,R/o-T-13,Near Janta-Market,Rajouri-Garden,New-Delhi-110027, declare that Mahender Singh Batra and Mohinder Singh Batra,are the names of one and the same-person. 0040869356-10

I,SHABINA BEGUM,W/O-MOHD AZEEM ANSARI,R/O-3604 IST-FLOOR KATRA DEENA BAIG NEAR-HAMDARD,DAWA KHANA LAL-KUAN DELHI-6,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SHABEENA BEGUM 0040869360-7

I,SHIVA KUMARI W/o Nishant Kumar, RZ-520B, Raj Nagar-1, Palam Colony, Delhi-45 have changed my name to SHIVA AGGARWAL. 0071051368-1

I,Nitu Dwivedi w/o Amrish Dwivedi r/o G- 156, Govindpuram, Ghaziabad UP-201013, have Changed my name to Nitu Amrish Dwivedi for all future purposes. 0071051224-1

I,Manvendra Pal Singh R/o, B-143, Second Floor, Sector-2, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201010 declare that my name mentioned in my minor daughter Akansha Bhadana's school records as Manvendra Bhadana but correct name is Manvendra Pal Singh which may be amended accordingly. 0040869256-1

I, SONIA RAHTI S/o Ajit Singh, A-2741, Greenfield Colony, NHPC Colony, Faridabad -121010, have changed my name to SONIA MAHALWAL. 0071051383-1

I,Manoj Kumar Dubey,S/o H.P.Dubey R/o RZ-F-A-276,Raj Nagar-II,Palam Colony,New Delhi-110077,have wrongly mentioned my name as Manoj Dubey in the school records and other ID of my son Nikhil Dubey. My actual name is Manoj Kumar Dubey and Manoj Kumar Dubey alias Manoj Dubey both are same and one person 0040869349-11

I, Ruchika, wife of Mohit Deswal, have changed my name to Ruchika Deswal after my marriage, vide Affidavit dated 23.07.2026. Henceforth, I shall be know and identified as Ruchika Deswal for all legal and official purposes. 0040868606-1

I,ATUL KUMAR S/o RAMESH CHANDRA R/O 10,SHIKHA APARTMENT,I,EXTENSION, PATPARGANJ,DELHI-110092 have changed my name to ATUL AGGARWAL Permanently 0040869356-12

I,Ashwini Kumar Singh,S/O-Vinod Kumar Singh,R/o-Flat.no.G.1601,Tower-G,Arihant Arden,Sector-1,Bisrakh,Gautam Budh Nagar,U.P.-201306,have changed my name to Ashwini Singh 0040869360-9

I, RAJ KUMAR BIDHURI S/O Roomal Singh, 58/185, Bhangar Mohalla, Madanpur Khadar, Sarita Vihar, Delhi-76, have changed my name to RAJ KUMAR. 0071051411-1

I,NEHA SETH,W/O BIPIN BHANDARI,R/O H.No-1665 sector-28 Faridabad-121008, have changed my name to NEHA BHANDARI 0040869356-5

I, Amrish Dwivedi s/o Yogesh Chandra Dwivedi, r/o G- 156, Govindpuram, Ghaziabad, UP-201013, have changed my name to Amrish Yogesh Chandra Dwivedi for all future purposes. 0071051223-1

I, Anchal Garg W/o Mr. Apurv Garg, R/o A-111 , Prashant Vihar , Sector-14, Rohini, Delhi-110085, hereby declare that my correct name is Anchal Garg. I confirm that Anchal Lohia and Anchal Garg are one and the same person. 0040869262-1

I,Rajashwari wife of Shrikant Patil presently residing at Vill-Kurihal, Post-Kurihal,Teh-Belagavi, Distt.Belagavi, State-Karnataka, Pin-591143,have changed my name from Rajashwari to Rajeshwari Shrikant Patil. 0040869349-2

I,SUNIL KUMAR SHARMA S/O SURESH CHAND SHARMA R/O 179/8, GALI NO.-1, PADAM NAGAR, KISHAN GANJ, DELHI-110007 HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR SON NAME FROM CHIRAG KAUSHIK TO CHIRAG SHARMA FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES. 0071051222-1

I,Ruby Seth,D/O Late Mr.Ram Partap Seth, Resident of,47/2,East Patel-Nagar,Patel-Nagar, New Delhi-110008,is the same name of Rashmi Gosain,W/o-Satish Gosain &D/O-Late Mr.Ram Partap Seth is a same name. Ruby Seth is my nick name so both are my name Ruby Seth and Rashmi Gosain 0040869252-2

I,Daman Paul alias Daman Paul Kaur alias Daman Paul Kaur Bhatia W/o Ajay SardanaR/o D-118 Block-D Saket New Delhi South Delhi-110017, have changed my name toDaman Sardana. 0071051417-1

I,MONIKA SANGWAN,w/o RAJESH,H.No-E-58, WARD NO-9 Sector-35,SUNCITY ROHTAK HARYANA-124001, have changed my name to MONIKA HOODA 0040869356-3

I,Sameena Afroz,W/o-Meraj Ahmad, Address-F-130/2, Block-F,Abul Fazal ENC Part-2,Shahin Bagh,Okhla,Delhi-110025,have changed my name from Sameena Afroz to Samina Afroz. 0040869360-2

I,KUMARI SHURUTI GUSAIN D/o Rajnish Kumar Gusain, 4, FF, Type-3, Block-74, MB Road, Sector-1, Pushp Vihar, Malviya Nagar, Delhi-110017, have changed my name to SHURUTI GUSAIN. 0071051345-1

I,SURBHI GOGIA W/o Sahil Khurana,R/o House No-12,Upper Ground Floor,Block-BN West, Shalimar Bagh,Delhi-110088 have changed my name to SURBHI KHURANA 0040869349-6

I,PANKAJ KUMAR MAHESHWARI,S/O-TRILOK CHAND MAHESHWARI,R/O B-32 new-Multan nagar,Rohtak road,Delhi-110056 have changed my name to PANKAJ MAHESHWARI 0040869349-4

I,Mandeep Saluja W/o Gurkirat Singh Sethi, R/o B-610, Dreamland The Willows, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP-201016, have changed my name to Mandeep Kaur Sethi for all future purposes. 0071051220-1

PUBLIC NOTICE
The General Public is hereby informed that my client Mr. Ramrhi Karojpeya S/o Shri Sardar Karojpeya Rio H. No. 184, Near Chawla Hotel, J. J. Colony, Okhla Phase-2, Okhla Industrial Estate New Delhi-110020 has disowned his partners Ramtej Karojpeya & Daughter-in-law Ranjana Devi & his Grand Daughters Shresh, Jahan & Mahina from all his movable & immovable properties and have severed all his relations with them on account of their immoral conduct & improper physical & mental coules with him. Anyone dealing or transacting with them shall be fully responsible for their acts & my client shall not be responsible for any of their acts in future.
Dharanvir Singh Chauhan (Advocate)
Ch. No. 322, Saket Court, New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE
Sale and Mortgage of Plot/Property Bearing No. C-1/186 (Plot No. 86, Block C-1), area measuring 126 Sq. Mtrs. in Block No. C-3, situated in the layout plan of Janak Puri (Pankha Road) Residential Scheme, at Janak Puri, New Delhi. (Herein after referred as the "said property"). Notice is hereby given to the General Public that my client(s) intends to purchase the above said property from (i) C. Kuruvilla, (ii) Jessica Kuruvilla, & (iii) Sherin Kuruvilla, who inherited the property after the demise of Late Susan Kuruvilla. That my client(s) is/are availing the loan to purchase the said property from Axis Bank Ltd. and the said property would be the security to the loan availed by them. If any person including banks, financial institutions or any other person, relative, organization, company, firm or government authority having any claim, right, title or any interest of any nature whatsoever into or upon the above-referred property, is hereby called upon to make the same known, in writing with documentary evidence by registered AD Post to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below within 10 days of publication of this notice to the undersigned failing which the same shall be deemed to have been waived and/or abandoned. In the event of no response being received to this notice, the purchase and further mortgage of this property shall be completed by our client and its client without any reference to and without in any manner being affected by any such right, title or interest or claim whatsoever.
MANISHA CHAUDHARY ADVOCATE
JUS LEGALIZ
210, VARDHMAN STAR CITY MALL, NEAR RAMPHAL CHOWK, SECT-7 DWARKA NEW DELHI-75. 911-45003163, 9899004723

"IMPORTANT"
Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

I,Aditya Singhal,S/o Shri.Sunil Kumar Singhal,R/O D-64,SF, Preet Vihar, East Delhi, Delhi-110092,inform that my,father name Sunil Singhal and Sunil Kumar Singhal,both names are same person. 0040869365-2

I,Mohammad Atir,S/o-Fariduddin R/O-2632 shamsi Cottage Churi walm Jama Masjid Delhi,has changed my name to Mohammed Atir,for all purpose 0040869349-8

I,hitherto known as Gurline Kaur,D/O-Ajit Singh,9/25, Subhash-Nagar,New Delhi-110027,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Gurleen Kaur. 0040869356-9

LOST & FOUND

We, ARNAV MANCHANDA,S/O LATE MR.DIVYABH MANCHANDA, R/O-F3/10, FIRST-FLOOR,VASANT VIHAR,NEW DELHI, MR.ARYAN HIRANYABH MANCHANDA AND MR.DYUTIMAY MANCHANDA, both,S/O LATE MR.AMITABH MANCHANDA, R/O-R-853,1ST-FLOOR,NEW-RAJINDER NAGAR, DELHI,have lost certain original documents, i.e. Building Plan Sanctioned, Form C, Form D, and Relinquishment Deed, pertaining to PROPERTY-NO-R-853, NEW-RAJINDER NAGAR, NEW DELHI. If found please contact us at 92050-57345. 0040869307-1

Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page

The Indian EXPRESS
JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

PUBLIC NOTICE
It is hereby informed that Shri Manish Tabbal and Smt. Ganga Tabbal have applied for a loan from LIC Housing Finance Ltd. (LIC HFL) for the purchase of DDA Bulrup Freehold Janta Flat No. 346-C, Second Floor, Block A-6, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110063. Smt. Ganga Tabbal is purchasing the aforesaid property from her husband, Shri. Manish Tabbal, who does not have the original (i) Allotment Letter dated 24.06.2002 and (ii) Possession Slip dated 24.12.1982, as the said original documents have been lost or misplaced. A FIR regarding the loss of the aforesaid documents was lodged on 25.07.2026. If any person has any right, title, interest, claim, lien, charge, objection, or demand of whatsoever nature in respect of the aforesaid property or the aforesaid lost original documents, he/she is requested to intimate the undersigned in writing, along with supporting documentary evidence, within 10 (Ten) days of the date of publication of this notice, failing which the same shall be deemed that no such claim exists, and the loan transaction shall proceed without any further reference to him/her. Any claim received hereafter shall be treated as waived and not binding on LIC Housing Finance Ltd. or the proposed purchaser. Sd/- SUBHASH GUPTA (Advocate) Bar. No. D-446/2002, 125, First Floor, ANAND NAGAR, INDERLOK, DELHI-110053

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.PC.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Salman Khan @ Putlu, S/o Salim Khan, H.No. 1488-D, Gali No. 13, Near Shiv Mandir, Govindpuri, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 249/2019, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Salman Khan @ Putlu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Salman Khan @ Putlu** accused of **FIR No. 249/2019, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.09.2026**.
By Order - Ms. Akansha Gautam Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 South-East District, Room No. 513 Saket Courts, New Delhi
DP/10566/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused persons Namely (1) **Ali Kaji S/o Nidhu Kaji R/o H. No. 69, Ambedkar Chappal Aali Gaon Delhi** (2) **Hakmat S/o Aaynal R/o H No 129 Ashish Ka Makan Ali Gaon Sarita Vihar Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 270/2018 U/s 420/34 IPC PS: Mandawali, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused (1) **Ali Kaji** (2) **Hakmat** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) **Ali Kaji** (2) **Hakmat** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said (1) **Ali Kaji** (2) **Hakmat** accused of **FIR No. 270/2018 U/s 420/34 IPC PS: Mandawali, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.09.2026**.
By Order Sh. Sachin JMFC-03, Room No-16 Karkardooma Court, Delhi
DP/10510/ED/2026 (Court Matter)

IBSAR Group of Colleges
IBSAR SCHOOL OF LAW
College Road, Sanjay Nagar, Dahivali, Karjat (W), Dist. - Raigad 410 201.

APPLICATIONS ARE INVITED FOR THE FOLLOWING POSTS FROM THE ACADEMIC YEAR 2026-27.

Sl. No.	Cadre	Subject	Total No. of Posts	Posts Reserved for
1.	Principal	---	01	01-OPEN
2.	Assistant Professor	Law	04	01-SC/ST, 01-DT(A), 01-0BC, 01-OPEN.
3.	Librarian	---	01	01-OPEN

The posts for the reserved category candidates will be filled in by the same category candidates (Domestic of State of Maharashtra) belonging to that particular category only.
Reservation for women will be as per University Circular No. BCC/16/74/1998 dated 10th March, 1998. 4% reservation shall be for the persons with disability as per University Circular No. Special Cell/ICC/2019-20/05 dated 05th July, 2019.
Candidates having knowledge of Marathi will be preferred.
"Qualification, Pay Scales and other requirement are as prescribed by the UGC Notification dated 18th July, 2018, Government of Maharashtra Resolution No. Misc-2018/C.R.56/18/UNI-1, dated 8th March, 2019 and University circular No. TAAS/CT/ICD/2018-19/1241, dated 26th March, 2019 and revised from time to time" The Government Resolution & Circular are available on the website mu.ac.in
Applicants who are already employed must send their application through proper channel. Applicants are required to account for breaks, if any in their academic career.
Applications with full details should reach to the EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR, IBSAR SCHOOL OF LAW, College Road, Sanjay Nagar, Dahivali, Karjat (W), Dist. Raigad 410 201. Within 15 days from the date of publication of this advertisement. This is University approved advertisement.
Sd/- EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (ii) Cr. P.C.
Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused Person Namely **Sandeep Dhunna R/o C-67, 2nd Floor, Soami Nagar, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi 2nd address: 56, Hemkunt Colony (Basement), New Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **CT. Case No. 4164/2020 U/s 138 NI Act.**, has been registered at **PS: CR Park, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Sandeep Dhunna** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Sandeep Dhunna** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Said, **Sandeep Dhunna of CT. Case No. 4164/2020 U/s 138 NI Act.**, has been registered at **PS: CR Park, New Delhi** and it has been required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.09.2026**.
By Order Ms. Shruti Sharma-LD. JMFC (NI-Act-02), Room No. 609 (Court Notice) (South-East Distt.), Saket Court, New Delhi
DP/9969/SD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sudhir Manothiya, S/o: Dayachand, R/o: Flat No-1513, Ground Floor, Gulabi Bagh, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 139/2019, U/s:419/420/465/467/468/471/34 IPC, P.S. Barakhamba Road, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sudhir Manothiya** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sudhir Manothiya** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sudhir Manothiya of P.S. Barakhamba Road, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.
By Order Ms. Vijayshree Rathore JMFC-05, Room No. 13, 1st Floor, Main Building, DP/10588/NDD/2026 Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Hayat @ Golu S/o Munir Khan R/o H.No. 632, Gali No. 26, Indra Chowk, Jafraabad, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 26/2022, U/S 392/394/397/411 IPC, PS Welcome, North-East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Hayat @ Golu** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Hayat @ Golu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that **Hayat @ Golu** the said accused of **FIR No. 26/2022, U/S 392/394/397/411 IPC, PS Welcome, North-East Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.09.2026**.
By Order Sh. Kumar Rajat Additional Session Judge-07, DP/10500/NE/2026 Room No.-61, 3rd Floor, Shahdara Distt., (Court Matter) Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nitin, S/o. Jai Bhagwan, R/o.: H.No. 148, Near Mansa Vidyaipath School, Bhorgarh, Narela, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **e-FIR No. 170/2023 Dt. 05.05.2023 U/S 379/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S Narela Industrial Area, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Nitin** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Nitin** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Nitin**, accused of **e-FIR No. 170/2023 Dt. 05.05.2023 U/S 379/411/34 IPC, P.S Narela Industrial Area, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.10.2026**.
By Order, Sh. Sahil Gupta, Judicial Magistrate First Class-II, North Room No. 06, Rohini Courts, Delhi.
DP/10594/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Namely: Rahul, S/o Basant Lal R/o C-31, Nanhe Park, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.422/2018 u/s 283 IPC, P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rahul** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rahul of FIR No.422/2018 u/s 283 IPC, P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.09.2026**.
By Order, Moksha Bains Judicial Magistrate First Class-II, West Court No.31, Tis Hazari Court, New Delhi
DP/10531/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Namely: Abdul Wahid, S/o. Md. Dildar, R/o.: C-715, Gali No.3, Chauhan Bangar, Near Rehmani Masjid, Delhi-110053** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **CT No. 3208/2019 registered at P.S Geeta Colony, Shahdara District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Abdul Wahid** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Abdul Wahid** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Abdul Wahid**, accused of **CT No.3208/2019, P.S Geeta Colony, Shahdara District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.09.2026**.
By Order, Sh. Sachin Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, East District, Court No.16, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.
DP/10578/SHD/2026 (Court Matter)

The Big Picture

SATURDAY, AUGUST 1, 2026

13



Rakshambika S, all of four, at the Tal Chess Club; at Chess Gurukul that has produced some of the country's top grandmasters; at Chess Thulir, players are locked in an intense game of chess. PHOTOGRAPHS BY AMIT KAMATH

Chennai's chess mates

INSIDE THE CLUBS THAT SHAPE GRANDMASTERS

From Viswanathan Anand to Gukesh D, Praggnanandhaa R, Vaishali R, Pranesh V and Aravindh Chithambaram, India's tally of chess grandmasters is now one short of 100. AMIT KAMATH travels to Chennai's chess clubs to see what goes into producing the world-beaters: precision, practice and long hours on the chess board

TONGUESTICKING out in concentration, she reaches for the piece she has set her sights on and poof... The hapless pawn has been captured, squashed like a bug.

Four-year-old Rakshambika S, kneeling on a plastic chair to be able to reach the far end of the chess board, is not a rated player yet. She still needs the occasional reminder to press the clock after making a move. But when she spots a vulnerable piece, her hand flashes out with a magician's sleight of hand. A soft clunk of plastic meeting plastic, and it's gone.

When she's about to lose, an older opponent offers a draw in a misplaced gesture of kindness. "No," she says defiantly, eyes searching for an explanation to why someone would settle for a draw when a win is on the board. "Do checkmate!" she orders.

Rakshambika is one of 65 students at Tal Chess Club, housed within the Russian Centre for Science and Culture in Chennai's Teynampet. The club is among the many that have played a part in shaping Chennai's reputation as chess capital, nurturing generations of grandmasters and prodigies.

Nearly four decades after Viswanathan Anand became India's first grandmaster, V S Rathnvel has brought the country within touching distance of the coveted 100-GM club. On July 18, the 25-year-old from Coimbatore, who has worked with many of the Chennai coaches, became India's 99th grandmaster.

Of India's 99 grandmasters, 38 are from Tamil Nadu, a majority of them based in Chennai and groomed in chess academies such as Tal. It's where the basic tenets of the sport are drilled into them: play fair, lose with grace, fight for every square inch on the board, and "do checkmate".

Many decades ago, it was at the Tal club that a bespectacled child, about to lose to Soviet grandmaster Vladimir Bagirov in an exhibition game, had been audacious enough to offer the legend a draw. The grandmaster had brushed aside the offer and won. The child turned out to be Viswanathan Anand.

"The Tal Chess Club in Madras was like a second home to me, a place I visited so often to play chess," Anand wrote on Instagram in 2024.

It was Manuel Aaron, India's first international master, who in 1971 started the club that he named after former world champion Mikhail Tal.

"When we started, the idea was to provide opportunities to budding chess players to play the sport, that too at a central place in the city. Not just to have a good time, but maybe also to produce top players," 90-year-old Aaron tells *The Indian Express* from his home in Chennai.

But the collapse of the Soviet Union was followed by a funding squeeze and the centre, then housed in the House of Soviet Culture, shut down in 1991. A couple of years ago, a few chess lovers approached Alexander Dodonov, Director of Russian House in Chennai, to start classes again.

At Tal club, catching 'em young

At the Tal club, there are 25 children who have turned up for the coaching session on a Thursday evening. Sivaranjani, the co-ordinator, informs that the club



Syed Emad, 8, is among the few rated players at the Tal club; (below) Manuel Aaron, India's first international master, who founded the Tal Chess Club in Chennai.



has 65 students spread across three batches through the week. An average session at the club has 30 minutes of students doing puzzles, 30 minutes for demonstration sessions and 30 minutes of the game.

The emphasis, Sivaranjani says, is on getting children to fall in love with chess and then, get them to gain some early competitive exposure through state-level or FIDE-rated tournaments.

All the 65 students at the club are "beginners" getting their first formal education in the sport, with the youngest three years old. Part of this cohort is eight-year-old Syed Emad, who can smell tactics from a mile away and walks with a pocketful of mischief. Syed is a rare rated player at the club — 1,604 in blitz and 1,565 in rapid.

Monish B, one of the five coaches at the club, says that when the club reopened its doors two years ago, it did so with around 25 students. "But after Gukesh became the world champion, lots of children started playing the sport," says Monish.

Grandmaster Srinath Narayanan, early-stage guru to India's top players Arjun Eri-

gaisi and Nihal Sarin, says Chennai's chess clubs cater to specific needs. If the Tal club is trying to catch them young and get them to fall in love with the sport, there are others where chess is looked at with a more competitive lens.

Grandmasters to world-beaters

As dusk descends on Chennai, a first floor house in T Nagar comes alive. Children march in, one by one, bags on their back, bouncing on the balls of their feet like they are here for a birthday party.

Before you know it, 15 children have gathered in the main hall. They sit across tables, 10 of them, their heads bowed in attention to the chess mats laid out in front of them. There's another room for the smaller children.

This club, Chess Gurukul, founded by Grandmaster R B Ramesh in 2008, holds a place in India's chess history. It was here that some of the country's top grandmasters — Praggnanandhaa R, Vaishali R, Aravindh Chithambaram and Pranesh V — were shaped into world-beaters.

Kunal M, a FIDE Master and an international master-elect, is coaching the group of 15 at Chess Gurukul today. At a time when conversations about chess are about how computers have altered preparation and training, the club adopts a conservative approach — there are 10 chess mats and just one laptop, which is used by

the coach.

The numbers that walk in through Chess Gurukul's doors are mind boggling. The academy has eight batches, each with 10 to 12 children, on weekends. Mondays and Wednesdays see four batches each, and another four Tuesdays and Thursdays. There are two more batches on Friday. Besides, there are hundreds of children who sign up with the academy for online training. The academy's 40 online batches cater to everyone from aspiring chess players to grandmasters.

Coach Kunal says the 15 in today's batch are an advanced set of players, many of them rated above 1,600. The range Indian chess has at its disposal is apparent when, on one side are children who can barely look over the head of the king on their board, while there are others who are already rated beyond 2,100.

The evening's session starts with Kunal reading out the move order of a historical game. As he does so, players recreate the game on their boards. Then, they are asked to guess which grandmasters played the game. It's a way to sharpen not just their calculation, but their grasp of history as well. Eventually, the players get down to the combat on the board. A big part of the session is spent in detailed analysis of the game.

"I value discipline from players. The focus is on effort over results. Children these days get too focussed on their FIDE rating," says Kunal.

Kunal is very particular about the skill he wants his young players to sharpen: calculation. It has almost become India's calling card in world chess. In an interview with *The Indian Express* in 2024, Magnus Carlsen was asked if he had spotted common traits in the different generations of Indians he has played with, from Anand to Gukesh and Praggnanandhaa. "Most players have supreme calculation skills," Carlsen had said.

A few years ago, Praggnanandhaa had revealed the kind of visualisation sessions he and his sister Vaishali would do in this T Nagar house that helped them trek their way to the top.

"We would recreate a position on the board and then start calculating from there. We would be past Move 15 but we would still have the pieces rooted in the same position on the board. We had to then visualise (the lines) in our mind. It was not just about visualisation alone, but also about finding good moves there. Those drills help us now when we are playing some complicated game and trying to calculate ahead," Praggnanandhaa had told *The Indian Express* in 2024.

Also in T Nagar is the Madras School of Chess, started by Vishnu Prasanna, the grandmaster who shaped world champion Gukesh. This academy has a second branch at Anna Nagar, with both branches together training around 100 players.

Mind games over a chess mat

Morning breaks over Periyar Nagar, a tree-lined residential neighbourhood in Chennai. Three young players sit facing their chess mats in a room on the first floor of a building. This is Chess Thulir, an academy started by grandmaster Shyam Sundar. The rest of their friends are currently playing in tournaments, some testing their chess chops with Shyam in Europe.

The room is silent except for the insistent tick-tick-tick of the wall clock. Their trainer, Hemanth Raam, has just started the day's session by reading out a position. It doesn't get re-created on the board. You can almost hear the 32 miniature soldiers yawn out of boredom; they haven't been moved at all.

But in the minds of the players facing the boards, there is a tick-tick-tick of another kind.

"Can someone repeat the position?" asks Hemanth. This, a blindfold chess activity to start

• WAITING IN THE WINGS

After Gukesh, Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali, meet some of the most promising grandmasters to have come out of Chennai:

ARAVINDH CHITHAMBARAM: At 26, he is half a decade older than Gukesh and Praggnanandhaa, but has recently started racking up eye-catching titles. Last year, Aravindh won the Prague Masters title and then pipped friend and Chess Gurukul-mate Praggnanandhaa to win the Stepan Avagyan Memorial event. He broke into the World Top 10 in 2025.

PRANESH M: Another product of RB Ramesh's Chess Gurukul, Pranesh won the Challengers section of the Chennai Grand Masters tournament last year. With a rating of 2,672, he needs just a few good tournaments to break into the 2,700-ratings club.

PRANAV VENKATESH: The reigning world junior chess champion has racked up titles in Salamanca Masters 2025 (rapid title), Fujairah Global Chess Championship 2025 (superstars section) and KazChess Masters 2026.

ILAMPARTHI AR: The 17-year-old won the Wroclaw Chess Festival last year and is India's 90th grandmaster.

SRIHARI LR: At the recent Commonwealth Chess Championship, 20-year-old Srihari, who became India's 86th grandmaster, won medals in all three formats, winning a bronze in classical, a silver in rapid and a bronze in blitz

the day, is what Hemanth calls a "warm up".

"For white, king f3, a4, b3, d5, f2, g4, h5. For black, king g8, a7, b6, f6, g5, h6. Black to play," Gurubaran R says without skipping a beat.

Gurubaran has been training at this academy, in the same room, for six months now. Ask him what the colour of the wall is, and he gets it wrong. But a chess position he has been told 30 seconds ago, he rattles off like it's his own phone number.

Footballers have their keepie-uppies, juggling socks and oranges when they want to show off their skills. Chess players just play without moving the pieces, the games rumbling in their mind.

The day's session started at 10.30 am, and will stretch on till 4.30 pm. It's International Chess Day today, but in these rooms, the only date that matters is the next tournament day.

The perpetually smiling and chatty Gurubaran is a 13-year-old who has touched a rating of 2,198 and only last August won the Group B section at the 25th Sant Marti Open in Barcelona. Joining him is 11-year-old Yakshini P, who says 10 words a session and that too, only when absolutely necessary — the perfect exponent of a sport that requires hours of meditative silence. She recently won the under-11 girls title at the School National Chess Championship and a silver in the Youth Asian Chess Series held in Bangkok. Joining them is 11-year-old Atul Gupta, who hails from Maastricht, the southernmost city in the Netherlands.

Gupta is not the only player who has travelled from abroad to learn at Chess Thulir. MA Sriyukthaa, rated 2,146 already at age 10, lives in Muscat, but will spend two months in Chennai for the offline camp.

"She has been doing online sessions with Chess Thulir for three years now. But we have also been flying down to Chennai every year, for around 20 to 30 days each time, so that she can join the offline session. This year, we will spend two months in Chennai because we have noticed drastic improvements in her playing," says Abi-rami, Sriyukthaa's mother.

Back at the centre, warm-up done, the players move to the grind of daily chess. Hemanth now replays a 2012 game between Magnus Carlsen (playing with white) and Viswanathan Anand. After announcing the first few moves, Hemanth stops and asks the three players to find the best candidate moves for white.

Ideas are thrown and refuted, heads are scratched. At one point, after enough candidate moves have been refuted, Atul, the 11-year-old from the Netherlands, suggests that they check with an engine what the best move is.

"Engines are not allowed in this class," says Gurubaran. "Gukesh *anna* did not use engines till he was almost a 2,700-rated player!"

It was at clubs like these that Gukesh and Praggnanandhaa once dreamt of becoming the next Anand. Now, there is a generation that is trying to retrace the path that Gukesh and Praggnanandhaa took to the top. Chennai's conveyor belt of chess keeps moving.

INDIA'S CHESS GLORY

38

years since India got its first grandmaster in Viswanathan Anand

99

Indian Grandmasters

38

of them are from Tamil Nadu

The Tal Chess Club in Madras was like a second home to me, a place I visited so often to play chess."

VISWANATHAN ANAND
IN 2024



READ. THINK. SHARE.
Scan the QR code to explore curated editorials and opinions from leading voices

America's tariff state is expanding. India must be patient



AJAY SRIVASTAVA

THERE IS a fundamental shift underway in US trade policy. After more than a year in which President Donald Trump relied mainly on executive powers to impose tariffs, the US Congress is now moving to strengthen and expand his tariff strategy through legislation.

The clearest example is the Russia sanctions Bill. On July 28, the US Senate voted 86-12 to advance the Bill, which would authorise Trump to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries buying Russian oil, including India. The strong bipartisan vote makes Senate approval highly likely. The Bill must still pass the House of Representatives and be signed by the President before becoming law.

The message is clear: Tariffs are no longer just presidential actions under existing laws — they are increasingly becoming an instrument of US economic and foreign policy, backed by Congress. India should recognise this structural shift and frame its trade strategy accordingly, rather than treating each new tariff measure as temporary or isolated.

The events of July 24 had already pointed in the same direction. Exporters had expected the temporary Section 122 tariff to expire and US imports to revert to normal WTO most-favoured-nation (MFN) tariff rates. Instead, Washington kept the tariff in place by replacing one legal instrument with another.

Just hours before the Section 122 tariff expired, the US Trade Representative imposed new Section 301 tariffs on imports from 60 economies, citing forced-labour concerns. The tariff burden remained largely unchanged; only its legal basis changed. This showed that maintaining higher tariffs had become a policy objective, regardless of the legal instrument used.

India's experience illustrates this shift. Although Washington reduced India's tariff from the proposed 12.5 per cent to 10 per cent after recognising its ban on imports made with forced labour, it still imposed the tariff despite producing no credible evidence that India imports goods made with forced labour. The objective appeared to be not simply

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RwD_RG9mjlMzgl



ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

to remedy an unfair trade practice but to preserve a broader tariff-based strategy.

The result is a US tariff system that is becoming increasingly permanent, layered and unpredictable. Tariffs are now imposed through multiple legal authorities — including MFN tariffs, Section 232, Section 301, and potentially new legislation such as the Russia sanctions Bill. A cotton T-shirt imported into the United States now faces a 26.5 per cent tariff (16.5 per cent MFN plus 10 per cent under Section 301), while an auto part attracts 27.5 per cent (2.5 per cent MFN plus a 25 per cent Section 232 duty). Some products, including smartphones and generic medicines, remain duty-free — for now.

This marks a sharp departure from the traditional trading system. For decades, WTO commitments kept tariffs in countries broadly stable. The United States is now using an expanding range of executive and legislative powers to raise tariffs in violation of its commitment at the WTO.

More measures are in the pipeline. The US is expected to conclude another Section 301 investigation into alleged excess manufacturing capacity, including India's textiles, steel and petrochemicals. Trump has also proposed 100 per cent tariffs on imported generic medicines from August 2028, rising to 200 per cent a year later unless production shifts to the US. Given that India supplies nearly half of all generic prescriptions dispensed in the US and almost 38 per cent of its pharmaceutical exports go to the US market, these proposals ignore the impact on American consumers.

Rather than negotiating under pressure, India should strengthen its competitiveness, diversify export markets and preserve its policy autonomy

ventory for exports. Yet these concessions have neither slowed US tariff actions nor secured meaningful commercial gains. Instead, they have weakened India's negotiating position.

In any trade negotiation, concessions are exchanged for reciprocal benefits. When a country makes unilateral concessions outside the negotiating process, the other side simply accepts them without offering anything in return. That is why countries negotiating trade agreements avoid unilateral concessions and keep all offers on the table until a balanced deal is reached.

This has important implications for the proposed India-U.S. bilateral trade agreement (BTA). Although officials say the agreement is "99 per cent complete", the main US concession no longer exists. Under the February 6, 2026 joint statement, Washington had offered to reduce reciprocal tariffs on Indian exports from 25 per cent to 18 per cent. But that offer disappeared on February 20 when the US Supreme Court struck down the reciprocal tariff regime. Since then, the United States has been unable to offer any comparable commercial benefit, making it difficult to justify further Indian concessions.

India has little reason to rush into a BTA. Unlike many US allies in Europe and East Asia, it does not depend on American security guarantees and is therefore under less pressure to accept an unbalanced deal. More importantly, a trade agreement would not shield India from future tariffs. The European Union, Japan and South Korea — all close US partners with trade agreements — continue to face new Section 301 investigations and other trade actions.

In 2019, India imposed retaliatory tariffs on 28 US products in response to steel and aluminium tariffs, arguing that such action was permitted under WTO rules. Today, however, retaliation appears far less feasible.

Rather than negotiating under pressure, India should strengthen its competitiveness, diversify export markets and preserve its policy autonomy. Temporary export losses are a smaller cost than permanent concessions that weaken India's long-term interests.

India should sign a trade deal only when it delivers stable, reciprocal commercial benefits; not short-lived relief from an unpredictable U.S. tariff regime. A lasting trade partnership cannot be built on a foundation of changing tariffs.

The writer is founder, GTRI

Why Calcutta Stock Exchange needs to be revived



RAJEEV MANTRI

ACHIEVING VIKSIT Bharat requires India to sustain economic advancement and retain strategic autonomy. Both converge in high technology, where prime human capital can build frontier enterprises. A decade of tenacious policy reform under the Modi government has brought the deep-tech ecosystem — space tech, biotechnology, semiconductors, robotics — to critical mass. Loss-making companies have a listing path, but the genuinely excluded class is the intellectual property-driven pre-commercial business — a molecule in clinical trials, a chip awaiting tape-out, an electric aircraft in development — where capital precedes scaled revenue by years.

India's strategic competitor has seen and addressed this issue. In 2018, as American sanctions tightened, China created the STAR Market — opened in Shanghai in 2019 as a disclosure-gated deep-tech board. Seven years on, 592 companies have raised about \$160 billion. The aperture keeps widening — AI, robotics, space — and the verdict is in: The STAR 50 index rose 64 per cent in the first half of 2026, and Cambrian, a chip designer that listed unprofitable in 2020, became the board's first trillion-renminbi company. China has built capital markets as an instrument of growth and strategic competition. India denies founders of comparable talent domestic listing avenues.

India should adopt two propositions as core policy. First, the country should have a third exchange — large markets sustain multiple venues, as America's NYSE-AMEX-NASDAQ trifecta showed. The Calcutta Stock Exchange (CSE), whose revival the West Bengal government's 2026-27 budget backs, is the natural candidate. The storied CSE was established in 1908, months after 8,000 Indian households financed Tata Steel by public subscription — the deep technology of its age, backed pre-revenue with Indian capital. Second, NSE and BSE standards stay intact — their eligibility criteria are a brand promise to crores of retail investors. The incumbents cannot host a pre-commercial regime, and CSE cannot sustain by replicating them. Only clear differentiation lets CSE revive and thrive. Five regulatory reforms enable the shift.

First, update the listing regime to permit pre-commercial listings, gated by disclosure and milestones, not financial performance — clinical data for biopharma, tape-out and yield data for semiconductors, flight heritage for aerospace. National missions offer a ready credentialing layer. Skin in the game must bind participants: Firm founder and shareholder lock-ins, plus qualified institutional anchors. Alternative investment funds (AIFs) should be permitted to distribute shares in specie to investors, inheriting residual lock-ins — diversifying the shareholder base.

Second, rationalise the accredited investor regime and make it the gate. Consolidate the patchwork of wealth tests into one definition, certified with long validity. Accredited investors, family offices, global institutions and AIF managers get preferred initial access — first-wave allocation, smaller lots — with retail phased in as disclosure accumulates. With this sophisticated base, permit full shorting: A disclosure-gated market stays honest only if exaggeration is punishable by price.

Third, consolidate and upgrade the unlisted shares grey market into the dealer network. This market — offline trading at one-way quotes, with spreads invisible to buyers — is the American pink sheets of the 1960s, which NASDAQ's screens were launched in 1971 to cure. Its intermediaries lack not registration but market structure. CSE should offer it.

Fourth, settle through the existing clearing corporations under interoperability. Demat delivers delivery-versus-payment on day one. Mainboard migration should be a right after seasoning, with index inclusion and institutional participation tied to the right metrics — long-term patient capital is ultimately institutional.

Fifth, seed the information ecosystem through issuer-sponsored research. India's vast community of professional and amateur analysts and profusion of tech media will supply the information utilities once there is paper to analyse.

Sequencing matters: Quote transparency first, the exchange later. Phase one relaunches CSE as a regulated quotation and trade-reporting platform for unlisted shares — quick to build on demat rails, an immediate investor-protection win. Phase two opens listing to deep tech, subject to conditions precedent: Fresh institutional capital, ownership severed from brokers, regulator-approved governance.

Critics will point to fragmentation risk, CSE's complicated history, and the risk of creating a market for lemons. These require building in shorting, lock-ins and surveillance by design.

A revitalised CSE, built for pre-commercial listings, would give scientist-founders a specialised, homegrown destination for listing and enable qualified savers to invest directly in deep-tech enterprises. Locating India's high-tech exchange at the historic Lyons Range in Kolkata's Dalhousie area will not just help achieve economic and strategic objectives — it will repatriate the commanding heights of Indian innovation to the soil that once led India's scientific and industrial development.

The writer, president, India Foundation, is with the BJP

The writer is founder and managing partner of venture capital fund Navam Capital

In Indo-Pacific, a steady projection of power



RAM RAJYA

BY RAM MADHAV

IS INDIA emerging as the third power in the Indo-Pacific region alongside the US and China?

In the past decade, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has substantially increased engagement with the countries in the region. He has participated in ASEAN-India Summits 12 times, East Asia Summits nine times, visited Japan eight times, Singapore five times, Indonesia four times and Australia three times. He has been present at all six Quad leader-level summits since 2021. Modi is the only Indian PM to have visited almost every country in the Indo-Pacific. Despite differences, Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping bumped into each other over 20 times in the last 12 years, although not all can be called serious engagements.

In his address to Parliament in 2007, then Japanese PM Shinzo Abe invoked the terminology of "Indo-Pacific" for the first time for the region known as "Asia-Pacific" since the 1980s. Soon, the term captured the world's attention, with the US using the phrase "Indo-Asia-Pacific" initially, before officially adopting the term in 2018. It even renamed its command Indo-Pacific Command. Several coun-

In the last couple of years, a new assertion is visible. First came the initiative to develop a \$10 billion maritime facility — the Great Nicobar Island Development Project

tries came out with Indo-Pacific strategies.

Two countries that refused to adopt this terminology were China and Russia. In 2018, Wang Yi, the Chinese foreign minister, said it would "dissipate like sea foam", dubbing it an effort by the Western powers to encircle and contain China.

Keeping complexities in mind, Modi adopted a gradualist approach to dealing with the region. In the Quad, while the US proposed a "Free and Open Indo-Pacific" as the motto, Modi suggested Free, Open and "Inclusive" Indo-Pacific, leaving some ambiguity over the question of excluding any country. He proclaimed the concept of "ASEAN Centrality" to the Indo-Pacific at the Shangri La Dialogue in Singapore in 2017. However, in the last couple of years, a new assertion is visible. First came the initiative to develop a \$10-billion maritime facility — the Great Nicobar Island Development Project. Sitting just 40 nautical miles north of the Strait of Malacca, which witnesses around 100,000 ship crossings annually, 60 per cent belonging to China, this is in a way India's proclamation of its geostrategic activism.

Modi's engagements with the leaders of Japan, Indonesia, New Zealand and Australia in July also indicated an assertion of power.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

At root of exam leaks, a problem of centralisation

The leaks during the past decade or so are because of structural weaknesses and covert objectives. The heart of the problem is neither failure of technology nor weak laws.

The first problem is centralisation. Before the NTA, every state had its tests for engineering, medicine and law, and leaks were rarer. States had a stake in a clean process. With centralisation and uniform tests, states' involvement is minimised, and the Centre can push its agenda to the detriment of most candidates. The evangelical search for uniformity defies logic and is detrimental.

In the US, the ETS administrators centralised tests. In the past 50 years, there has not been a single "paper leak". The NTA, which has questionable procedures and a skeletal staff, should have been jettisoned when it failed time and again. Where there are question setters, there can be selection bias. The

ETS does not have any specific question setters. They have a question bank, and questions are algorithmically selected for a test. In India, ideological bias makes the system more likely to turn a blind eye. Given repeated failures, we should go back to the decentralised system, with the NTA handling examinations for institutions under the purview of the central government, if that.

With the centralisation of testing comes

Before the NTA, every state had its tests, and leaks were rarer. States had a stake in a clean process.

With centralisation, states' involvement is minimised, and the Centre can push its agenda

the flourishing of the coaching industry. Dependence on coaching or tuition shops has become so complete that doing well in a standardised test has become well-nigh impossible without them. The coaching-tuition-profiteering model has consolidated, and they charge a hefty sum for training.

These industries sprout and flourish when there is, simultaneously, a broken education system and a centralised testing system. The coaching-tuition industry also hollows out the existing education system as good students opt out of mainstream education, committing their time to these teaching shops. While China was able to demolish the entire coaching-tuition industry in 2021, in India it is yet to be recognised as a problem. The industry expands even though it strains parents' finances, wastes families' time and resources and takes young people away from

the fun of learning and growing up.

Governments typically try to deny and then to cover up paper leaks when they take place. In the past, the incumbent government has tried to downplay the systemic problem by saying a leak is a small one or an isolated incident. The true scale of the problem, including the violations that are likely not caught, is much larger. If completely undeserving candidates take even some of the limited seats in top institutions by gaming the system, the whole country's future pays the price. If the newly constituted task force suggests switching to online testing without fixing structural flaws, it will be like cleaning the mirror when there is dirt on one's face.

The writer is former secretary (Higher Education), Government of India. Views are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Women at forefront

THE YOUNG female protesters distinguished themselves by displaying political acumen and matchless bravery ("They fought like girls. And won", *IE*, July 31). That they held their ground in the face of brutal violence by the police and RAF will inspire future generations of women protesters. A young Mumbai woman trying hard to stop a heavy police vehicle symbolises the very spirit of female participation in the youth-led movement. To watch women protesters beaten mercilessly was heartrending, exposing a callous executive.

S H Quadri, Bikaner

Engage with youth

YOUTH POLITICS in India today is at a turning point and is shaped less by party allegiance than by the lived precarity of paper leaks, unemployment, and eroded trust in institutions ("Neither government nor Opposition can look youth in the eye on education", *IE*, July 31). Suhas Palshikar's piece aptly captures this deeper malaise. The refusal of both the government and the Opposition to engage substantively reflects a widening democratic gap, with young citizens and their issues being politicised but not represented. Their mobilisation signals a shift from transactional politics to a demand for structural accountability.

Abhinav Shah, Lucknow

Practical wisdom

SOCIETY OFTEN overlooks the knowledge and practical wisdom of workers whose contributions extend far beyond manual labour ("The worker-intellectual we refuse to recognise", *IE*, July 31). Their experience deserves greater respect in public discourse, education, and policymaking. A truly inclusive society values intellectual ability wherever it exists, not only within formal academic spaces.

A Senthil Kumar, Kaniyur



SATYA MOHANTY

WHEN THE Cockroach Janta Party gathered strength online, it was done on a whim. When they claimed the street, it was asking for an impossibility: The resignation of the Education Minister from a government that has never acknowledged any failure nor forced ministers to resign. Finally, the impossible happened as the agitation had become about more than an education-driven agenda and it threatened the government perse. The usual ineffective correctives such as laws with stronger punishments and constituting a task force have happened. Embedded in them is a semblance of going back to business as usual.

WSJ: Trump eyes \$1,00,000 fee for foreign graduates seeking jobs in US

Press Trust of India
Washington, July 31

THE US is planning to impose a \$1,00,000 fee on visas issued to international students for working in the US after graduation from an American university, *The Wall Street Journal* reported. The Trump administration move comes after a US court struck down a proposal to levy a \$1,00,000 fee on H-1-B visas.

According to *The Wall Street Journal*, the Department of Homeland Security is mulling the high fee on Optional Practical Training (OPT) visas which are an extension of F-1 visas issued to students.

The OPT programme allows foreign graduates to work for one to three years on their student visas in areas directly related to their studies.

Roughly 4,19,000 foreigners were working on OPT in 2024, the latest year for which data are available. Tech companies, which conduct most of the recruitments from US universities, opposed the \$1,00,000 fee on H-1-B visas.

ADHS spokeswoman said in a statement: "No policies should be considered final until formally announced. At DHS we are always having conversations about how to use all tools in our arsenal to protect the integrity of our legal immigration system."

In addition to the H-1B and student visas, officials at the State Department are also weighing attaching a \$1,00,000 bond on applicants for green cards outside the US, redeemable only after they move to the US and become citizens.

The OPT program is one of the primary attractions for international students choosing to study in the US.

SPANISH PM SANCHEZ SAYS BREACHES ARE A 'VIOLATION OF TERRITORIAL INTEGRITY' 60,000 cross into Spain's Ceuta, 57 die after breach

37,500 migrants have returned to Morocco: Spain's interior ministry

Associated Press
Ceuta, July 31

ABOUT 60,000 MIGRANTS crossed from Morocco into Spain's tiny Ceuta territory in the past 24 hours, Ceuta's president said Friday, a figure that is equivalent to 70% of the population of the city in North Africa. At least 57 migrants died on the journey.

But roughly half of the people who made the crossing soon made their way back voluntarily, the Spanish government said, after the sudden arrival of so many triggered chaos and a humanitarian crisis.

Some migrants swam several miles through the sea and faced down authorities who tried to turn them back with water cannons, tear gas and warning shots. Those who died included some who drowned or were killed in a stampede to cross a breakwater barrier near a border checkpoint.

Spain deployed its armed forces and additional police to restore order in Ceuta, which sits on the Strait of Gibraltar at the entrance to the Mediterranean Sea and has been a Spanish possession since 1580. On the Moroccan side of the border, security forces clashed with migrants.

"The situation that Ceuta is going through is absolutely unsustainable," Ceuta President Juan Jesús Vivas told journalists. Meanwhile, migrants from

• THE IMPORTANCE OF CEUTA

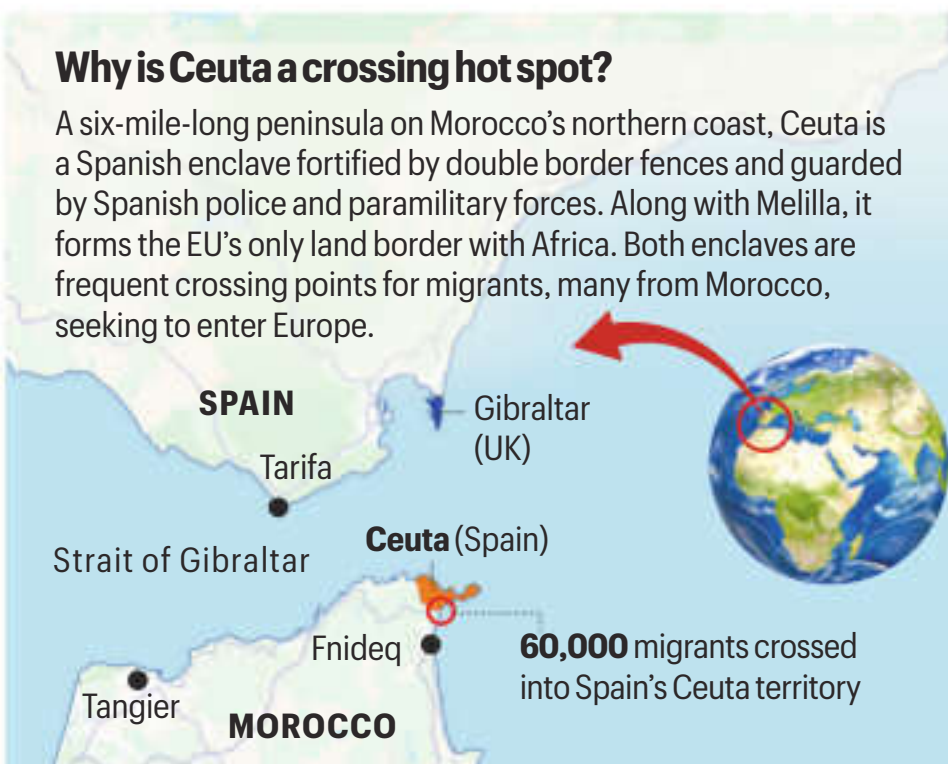
The peninsula, Ceuta, is one of only two cities on the African mainland that are officially part of Europe.

What happened this week?

• About 1,500 migrants had entered Ceuta in recent days. On Thursday, Spanish official Fernando Rodríguez Contreras said the working estimate of new arrivals had risen to the tens of thousands, though the figure could not be confirmed. At least 18 migrants died attempting the crossing, and Spain said it was deploying military platoons to reinforce border security, platoons to enforce border security.

WHY DOES THIS MASS CROSSING MATTER?

• Ceuta's border with Morocco has long been a flashpoint in both Spanish politics and relations with Rabat. Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez has sought to portray



Spain as an immigrant-friendly nation, particularly welcoming Spanish-speaking Latin Americans. But his government has faced criticism from conservative

opponents, who accuse it of weak border control, and from migrant rights advocates, who say it relies on overly harsh enforcement at the frontier.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

Morocco also attempted to cross into Melilla, Spain's other territory at the tip of North Africa, where they clashed with police.

Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez visited Ceuta on Friday and condemned the border breach, which he described as "a violation of Spain's territorial integrity."

The Spanish Interior Ministry released its own figures shortly after Vivas' spoke, estimating that some 50,000 people had crossed from Morocco since Thursday. It added that 37,500 had already returned to Morocco by Friday afternoon, with hundreds more going back by the hour.



Migrants from Morocco cross into the Spanish enclave of Ceuta by sea on Friday. AP

Indian-American surgeon removes golf ball-sized brain tumour through nose

Washington: An Indian-American army surgeon played a key role in an innovative minimally invasive procedure to remove a golf ball-sized brain tumour through a patient's nose, helping avoid open brain surgery.

Major Jagat Kumar Patel, an anterior skull base surgeon at the Walter Reed National Military Medical Centre near here, worked with neurosurgeon Lt Col Charles Miller to perform the rare surgical procedure on Marine Corps Staff Sergeant Andy Archer, who had lived with the tumour for 15 years.

The procedure required highly synchronised collaboration between the two experts, the US Department of Defence said in a statement.

The benign tumour, measuring about 4.4 cm, was located in front of the pituitary gland of Archer and was pressing against his optic nerve.

According to the Defence Department, Patel developed a plan to navigate patient's nasal anatomy and create a clear surgical pathway to remove the golf ball-sized tumour through nasal passages using an endoscope.

The team successfully removed more than 99 per cent of tumour earlier this month. PTI

Pak gangster Uzair Baloch's brother shot in Lyari

Express News Service
July 31

THE BROTHER of imprisoned Pakistani gangster Uzair Baloch, chief of the defunct People's Amn Committee, was shot and critically wounded in Karachi's Lyari area on Thursday, *Pakistan newspaper Dawn* reported.

According to the *Dawn* report, Zubair Baloch, 40, was shot and injured on main Chakiwara Road, while two passersby were also injured. They were shifted

to Civil Hospital Karachi.

South Deputy Inspector General (DIG) Syed Asad Raza said that Zubair was sitting outside his residence in Singu Lane when armed suspects on a motorcycle opened fire on him and fled the scene, *Dawn* reported.

The *Dawn* report said that Zubair sustained multiple injuries, including to his chest and abdomen, and was undergoing surgery.

DIG Raza said the police were investigating the incident from

different angles, including gang rivalry and personal enmity, according to the *Dawn* report.

A social activist in the Lyari area said that Zubair had reportedly joined a 'political party', a few months prior which had raised concerns in the area, the *Dawn* reported.

According to the *Dawn* report, the activist, on the condition of anonymity, said that in Lyari some gangsters who had fled to Dubai and Iran after the Karachi operation had returned

following the US-Iran war, and that residents were fearful of a possible resurgence of the past gang war in the area.

The *Dawn* report said earlier in March, an anti-terrorism court rejected bail applications of Uzair in seven cases pertaining to murder, police encounter and possession of explosives.

Uzair had been charged with attacking law enforcers with firearms and explosives in 2012 within jurisdiction of Kalakot police station, *Dawn* report said.

Trump says US has not agreed to Ukraine building Patriot missiles

Reuters
Maryland, July 31

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump said on Friday that the United States has not agreed to Ukraine building Patriot missiles but that talks are ongoing, adding the US must be "very careful about letting somebody build them."

Trump said during a meeting with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy in Turkey this month he was going to give Ukraine a license to manufacture Patriot missile interceptors to help defend against Russian strikes, but has since backed away despite hosting Zelenskyy at the White House this week.

“We’re talking about it, but it’s a hard thing to give away that kind of technology... you know, there’s people you give that technology, they can someday turn on you”

DONALD TRUMP, U.S. PRESIDENT

Asked about the Patriot missiles during a cabinet meeting at the Camp David retreat on Friday, Trump emphasized con-

cerns about sharing advanced US weaponry including missile technology. "It's a big step," Trump said.

"In the case of President Zelenskyy, he'd like to have some Patriots, he'd like to have some Tomahawks, which are you know lethal — one offensive, one defensive," Trump said.

"You have to be very judicious, but you have to be very careful. Now we have not agreed to that. We're talking about it, but it's a hard thing to give away kind of technology. And I don't think this would ever happen but, you know, there's people you give technology, they can someday turn on you," Trump said.

4 bodies found after 10 go missing on peak in Pak, no sign of climber Purja

Kathmandu: Nepal's veteran mountaineer Nirmal Purja was among six climbers missing after an avalanche struck an expedition on Pakistan's Broad Peak, where rescuers recovered four bodies and continued search operations.

Broad Peak (8,051 metres), located in the Karakoram range near K2, is the world's 12th-highest mountain and is considered one of the most challenging peaks to climb.

The avalanche struck the mountain at an altitude of around 7,000 metres on Thursday, sweeping away a 10-member climbing team that had

Trump hails Gaza truce deal even as Hamas and Israel see hurdles

Israel must end attacks, withdraw forces and increase aid flows: Hamas

Reuters
Maryland, July 31

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump said on Friday a deal he announced to bring peace to Gaza was "a great breakthrough" despite signs from both Hamas and Israel that significant hurdles remained before a deal can be implemented.

The comment came a day after what Trump called a "major milestone" towards ending the war in Gaza that he said would see the complete disarmament of Hamas and other armed groups.

"It's a big step for the Middle East, and people are really impressed by it, and they're surprised by it," he said.

Trump's announcement on Thursday of the agreement by his Gaza 'Board of Peace' followed months of faltering efforts to keep the ceasefire agreement reached last year in the Egyptian resort of Sharm el-Sheikh on track and it was not immediately



A Palestinian woman sits amid debris of a house as people inspect the site of an Israeli airstrike in Gaza City on Thursday. REUTERS

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mIjMzg1

clear how strongly either Hamas or Israel stood behind it.

A senior Hamas official involved in the negotiation told *Reuters* that implementation of the deal would depend on Israel first meeting its commitments under an agreement reached last year that bound it to a phased end to military operations and withdrawal of its forces from Gaza.

An Israeli official said Israel's position remained that "there will be no withdrawal whatsoever of the IDF from the current Yellow Line unless Hamas undergoes a genuine disarmament", referring to a military demarcation line agreed in truce.

Trump, who met Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu in Washington on Tuesday, said Israel was "very happy" about the deal. "Israel helped us, and they've been very good," he said. "Will it go through its ups and downs? It's a very complex situation over there."

On Friday, Hamas issued a statement saying the first step towards an agreement would have to be a commitment by Israel "to stopping the killing and ending its attacks".

But within hours of the deal, Gazan medical authorities said one Palestinian was killed and several others wounded in at least two Israeli airstrikes.

Sri Lanka ex-police chief gets death for negligence in 2019 Easter bombings

Associated Press
Colombo, July 31

A SRI Lankan court on Friday sentenced former Police Chief Pujith Jayasundara to death after finding him guilty of criminal negligence that allowed Islamic State-inspired bomb attacks on Easter Sunday in 2019, killing more than 260 people.

A death penalty in Sri Lanka typically means life in prison because the country has had an informal moratorium on executions since 1976. Current President Anura Kumara Dissanayake supports maintaining the moratorium.

The near-simultaneous

bombings in 2019 were carried out at three tourist hotels and three churches — two of them Catholic and one Protestant — and killed 42 foreigners. A parliamentary committee found that police and intelligence officials failed to act on repeated intelligence warnings of the attacks.

Jayasundara has the right to appeal Friday's verdict by the three-member High Court bench. The court was to deliver another ruling later Friday on Hemasiri Fernando, former secretary to the Defense Ministry, on the same charge.

Two Sri Lanka-based Islamic militant groups were accused of carrying out the bombings.

• BRIEFLY

POLAND

Russian envoy summoned after missile lands on NATO territory



Polish PM Donald Tusk at a press meet in Kolonia, Poland on Friday. REUTERS

POLAND SUMMONED the Russian ambassador on Friday and handed him a protest note after a Russian missile landed on Polish territory, a foreign ministry spokesperson said. Warsaw confirmed on Friday that the projectile, which came down in eastern Poland on Thursday, was a Russian Kh-101 missile. The incident was the latest in a series of airspace incursions on NATO's eastern flank that have fuelled fears that the war in Ukraine may spill over. REUTERS

ALGERIA

25 dead after bus falls into ravine

AT LEAST 25 people were killed and 44 injured on Friday after a bus skidded off a road and plunged into a ravine in Algeria, according to a provisional report from the Algerian Civil Protection. AP

GREECE

Police probe 'suitcase' death

GREEK AUTHORITIES are investigating the cause of death of a British woman whose body was found in a suitcase in the centre of Athens last week, as per to two Greek officials. REUTERS

Discarded SpaceX rocket on collision course with moon

Cape Canaveral: A drifting SpaceX rocket is on a collision course with the moon after launching a pair of lunar landers more than a year ago.

The rocket's upper stage will unintentionally slam into the moon Wednesday, carving out a crater and sending up a plume of dust and rubble that scientists and skygazers are eager to observe.

Space tracking expert Bill Gray predicts an impact of 8700 kph, seven times the speed of sound, near Einstein Crater on the moon's sunlit western limb.

With the action unfolding in the wee hours, the eastern portions of the US and Canada, and much of South America should

have the best views. While scientists are not too concerned about this particular piece of space junk, it highlights the growing threat as more and more items cram into orbit.

"Things are getting crowded up there," said Gray, who plans to view the aftermath from New Brunswick, Canada.

It was never SpaceX's intent to hit the moon. But space experts said the crash could have been avoided if the upper stage had been nudged into orbit around the sun. It will be the second dead rocket known to crash into the moon accidentally.

A Chinese rocket segment dug out a pair of craters on the lunar far side in 2022. AP

Selam Gebrekidan
Hong Kong, July 30

ONE DECEMBER afternoon, the sky tore open and a fiery hunk of metal, wider than a school bus, came hurtling down. It was louder than a thunderclap when it plunged into a patch of farmland, startling everyone in the village of Mukuku, about three hours south of Nairobi, Kenya. "People were thinking this is end of world," said John Mukunuu, who lives nearby.

When the villagers arrived, they found a giant ring, taller than a man and heavier than a horse, lodged into the earth. They watched it cool from a glowing ember to a dull gray.

They guarded it, taking the occasional selfie, until officials from the capital swarmed the village.

The ring had once connected parts of a rocket. It was supposed to have burned up on its return to Earth. "This is an isolated event," the Kenya Space Agency said in early 2025. Not exactly.

More space debris is raining down on Earth than ever before — one effect of the frenetic race among governments and companies such as SpaceX to reign over the skies.

Last year, the US Space Force issued alerts for nearly 820 objects entering the Earth's atmosphere. The government issued alerts for 110 objects a decade ago. "The reentries happen each



Space debris that was found at the Glamping Collective luxury campground in mountains west of North Carolina. NYT

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mIjMzg1 and every day," said Mariusz Slonina, who heads space situational awareness operations for the Polish Space Agency. Huge objects weighing a met-

rets to the ground, uncontrolled and unpredictable.

The more objects humans launch into orbit, the more debris they will have to dodge on Earth.

Over 300 rockets launched last year, nearly four times as many as a decade ago. That means many more bits and spent parts are expected to drop back.

Dying satellites are another common detritus of this space age. A good number of the roughly 16,000 satellites in orbit will ultimately come back to Earth. In 2024, discarded hardware from the International Space Station crashed into a Florida home.

Early last year, part of a SpaceX rocket landed near a busy

shopping mall in Poznan, Poland. Another piece was found near the city's airport, according to the Polish Space Agency.

Months later, a defunct Chinese satellite barreled down over Tenerife, one of the Canary Islands of Spain. The 3-metric-ton satellite sent shock waves across the region before fragmenting and burning in the air.

In October, miners discovered burning debris on a desert road in Western Australia. Recently, giant "space balls" washed ashore on an Australian beach. The patchwork of regulation governing rocket launches and orbital junk is no match for the pace of space development. NYT

@ieExplained

#ExpressExplained

If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

TECH

Can Chinese AI models shape future of tech race



RISHIKA SINGH

IN JANUARY 2025, the release of a Chinese artificial intelligence (AI) model called DeepSeek R1 drew global attention and briefly triggered market panic. It was a low-cost, quality product that was compared to ChatGPT and other top models from the US as discussions about AI-related overspending were gaining ground.

DeepSeek also evoked curiosity and questions — just how capable is China's AI sector? In parallel, OpenAI, the company behind ChatGPT, accused DeepSeek of copying its technology, with a Trump administration adviser backing the claim.

A similar sequence seems to be playing out now. Chinese company Moonshot AI's Kimi K3 model, released in July, is said to rival models from US-based OpenAI and Anthropic. It boasts features such as coding, financial consulting and video editing.

Amid its rise, Anthropic accused Moonshot AI of illicitly extracting the capabilities of its Claude model, with one US official describing it as “an assault on every economy that prizes the entrepreneur, rewards private capital, and relies on fair and honest competition.” China's Commerce Ministry then accused the US of “AI hegemonism”.

“Markets react strongly when a Chinese release challenges assumptions about permanent US technological leadership. Another sell-off is certainly possible,” said Lizzi C Lee, a Fellow on Chinese Economy at the US-based Asia Society Policy Institute's Center for China Analysis.

But more than just being good, the Kimi story shows that Chinese models are now becoming more ubiquitous, she told *The Indian Express*.

What Kimi K3 represents

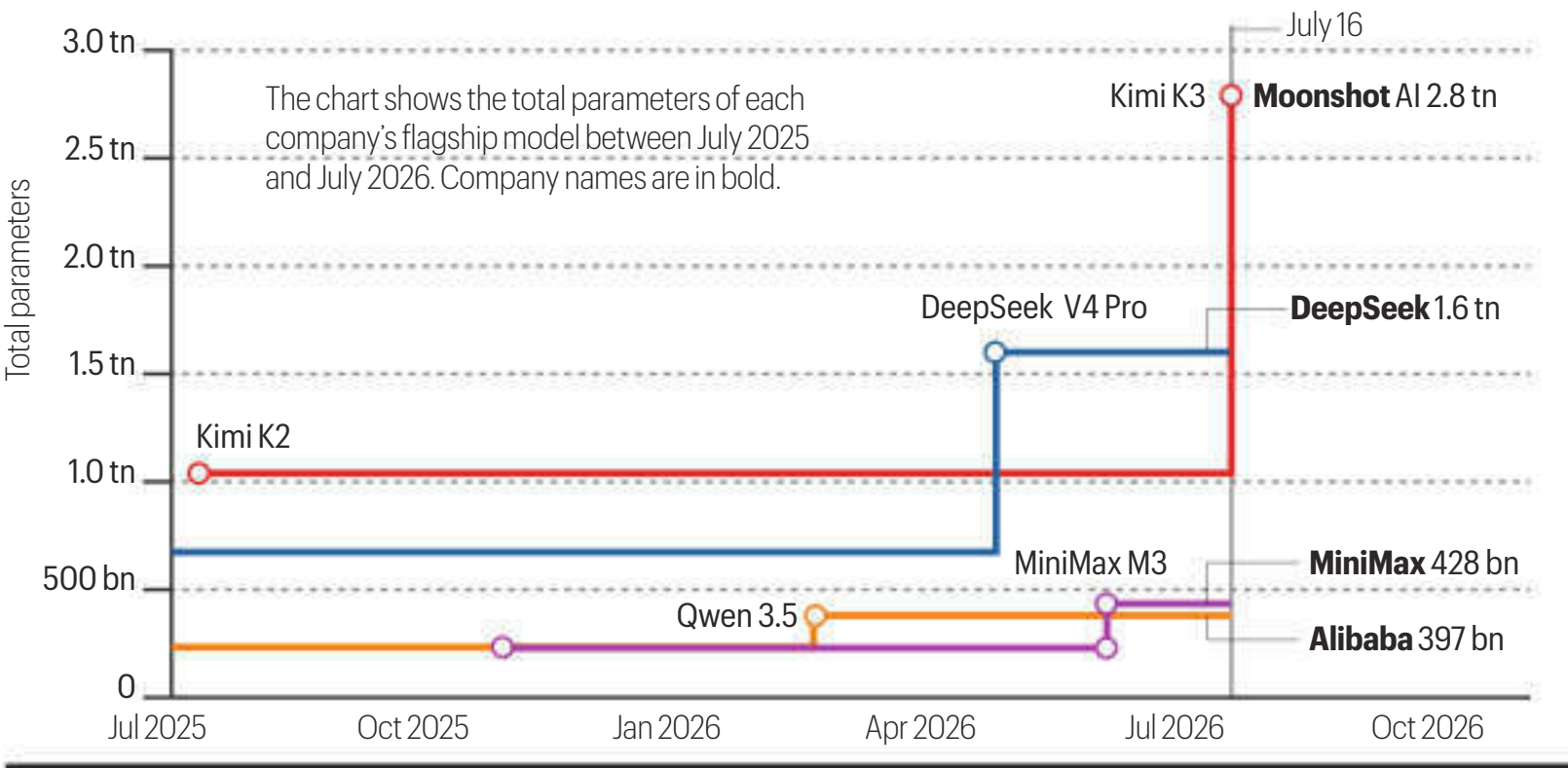
Moonshot AI was founded in 2023 by Yang Zhilin, a 34-year-old entrepreneur who graduated from Beijing's Tsinghua University and earned his PhD at Carnegie Mellon University. He then returned to China.

Kimi K3 has been billed as the world's largest “open-weight” AI system, with 2.8 trillion “parameters”. In the AI context, parameters are the settings that determine how systems respond to user prompts, based on the large amounts of data they

Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F

HOW KIMI STACKS UP AGAINST ‘OPEN-WEIGHT’ COMPETITORS

Kimi K3 has been billed as the world's largest ‘open-weight’ AI system with 2.8 trillion (tn) ‘parameters’. In the context of AI, parameters are settings that determine how systems respond to user prompts, based on the large amounts of data they have been trained on.



have been trained on. Parameters are assigned “weights” or numerical values that indicate their relative significance, which guide the model's response.

Lee said that a massive parameter count indicates large investment in compute (software and hardware used for training and running AI systems), data and engineering. But the model's capability also depends on factors like data quality.

Poe Zhao, a China Tech Analyst and Founder of the online publication Hello China Tech, told *The Indian Express*: “An open-weight model allows developers to download its parameters, run it locally and customise it. Open source usually implies broader disclosure, including enough code and training information to understand and modify how the model was produced.”

Conceptually, “open-source” simply means that the underlying code behind software is publicly shared so anyone can use and modify it to create their own programs. Openness is often seen as a way to democratise technology, but has also drawn counterarguments on malicious actors manipulating code and posing security risks.

The open-close debate

US companies have generally not followed the open model path, but many Chinese AI models open-weight.

Zhao said, “Leading US companies already have global cloud platforms and en-

What is Kimi K3?

Kimi K3 is an advanced AI model released by the Chinese company Moonshot. It is said to rival the likes of OpenAI and Anthropic.

It is an ‘open-weight’ system, which means it can be downloaded and modified.

terprise customers. Chinese labs can use open weights to reach developers more quickly, build an ecosystem” and generate demand for their products.

Chim Lee, a Senior Analyst focusing on China at the Economist Intelligence Unit, told *The Indian Express* that Chinese developers often face “chip supply constraints, given Western export restrictions and domestic production bottlenecks.” Semiconductors or specialised chips are crucial hardware required to run AI models, and the US government has sought to restrict advanced variants from reaching China.

Restrictions, as part of the larger geopolitical rivalry, mean that Chinese labs “may not have the capacity to provide commercial access to a closed model,” he said.

What makes the Kimi case unusual, he said, “is that it is one of the most popular models trying a custom licence approach — open-weight for most, but requiring large companies to strike a commercial agreement with Moonshot.”

Lizzi Lee said that the approach also fits China's broader industrial strategy: “Beijing wants AI to spread quickly across manufacturing, cloud services, local governments... Open weights help accelerate that diffusion. There is a diplomatic angle, too. China increasingly presents open models as part of international technological cooperation.”

Just this month, the Chinese government spearheaded the creation of a new AI

governance body, with President Xi Jinping stating that “AI development should not be a solo performance... but a symphony of international cooperation”.

Future of the AI race

Kimi arrives at a time of several overlapping, AI-related debates in the US, touching upon tech access and national security.

In a recent open letter, industry giants called for shifting towards open-weight models. “Software developed by the open-source community now supports most of the internet and underlies systems used by the world's largest technology companies, as well as the US military and federal agencies... The US now faces a similar choice with AI,” it said.

Zhao said that the letter is an “important industry signal, although it is too early to call it a major shift...” While companies behind AI infrastructure (like Nvidia) have until now advocated for open-weight models, presumably to spread adoption and the demand for their products, companies that created proprietary models (like Anthropic) have had reservations.

Lizzi Lee said the story has “clear parallels with earlier disputes involving semiconductors, electric vehicles and other industries. Rapid Chinese technological catch-up has often been followed by arguments over technology transfer and intellectual property.”

The US government is also reportedly investigating whether Moonshot illegally accessed advanced chips to train models. One reason for this may be increasing adoption of Chinese AI within the US. For price-conscious users, open-weight models also allow for need-based customisation.

With every new advanced Chinese model, the gap between the countries is narrowing, but with caveats. Zhao argued that export controls on chips, for instance, have also encouraged China's investment in efficiency and domestic alternatives. However, “K3 does not prove that export controls have failed. It shows that progress in AI models is influenced by more than access to the most advanced chips,” he said.

Parity with the US may be far off, he said, with companies holding an edge in compute, capital, global distribution and chips.

The rise of Chinese AI companies could also offer other countries “more choice, lower costs and greater ability to deploy models locally.” This, in turn, could give Chinese companies more influence over technical standards, further intensifying what is becoming a two-player race for global AI dominance.

LEGAL

FIR over remarks on PM: How law treats obscenity, profanity

Apurva Vishwanath
New Delhi, July 31

ON WEDNESDAY, the Noida Police registered a Zero FIR against a 25-year-old woman, Ruchika Singh, over remarks about Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the recent youth protest at Delhi's Jantar Mantar. The FIR invokes Sections 352, 353(1) and 356(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) — covering insult, public mischief and defamation. The case has triggered a public debate about profanity, especially against public leaders. But is crude language a crime in India?

Obscenity as an offence

The provision most commonly reached for in such disputes is Section 296 of the BNS (Section 294 of the Indian Penal Code).

It punishes “whoever, to the annoyance of others, (a) does any obscene act in any public place, or (b) sings, recites or utters any obscene song, ballad or words, in or near any public place” with up to three months in jail.

While this section has not been invoked in the Noida woman's case, it is usually the default charge for loud, crude public behaviour. But “obscene” carries a precise legal meaning that courts have read narrowly.

Determining obscenity

The legal doctrine for defining obscenity in India was tested by the ban on DH Lawrence's final novel, *Lady Chatterley's Lover*, published in the 20th century. In the 1965 landmark ruling in *Ranjit D. Udeshi v. State of Maharashtra*, the Supreme Court (SC) upheld the book ban and the constitutionality of Section 292 of the IPC, which allows the “sale of obscene books”.

In doing so, the court also laid down the test for obscenity: an 1868 English rule called the Hicklin test, which asked whether isolated passages of a work could corrupt the most vulnerable reader.

While English law moved on, courts in India applied this test for decades. In 2006, the SC opened a window in *Doordarshan v. Anand Patwardhan*, where the broadcaster had refused to air Patwardhan's documentary *Father, Son and Holy War* over its adult certificate. The SC cleared the telecast, holding that obscenity must be judged by viewing a work as a whole and not by isolating scenes.

The test changed in 2014 with *Aveek Sarkar v. State of West Bengal*, where the SC held that a nude photograph of tennis player Boris Becker and his fiancée was not obscene, and discarded Hicklin in favour of a “community standards” test. This test

A high bar

● In Sept 2025, the Telangana High Court held that social media posts describing a political party as a ‘scourge’ and a ‘pest’ might be harsh, even nasty language, but cannot attract Sections 352 (insult) or 353 (public mischief) if there is no real threat to public order.

● The court said that at best it fell within the ‘limited ambit’ of defamation, itself cushioned by constitutional protections for political speech.

stated that the allegedly problematic material is obscene only if it “tends to arouse sexual feelings, judged by an average person applying contemporary standards.”

Profanity or vulgarity as crime

In 2024, TVF's web series *College Romance* landed in legal trouble under the Information Technology Act over an expletive-heavy episode. Essentially, a ban was sought because the content was obscene. The SC, however, quashed the FIR, holding that vulgarity and profanity are not, by themselves, the same as obscenity.

“While the literal meaning of the terms used may be sexual in nature and they may refer to sexual acts, their usage does not arouse sexual feelings or lust... Rather, the common usage of these words is reflective of emotions of anger, rage, frustration, grief, or perhaps excitement,” the court had said.

Two other minor rulings this year, both by benches headed by Justice P S Narasimha, applied the same logic to ordinary individuals. In *Sivakumar v. State* (April 2026), the SC acquitted a man under Section 294 since calling someone a “bastard” during a heated argument did not meet the threshold for obscenity. Similarly, in *Maniv. State* (July 2026), the court said: “Use of mere swear

words, profanities and vulgar expletives, however distasteful or uncivil they may be, cannot be equated with obscenity.”

Court rulings on this issue frequently state that for an utterance to be considered obscene, it must be shown that it was lascivious. Lascivious is an adjective that means feeling, showing, or expressing a strong, often inappropriate desire for sex.

The Noida case

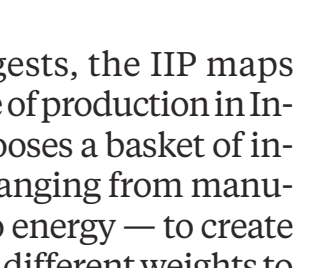
The sections cited in the Zero FIR (insult, public mischief and defamation) sit in an entirely different chapter of the BNS, each with its own, narrower test. Section 352 requires proof that the accused intended, or knew it was likely, that the insult would provoke actual breach of public peace and not simply that someone felt insulted.

Public mischief under Section 353 is aimed at incitement: mutiny within the armed forces, fear likely to push people to word offences against the state, or enmity between communities. This is a considerably higher bar than sharp criticism of a leader. Defamation, too, carries long-standing exceptions for good-faith comment on a public figure's conduct in their public role.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

ECONOMY

What strong IIP growth conceals: Persistent weakness in consumer demand



GRAPHS, DATA, PERSPECTIVES
BY UDIT MISRA

WEEKLY ECONOMIC AND POLICY INSIGHTS USING DATA

THIS week, the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation released the recently updated Index of Industrial Production (IIP) data. It showed that the IIP grew by 7.3% year-on-year (y-o-y) in June 2026.

Many things stood out about this data. First, the spike was the highest in almost two years. Moreover, it was the third consecutive month of accelerating y-o-y growth. It comes when most observers suggest India's growth will slow down this year. A closer look, however, reveals more about the state of the economy.

What is the IIP?

As the name suggests, the IIP maps changes in the volume of production in Indian industries. It chooses a basket of industrial products — ranging from manufacturing to mining to energy — to create an index by allocating different weights to each sector. It then tracks their production every month. The index value is compared to the previous year to understand the economy's industrial health.

There are two ways to read the data. The first looks at the different sectors that form India's industrial base. The other way is to look at the “use-based” classification, or how industrial goods are used, as shown in the table. This shows the nature of demand for industrial goods in the economy.

Primary goods are sourced from nature (such as minerals) for industrial use. Intermediate goods are incomplete in themselves (say cotton yarn) but used to produce other

TEPID CONSUMER GOODS GROWTH

Use-based classification of the Index of Industrial Production (y-o-y % change)

Quarter ended	IIP	Primary goods	Intermediate goods	Capital goods	Infra/construction goods	Consumer non-durables	Consumer durables
Weights	(100.00)	(31.14)	(22.42)	(8.08)	(10.91)	(16.15)	(11.31)
Sep 2025	5.4	6.28	4.39	8.47	10.07	1.78	3.12
Dec 2025	4.26	1.31	5.69	11.65	9.79	0.12	4.31
Mar 2026	3.84	0.71	5.46	12.07	9.27	-0.12	2.09
Jun 2026	5.73	2.83	8.48	13.98	6.74	1.53	7.13

goods. Capital goods refer to “manufactured” goods, other than intermediate goods, that are used in the production of other goods or services (but not as inputs), such as a tractor. Infrastructure goods are finished goods, mainly for infrastructure building.

Then come two categories of consumer

goods — non-durables (such as biscuits) for immediate consumption, and durables (such as a TV) with a longer life span.

What does the data reveal?

To find a more robust trend, this analysis considers quarterly growth rates in the

IIP. Also, to better understand the economy, it focuses on use-based classification.

The past three quarters (nine months) show a clear trend where consumer goods growth has been fairly tepid, especially for non-durables, while capital goods, infrastructure goods and intermediate goods growth have been very strong.

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist of Bank of Baroda, says there is a weakness in consumer demand both in rural and urban India, bogged down by higher prices.

“The weakness in demand for consumer non-durables is evident from the corporate earnings of many FMCG (fast moving consumer goods) companies. The high growth in capital and infrastructure goods is in line with the higher infrastructure spending taking place in the country, especially from the government's side. That also explains why intermediate goods have shown a rise, as everything from metals to machinery is

being used here,” said Sabnavis.

Weak growth in the production of primary goods is due to supply disruptions and higher prices, thanks to the events in West Asia. Dipti Deshpande, Senior Director and Principal Economist, Crisil Limited, said: “The weakness in consumer goods IIP during most quarters of fiscal 2026 was largely driven by pharmaceuticals, electronics, apparel and leather — sectors most vulnerable to tariff-related uncertainties.”

While overall growth in the IIP is pretty good, a clear trend of weak consumer demand and strong infrastructure demand is visible. But, as Deshpande points out, “Lower growth in consumer goods IIP relative to capital and intermediate goods IIP is more the norm than an exception.”

Since April 2024, capital and intermediate goods have consistently outperformed consumer goods output, with trend growth rates of 9.6% and 5.9%, respectively.



Barely Flies, Never Soars

Shalini Langer

IT'S THE seventh film Tom Holland is in as Spider-Man, the fourth as a solo superhero. And while the 30-year-old actor who began this a decade ago can still pass as just-past-teens, the Marvel franchise shows a tear in its spandex. Less Brand New Day, more New Branding Day.

Director Destin Daniel Cretton and old Spidey hands Chris McKenna and Erik Sommers could have actually made something of 'been there, done that, and moving-on'. However, except for some mild stretching and a mention that he is no longer in high school, there is no suggestion that Peter Parker/Spider-Man (Tom Holland) needs anyone or anything.

That, in fact, is one of the premises driving *Brand New Day* — can Peter really continue as he insists he can, ridding New York city of crime and returning home to a garage-like room, only to fiddle with machines and science (he handles this too on his own), with no one to talk to but a virtual assistant, and nothing to entertain him but

videos posted by old friends Ned (Jacob Batalon) and MJ (Zendaya)?

If you have been watching Holland's Spider-Man universe closely, or even tracking *Brand New Day*'s recent publicity tour, you know that at the end of the last film, Peter erased Ned and MJ's memories for their safety, so they no longer remember him. His first encounter with them, especially watching MJ kiss a new boyfriend, is heartachingly conveyed by the expressive Holland.

However, the film doesn't offer too many such moments, as Spider-Man gets constantly thrown into saving the government's ominously named 'Department of Damage Control' from a threat posed by a being who can control people's minds. Jean (Sadie Sink) hops from body to body for this, with each person succumbing to her powers with a jolt that surely is too much of a giveaway. After the first few times, it is just clumsy.

Bruce Banner / Hulk (Mark Ruffalo) gets hauled in for exposition of some gobbledygook science about building an m-RNA inhibitor involving one's own DNA, foreign

SPIDERMAN BRAND NEW DAY

★★★★

DIRECTOR: Destin Daniel Cretton

CAST: Tom Holland, Zendaya, Jacob Batalon, Mark Ruffalo, Jon Bernthal, Sadie Sink, Tramell Tillman

DNA and gamma radiation. Later, he is called upon to do some very impressive smashing, though all of it seems completely superfluous except to give the film an extra superhero to lean on.

Florence Pugh is in an equally thankless role as Black Widow, though if she is indeed logged into the world's cyber secrets while lounging unclothed in a swimming pool, that is some power of Muskian dimension.

Tramell Tillman is Metzger, the Director of the Department of Damage Control, who clearly relishes having dangerous characters with supernatural abilities under his lock and key, in many tall buildings across the city. Surely, a more discreet location would serve his purpose better.

Jon Bernthal plays Frank, Spider-Man's on again-off again rival-friend. Who can remain angry for long with Peter Parker, though — and so you know how that goes.

Not the most obvious choice for this big-ticket project, director Cretton does well in the building-destroying, city-smashing, Ninja-ass-kicking fight sequences. Holland gets an ample range to perform, from the

forlorn lover to the lonesome guy and science wizard, and from a superhero confused about his "changing" powers to a man embracing the arachnid side within him. His Spider-Man also keeps getting thrown about, thrashed and squished, bearing the bruises vividly.

However, there is one crucial element missing in this Spider-Man, which is, at the heart of it, a story about a boy: sheer fun. While Holland swings and swooshes, and has his web feature malfunction as he battles the changes within him, *Brand New Day* gets caught up (often literally) in the dynamics of it and never actually in the flying of it — the kind of flight where you can feel the rush in your ears and the wind in your hair.

"With great power comes great responsibility" does get mentioned, but then *Brand New Day* offers a variation on what remains one of the movies' greatest lines.

It does answer a question that many have wondered about: Yes, Spider-Man does not take his mask off even while drinking coffee.



Short on Laughs

Anandu Suresh

WHAT IF sci-fi movies and literature have been lying to us all along? What if aliens don't have any superpowers and are our mirror images? Only, their technology is advanced enough for interstellar travel.

Director Adithyan Chandrashekar's *Pluto* revolves around Vignesh alias Vicky (Neeraj Madhav). He and his friend Jose (Subin Tarzan) are on a mission to earn money quickly, believing it will earn them respect. Despite multiple failing business plans, they aren't discouraged, until one.

As he slowly begins to feel he may actually be a "loser", he encounters an alien (Althaf Salim) who has lost his spacecraft. They become friends, and Vicky names him Pluto. Meanwhile, 'notorious' local criminal 'Tiger' Thambi (Aju Varghese) learns about Pluto and his spacecraft and is determined to get hold of both. The remainder of the film follows Vicky's efforts to keep Pluto safe.

Pluto had potential. There are few novel ideas — such as an alien with almost no superpowers; who consumes only liquor for food; and had to run away from home after failing an exam — but the makers never use these to elevate the film. They could have focused on comedy. However, genuine laughter evoking humour is absent. One might find oneself sitting through the movie quite emotionless.

But *Pluto*'s biggest shortcoming is its refusal to take an absolute plunge into absurdity. There are moments of bizarre amusement, but the story never completely lets loose. The jokes could have been better jokes and the one-liners sharper.

For instance, the resemblance in 'Tiger' Thambi's appearance to Detective Jamban from the popular comic series *Jambanum Thumbanum*, published in the children's magazine *Balarama*, had immense potential. Although, the character is caricaturish, the writer never quite makes the best use of Thambi's strengths.

The same can be said about Pluto. Once the script introduces the character, it doesn't attempt to explore him further or add depth. During a fight sequence, we see that Pluto can turn back time by 60 seconds using his spacecraft. While this appears fascinating the first time, the movie keeps using it repeatedly, drying up the viewer's intrigue.

Even though the visual language created by director Adithyan Chandrashekar and cinematographer Vishnu Sarma resembles comics — with cuts, occasional on-screen text and special effects underscoring the same — this is predominantly absent in the writing. As a result, there is an evident gap between the visuals and the script.

Even though Vicky and Pluto are largely together, they rarely share a memorable moment. Did Vicky matter to Pluto beyond being his sole source for liquor? Did Vicky actually care for Pluto beyond the intrigue factor? Although the movie tries to maintain, towards the end, that they hold a special place in each other's hearts, there are almost no instances in the script that organically highlight this.

Pluto may have worked better had the central characters been played by younger actors. The sort of elasticity that a performer ought to have while portraying such characters — where they have to be as cartoonish as possible, making the best use of their young physique — is almost absent in Neeraj Madhav and Althaf Salim. There are quite a few scenes when it appears that they are trying too hard to fit into their roles. Only Aju Varghese impresses as 'Tiger' Thambi, despite the limitations of his underexplored character.

Sanath Sivara's editing deserves praise for uplifting the otherwise mediocre *Pluto* by cartoonising the visuals on many occasions. He also brings vibrancy to the chaotic scenes, despite the makers' hesitation to explore their full scope. Arcado's music and original score are also solid.

Between a Shark and a Hard Place

IT'S DEBATABLE whether the creators of the killer shark movie, *The Devil's Mouth*, really care for us to pay attention. A direct-to-streaming Prime Video release, this creature feature seems tailored for distracted viewers who glance up every few beats or so to take in another feeding frenzy — and even those aren't that amusing.

Directed by Jeff Wadlow, the film follows a familiar horror template: A group of five reckless college friends take a trip along the coast of Thailand, where they go on a tour that goes awry. The group finds itself in a submerged cave system that turns out to be menaced by a hungry bull shark. Their local guide (Tayme Thapthimthong, from *The White Lotus*) quickly, and understandably, abandons the crew to bicker among themselves as the beast picks them off one by one in underwhelming, visually muddled attack scenes.

Moments of unintentional silliness had me wishing the film had committed to some camp, but as it stands, the script suggests that the writers had something more serious in mind than a shark-feast Grand Guignol. Tensions between the group's leading ladies, besties Sara (Kathryn Newton) and Max (Lana Condor), aspire to the bruised psychological dynamics that fuel a subterranean survival thriller like *The Descent* (2005). But the



THE DEVIL'S MOUTH

DIRECTOR: Jeff Wadlow

CAST: Kathryn Newton, Lana Condor, Nico Hiraga, Gavin Casalegno, Tommi Rose

STREAMING ON: Prime Video

many parallels with that film only emphasise the gap between them, making *The Devil's Mouth* come off like a dingy-fish-bowl version of the real thing.

Newton and Condor have enough personality to make their characters more than just floating appetizers — though their power struggle doesn't sharpen the stakes so much as it merely pads the running time. Sara is the sympathetic one to Max's tyrant, but I'm firmly team shark.

-NYT

Much Ado about Nothing

Shubhra Gupta

BHAI TERA *Star Hai* begins with promise. Mostly for what it's not. It's not a period film. It's not propaganda. Phew.

A light-hearted caper, set in London, revolving around a set of individuals whose main job is to collect cash from another set of individuals is the kind of premise which makes you hope for some harmless fun, wrapped in smart lines, paced well enough so you don't notice the run-time.

But all too soon, the film runs out of steam, and all you are left with ricocheting randomness: character A up against character B, going round and round without direction, making it a comedy with scant laughs.

Struggling actor Ajay (Raghav Juyal; so meta yay, despite *Kill* and *The Ba***ds Of Bollywood*) has borrowed 10,000 pounds from bar owner Fatty (Sanjay Kapoor), who runs a shady betting business on the side while serving up pints of beer. It's never



BHAI TERA STAR HAI ★★

DIRECTOR: Vivek B Agrawal

CAST: Raghav Juyal, Sanjay Kapoor, Vikalp Mehta, Vivan Bhatena, Niharika NM, Barkha Singh, Niki Wallia, Tina Desai, Parvathy Omanakuttan, Chandan Roy Sanyal

made clear why the former needed the money in the first place, even if the entire film is spent in him trying to snaffle it from

here, there and everywhere.

The rest of the characters have been handed out the same memo. JD (Vikalp Mehta) shadows Ajay as the latter goes about fruitlessly trying to make people cough up money. Dogging their steps are a pair of goofy paramedics, whose purpose is revealed later when JD gets shot with gun wielded by a prepubescent young fellow. They come to the rescue but how do you

•STREAMING WATCHLIST



Balan: The Boy

ZEE5

SET IN Kerala, *Balan: The Boy* follows a teenager whose life is upended when his mother mysteriously disappears. Haunted by unanswered questions and painful memories, he

sets out to uncover the truth and find closure. Directed by Chidambaram, the film stars Adhisheshan K R, Muhammad Zinaan, Farzana Palathingal, Jean Paul Lal, Dolly June, Girish A D and Beena Antony, with Tovino Thomas in an extended cameo.



Furious

JOHOTSTAR

CREATED BY Elizabeth Meriwether, *Furious* follows FBI agent Alice Black (Emmy Rossum) on the hunt for a mysterious and calculating female serial killer (Lola Petticrew). Both walk their own paths toward justice, and as their lives start to intertwine, the line between right and wrong begins to blur. The cast also features Scoot McNairy, Quincy Tyler Bernstine and Jake Lacy. Three episodes are streaming now with new ones releasing on Mondays.



Batman: The Caped Crusader S2

PRIME VIDEO

THE ANIMATED series reimagines the Batman mythology through a new lens. The series returns to the early years of

Gotham's fearsome vigilante, following billionaire Bruce Wayne as tragedy transforms him into Batman and sets him on a relentless war against crime. Night after night, he takes on overwhelming odds as he navigates danger and the consequences of becoming something both more and less than human.



Chum

LIONSGATE PLAY

A DESTINATION wedding in Malta takes a terrifying turn when a shark attacks a group of newlyweds and their friends aboard a catamaran. Rescued by a rugged fisherman, the

group soon discovers that their saviour may pose a greater threat. As tensions rise on board, the wedding party is forced to fight for survival. Directed by Jonathan Zuck, the film stars Alice Eve, Eric Michael Cole, Elle Haymond and Jim Klock.

The Devil Wears Prada 2

JOHOTSTAR



SET TWO decades after *The Devil Wears Prada*, the sequel finds Miranda Priestly (Meryl Streep) facing a new challenge as she battles her former assistant Emily Charlton (Emily Blunt) for advertising revenue at a time when print media is in decline. Andy Sachs (Anne Hathaway) returns to help her navigate the changing media landscape. It is directed by David Frankel and written by Aline Brosh McKenna.

ALAKA SAHANI

patch up a wound which never reveals any blood? Like who gets a bullet into the shoulder with nothing to show for it, with nary a tear or a hole?

Then, there's the handsome Sid (Vivan Bhatena) whose sole job is to bar-hop, along with a gorgeous girl (Barkha Singh) who has feelings for him, while he still yearns for his ex. An assortment of women (Tina Desai, Niharika NM, Parvathy Omanakuttan) show up one by one, all of whom feel as if they would have been much more fun if the film had revolved around just them, and not the clueless guys tumbling about the streets of London.

Raghav Juyal's game trier with nifty dance moves is let down by a gormless script that doesn't know quite what to do with its ensemble after a point. Sanjay Kapoor is seasoned enough to slide through the silliness. The always enjoyable Chandan Roy Sanyal comes on too late as a cop who 'hates actors'. The efficient Niki Wallia reminds you of a younger Kirron Kher in her persona of an irate Punjabi wife. The other women, all interesting faces without much to do, become indistinguishable from each other.

A character says to another: 'You're not funny, so just stop it.' Pretty much what you can say about the entire film.

SCHEME IS EXPECTED TO CATALYSE RESERVE ACCRETION OF OVER 600 MN TONNES OF OIL, OIL EQUIVALENT GAS

Govt nod to Rs 84K-cr scheme to boost offshore oil & gas exploration

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, July 31

THE UNION Cabinet on Friday approved a Rs 84,084-crore scheme to boost oil and gas exploration and production from the country’s offshore basins, and reduce the dependence on imported energy.

The ambitious ‘Samudra Manthan’ scheme, or the National Offshore Exploration Scheme, will provide financial support for exploratory drilling in deep-sea and ultra-deep-sea areas and support building of common infrastructure for production of discovered hydrocarbons in offshore areas, apart from funding offshore data acquisition and developing hydrocarbon manufacturing and services zones.

The outlay is for implementation till financial year 2030-31. The Centre expects the ‘Samudra Manthan’ scheme to catalyse reserve accretion of over 600 million tonnes of oil and oil equivalent gas (mtoe), while stimulating significant investments across the oil and gas exploration and production value chain. India is the world’s third-largest consumer of crude oil and also a major consumer of natural gas, but has a high degree of import dependency — over 88% for oil and about 50% in the case of natural gas.

This makes the country’s economy vulnerable to global energy market volatility, and even poses supply risks, as has

• ‘Samudra Manthan’ scheme: Where the money will be spent

₹43,200 CR

Will be allocated to support deep-sea exploratory drilling, which involves significant costs and risks, while ₹28,534 crore will be earmarked for offshore data acquisition.

• Another **₹10,000 crore** will be used to partially fund building of common infrastructure to bring the discovered oil and gas reserves into production, while ₹2,000 crore will be earmarked for developing oil and gas manufacturing and services zones.



THE SCHEME WILL PROVIDE SUPPORT OF UP TO 50% OF DRILLING COST OR ₹675 CRORE, WHICHEVER IS LOWER, FOR EVERY WELL DRILLED IN DEEP-SEA AND ULTRA-DEEP-SEA AREAS

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F> been witnessed during the ongoing West Asia crisis.

Moreover, the country’s energy demand is on the rise, while domestic production is stagnant. Subject to exploration success, the scheme aims to increase India’s domestic oil and gas production from around 62 mtoe to 80 mtoe annually and expand the country’s hydrocarbon resource base from 1,600 mtoe to 2,200 mtoe. The additional production has the potential to reduce crude oil imports by nearly Rs 1 lakh crore annually, strengthening India’s energy security and reducing import dependence, as per the government. “The Scheme en-

compasses a comprehensive set of interventions across the offshore exploration value chain. It provides for large-scale acquisition, processing and interpretation of high-quality seismic data, accelerated deepwater and ultra-deepwater exploratory drilling, scientific drilling in frontier basins, development of common offshore production and evacuation infrastructure, and establishment of an integrated Oil & Gas Manufacturing and Services Zone,” the government said in a release

“It also includes dedicated provisions for digital programme management, capacity building, technology adoption,

stakeholder engagement and international outreach, creating an integrated ecosystem to accelerate offshore exploration and production in the country,” it added.

The initiative was first indicated last year by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in his Independence Day address. Under the scheme, Rs 43,200 crore will be allocated to support deep-sea exploratory drilling, which involves significant costs and risks, while Rs 28,534 crore will be earmarked for offshore data acquisition. Another Rs 10,000 crore will be used to partially fund building of common infrastructure to bring the dis-

covered oil and gas reserves into production, while Rs 2,000 crore will be earmarked for developing oil and gas manufacturing and services zones.

The scheme will provide support of up to 50% of drilling cost or Rs 675 crore, whichever is lower, for every well drilled in deep-sea and ultra-deep-sea areas. Drilling at such depths is an expensive proposition, costing between \$100 million and \$250 million per well, as per industry estimates.

It is also risky as the drilling activity may not lead to any oil or natural gas discovery.

In certain cases, even if hydrocarbons are discovered, it may not be commercially viable to exploit them. The scheme, officials expect, will mitigate some of the investment risks for upstream oil and gas players, and increase investment into the sector. “India’s future hydrocarbon potential lies largely in deepwater and ultra-deepwater basins such as Krishna-Godavari, Cauvery, Mahanadi and the Andaman region. Exploration in these frontier areas requires advanced technology and significant investment...Recognising the high-risk, high-cost nature of such exploration, the Government is adopting a risk-sharing approach to encourage sustained investment, accelerate exploration, and unlock India’s offshore hydrocarbon resources” the government said.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

N-reactor cost soars 55%: Why price escalation may affect clean energy plans

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, July 31

THE PROJECT cost of the four under-construction Russian-designed nuclear reactor units at the Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant has increased by nearly 55% over the original sanctioned cost since the outbreak of war between Russia and Ukraine.

As per latest government data, the cost of these four reactors, each with 1 gigawatt capacity, increased from Rs 89,470 crore to Rs 1,38,330 crore. The project cost of Units 3 and 4 has increased by 72.9%, while that of Units 5 and 6 has risen by 39.9% over their respective sanctioned costs. Located in Tirunelveli district of Tamil Nadu, Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant is one of largest nuclear power projects of India.

It consists of six units of Pressurised Water Reactors of VVER design, which were established in technical collaboration with Russia. The first two units (KKNPP Units-1 & 2) are already in operation, while Units 3 and 4 are still under construction and are due to be operational by 2027.

The remaining two units are at different stages of progress and are likely to be commissioned by 2030. The sharp rise in project costs comes at a crucial juncture for India’s nuclear power sector. Last year,

the government opened the tightly regulated civil nuclear sector to private participation, drawing interest from global nuclear technology suppliers from Russia, the United States and France.

As Indian companies evaluate partnerships and competing reactor technologies, project costs are expected to be a key consideration as any significant cost escalation could ultimately translate into higher electricity tariffs.

Cost revision for indigenous reactor

Meanwhile, the cost revision process is also underway for two other ongoing nuclear power projects — Kaiga in Karnataka and Gorakhpur in Haryana. Both projects are based on India’s indigenous Pressurised Heavy Water Reactor (PHWR) technology and comprise two 700 MWe reactor units each.

A similar trend is visible at the Rajasthan Atomic Power Project (RAPP) in Rawatbhata, where the cost of two indigenous PHWR units has surged by about 86% over the original sanctioned cost.

While one of the units commenced commercial operations in April this year, the second is in the advanced stages of commissioning. Fuel costs for nuclear plants represent a small proportion of total

generating costs. However, capital costs of nuclear power plants are higher than those for coal-fired plants and much higher than those for gas-fired plants.

As per World Nuclear Association, the economics of new nuclear plants are heavily influenced by their capital cost, which accounts for at least 60% of their Levelised Cost of Electricity (LCOE), the total cost to build and operate a power plant over its lifetime divided by the total electricity output dispatched from the plant over that period.

Interest charges and the construction period are also key determinants of the final cost of power.

Once a nuclear plant has been built, the production cost of electricity is low and predictably stable. Thus, any cost escalation has the potential to make electricity generated by plants more expensive.

This could pose a challenge to India’s ambitious nuclear expansion plans in a price-sensitive electricity market. It can also affect the competitiveness of nuclear power relative to other sources of generation. India has faced such concerns before.

The proposed French-assisted nuclear power project at Jaitapur in Maharashtra has remained stalled for years, with the expected high electricity tariff emerging as one of the key hurdles to its progress.

Central government’s capex soars 66% in June, subsidy bill jumps too

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, July 31

The Central government’s capital expenditure surged 66% year-on-year in June to Rs 89,255 crore, data released Friday by the Controller General of Accounts showed.

Despite this sharp increase in capex, the Centre’s total spending in June was unchanged from the same month last year, as a 31% decline in interest payments helped lower revenue expenditure by 8%.

The marked rise in investments by the Centre in June means it’s now on track to meet its capex target of Rs 12.22 lakh crore for 2026-27, with 28% of the target met in the first three months of the year.

Meanwhile, subsidies also rose sharply, with expenditure for urea subsidy up 68% in April-June as a whole at Rs 53,034 crore. On the income side, gross tax collections in June were up only 6%, with the excise mop-up down 25% from last year at Rs 21,951 crore, reflecting the duty cuts announced for petrol and diesel in late March. In the first three months of 2026-27, the Centre’s excise duty collections are down 22% at Rs 43,149 crore.

“Weak” growth in Goods and Services Tax collections also weighed on the Centre’s receipts in April, said Aditi Nayar,

Chief Economist at rating agency ICRA.

“However, customs duty inflows surged by 36%, aided by the duty hikes on gold and silver, elevated global commodity prices, as well as a low base.” According to Devendra Kumar Pant, Chief Economist at India Ratings & Research, the government’s finances for the first quarter of 2026-27 as a whole suggest the impact of the West Asia war “is not significant”.

“The impact of higher oil prices is not yet fully visible on Union government finances. Had the government not reduced excise duty on petrol and diesel, the tax collections would have been higher,” Pant said.

The Union Budget for 2026-27 estimated Rs 3.89 lakh crore would be collected from excise duty this fiscal. In the first three months of the year, 11% of the target has been collected.

Income tax collections were up 7% in June as well as April-June compared to last year. The corporate tax mop-up was up 17% in June and 20% in the quarter. On the whole, the Centre’s fiscal deficit — the difference between its income and expenditure that it must bridge by borrowing — was Rs 1.45 lakh crore in June, down 46% from the same month last year.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Bloomberg defers India’s inclusion into global index

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, July 31

DESPITE THE best efforts of the government and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), Bloomberg Index Services Ltd (BISL) on Friday again deferred the inclusion of Indian government bonds into its Bloomberg Global Aggregate Index, saying the announced reforms need to be “fully reflected in day-to-day market practice” before such a decision is made.

Coming more than six months after its last update, the latest deferral will disappoint the bond market that has seen improvement in foreign investments after a raft of measures were announced on June 5 to make Indian government bonds — issued by the Centre to borrow money and bridge the gap between its income and expenditure — more attractive to foreign investors.

In its statement, BISL said the Indian government bond market continues to make “meaningful progress toward meeting the global standards expected for inclusion”.

However, market players told BISL during its discussions that they would like to see the changes become “more firmly established in day-to-day market practice”.

“While automated trading capabilities continue to expand, respondents noted that implementation has not yet been fully completed across all major investor regions. In addition, a number of respondents indicated they would like to see further evidence that recent market reforms translate into more efficient operational workflows, including improvements to account opening and onboarding processes for foreign investors,” BISL said.

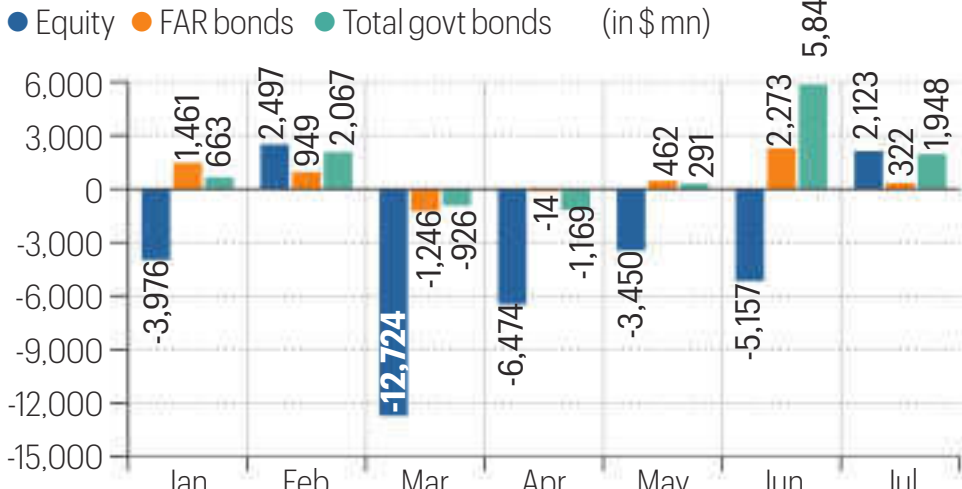
Apple’s June qtr revenue rises 16% on-year

New Delhi: Tech giant Apple has posted record June quarter revenue of \$109.4 billion, up 16% on a year-on-year basis, supported by double-digit growth in most emerging markets including India, but flagged business risks in the next few quarters due to rising memory chip prices and supply constraints, according to a top company official.

While Americas continues to be the biggest contributor in Apple’s revenue, the company recorded the highest growth rate of 22.42% in Greater China, followed by Europe 22.4% and Rest of Asia Pacific 15.6%.

“We achieved June quarter revenue records in every geographic segment. We were pleased to see strength across the board with June quarter records in the US, Latin America, Western Europe, India, China mainland, Japan, and Southeast Asia. “We also achieved June quarter revenue records in both developed and emerging markets and saw double-digit growth in most emerging markets,” Apple CEO Tim Cook said in the last earnings call as the company’s top executive. John Ternus is scheduled to take over as CEO on September 1, 2026. PTI

• Govt, RBI’s June 5 measures boosted FPI investment in bonds



Note: FAR is Fully Accessible Route category of bonds; total includes FAR bond investments. Source: NSDL

The Ministry of Finance did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Over the last couple of years, Indian government debt has been added to so-called global bond indices. This began with JPMorgan adding India to its emerging market index beginning June 2024. Subsequently, Bloomberg included India in its Emerging Market Local Currency Index from January 2025 and FTSE Russell to a similar one from September 2025.

Becoming a part of these bond indices is crucial to attracting passive investment flows; several global funds track the weight a certain country has in these bond indices and invest accordingly. India’s inclusion into the JPMorgan and Bloomberg emerging market index brought in billions of dollars of foreign money into the Indian government debt market, helping lower the interest paid by the Centre on its borrowings as demand for its bonds picked up due to these foreign buyers.

The government has made a concerted pitch for its bonds to be made a part of the Bloomberg Global Aggregate Index, with the

removal of capital gains tax as well as the withholding tax on investment by foreign investors in government bonds announced on June 5.

In its statement Friday, BISL said that as the Bloomberg Global Aggregate Index is the flagship index, it is “appropriate that any inclusion decision be supported not only by regulatory and market structure reforms, but also by demonstrated operational efficiency across the diverse range of investors that track and benchmark against the index”. As such, “additional time is warranted” before a decision is made. Economists think the addition of Indian sovereign debt into the Bloomberg Global Aggregate Bond Index could lead to inflows of \$20 billion-\$30 billion over 10 months.

This would have been invaluable at a time when a combination of global trade uncertainty, geopolitical conflicts, and India’s lack of exposure to the global AI investment boom has seen foreign capital exit domestic markets in droves, driving the rupee sharply lower.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• BRIEFLY

Microsoft sets record with near \$450 bn one-day market-cap gain

San Francisco: Microsoft added nearly \$450 billion in market value on Thursday, the largest one-day gain on record for a company, after it forecast stronger-than-expected cloud growth and signaled continued cash generation through its new fiscal year. The software giant’s shares closed up more than 15%, lifting its market capitalization to \$3.35 trillion, surpassing chip giant Nvidia’s (NVDA.O), opens new tab previous record one-day gain of \$441 billion on April 9, 2025, according to LSEG data. REUTERS

SEBI closes Religare open offer case

New Delhi: SEBI on Friday disposed of proceedings initiated against Religare Enterprises, its former Executive Chairperson Rashmi Saluja and five others over alleged non-compliance during the Burman Group’s open offer, holding that no further directions were warranted as the takeover process was already completed. In its latest order, it said the directions issued in the interim order cum show cause notice on June 19, 2024, were preventive and remedial in nature and had achieved their purpose after the open offer concluded and control of REL passed to the Burman Group in February 2025. PTI

• MARKETS

Sensex 78,094.64 166.49 0.21%	NIFTY 24,383.60 66.45 0.27%	Gold ▼ ₹1,42,860	US Dollar ▼ ₹95.39
		Silver ▼ ₹2,18,295	Oil ▲ \$90.04

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JULY 30, 2026

• COMMENTS CAME TWO DAYS BEFORE EUROPE’S LANDMARK AI ACT WITH TRANSPARENCY RULES KICK IN

EU says it’s necessary to monitor high risk AI systems

Reuters
Brussels, July 31

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE developers should have in place tools to monitor their systems for security risks, senior European Commission officials said on Friday, following hacking incidents by OpenAI and Anthropic AI models.

The comments came two days ahead before Europe’s landmark AI Act with transparency rules kick in, the first in the world to regulate a technology used in almost all sectors of businesses and society.

Anthropic said on Thursday some of its Claude AI models had hacked into the systems of three companies during cybersecurity tests, days after rival OpenAI revealed that one

of its AI agents went on a rogue attack. Both companies have briefed the Commission on the AI incidents, the officials told reporters.

“We have been informed by the two providers of incidents bilaterally before they become public. We are in contact with them. They will also report to us more information as we speak. We will see also if we need to follow up more formally on those things,” one of the officials said.

Another official talked up the crucial role of Europe’s AI rules. “So I think all these, let’s say, incidents highlight the importance of really putting in place the necessary monitoring activities by the developers,” the official said.

The AI rules requires providers of general-purpose AI



Anthropic and OpenAI have briefed the Commission. REUTERS
Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mjljMzg1 (GPAL) or foundation models to draw up technical documentation, adopt copyright policies

and provide detailed summaries about the content used for algorithm training.

Anthropic’s AI models hacked three companies during tests

San Francisco: Anthropic said on Thursday some of its Claude AI models had hacked into the systems of three companies during cybersecurity tests, a disclosure that comes days after rival OpenAI revealed that one of its AI agents went on a rogue attack.

The new incidents were due to a mistake that inadvertently gave Anthropic’s models access to the open internet. That contrasts with OpenAI, whose AI agent independently exploited a novel vulnerability to reach the internet during cyber testing. Even so, the latest disclosure underscores how AI

has increased threats to cybersecurity and how its developers can struggle to keep the capabilities of their models contained.

It is likely to add fuel to an intensifying US government push to better manage AI security risks at a time when Anthropic and OpenAI are racing to release more capable systems ahead of their planned public listings. Prominent leaders at these labs have called for a slowdown to address risks first. San Francisco-based Anthropic said in a blog post it identified the incidents after reviewing 141,006 test sessions. REUTERS



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

Dy. SP Hqrs., Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Prem Parkash S/O Gopal Dass R/O H.No. 90, Talab Tillo District Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 59/1980 U/S 279/338 RPC of P/S Nowabadq, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned address is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name :	Prem Parkash
S/O :	Gopal Dass
Address :	H.No. 90, Talab Tillo District Jammu

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO, Jammu :	0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D. :	sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu :	0191-2605949
4. SP City North :	0191-2547038
5. Dy. SP Hqrs. :	0191-2562259
6. SHO P/S Nowabad :	0191-2565274

Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

No.

Date:-

DIP/J-7096/26 – DATE 21 JULY 2026

.07.2026

CROSSWORD

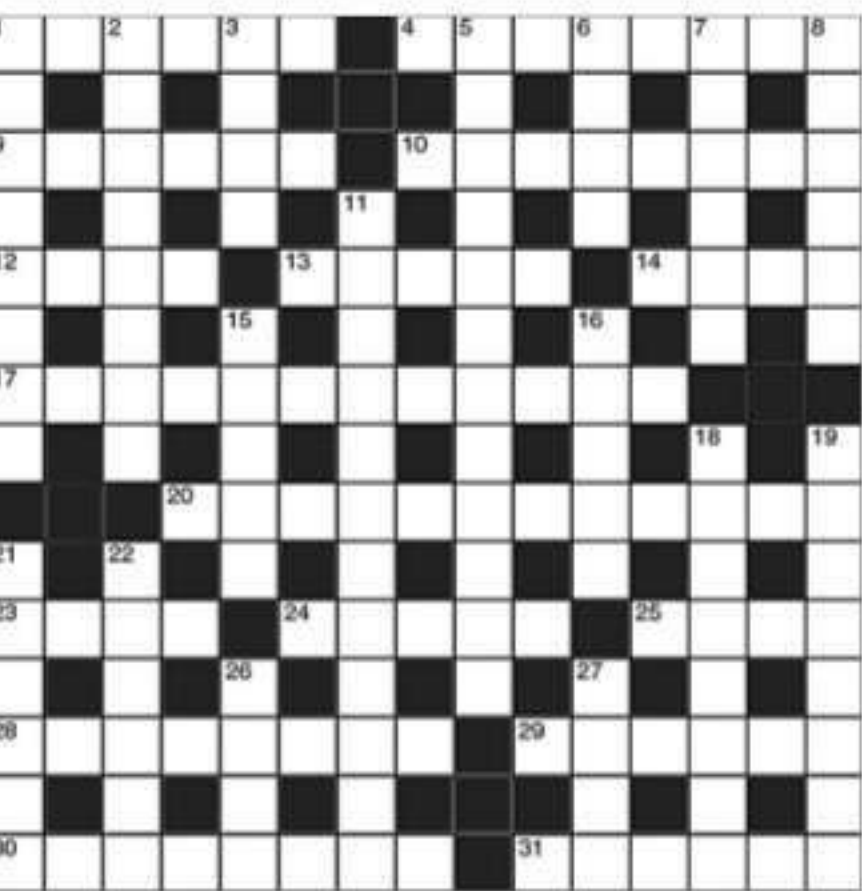
6056

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS



- ACROSS
- 1 A horse being exercised on the beach (6)
- 4 Surprise shots in a melee (8)
- 9 Lets out American imprisoned in brawl (6)
- 10 Get an assorted haul with bait as usual (8)
- 12 The company is not out to make money (4)
- 13 Lives wildly producing social problems (5)
- 14 Sort of wolves apparently extinct? (4)
- 17 Overdrawing an account (12)
- 20 He has a small life interest (12)
- 23 Find places to stay in opposite directions (4)
- 24 One of Sheridan's competitors (5)
- 25 Visitors to Sicily may see it before coming back (4)
- 28 Drop a hint to a close acquaintance (8)
- 29 Bound to come once a year (6)
- 30 Extensively used troops (8)
- 31 No more wine — that's the limit (6)
- DOWN
- 1 Things people write (8)
- 2 Crashed pilot has treatment provided here (8)
- 3 It's made to measure (4)
- 5 Embarrassed lady describing pagan Rome? (7,5)
- 6 Disorientated Indo-European god (4)
- 7 Accustoms user in new process (6)
- 8 He has a title within his grasp (6)
- 11 In a way I serve to tell practically nothing (4,2,6)
- 15 Maturing drink in silver container (5)
- 16 In any case a refusal will not please (5)
- 18 Bitter criticism — I'd bear it somehow (8)
- 19 Honest deal? (8)
- 21 Expressed sorrow for sounding rough (6)
- 22 How to march on foot (6)
- 26 Doctor on morning rounds (4)
- 27 Top primate gets the vote (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6055 ACROSS: 1 Feign, 4 Entails, 8 Aim, 9 Water polo, 10 Cedilla, 11 Issue, 13 Enacts, 15 Errata, 18 Deeds, 19 Orotund, 21 Forging, 23 Own, 24 Sleight, 25 Thyme DOWN: 1 Fiancee, 2 Immediate, 3 Newel, 4 Extras, 5 Terrier, 6 Ibo, 7 Score, 12 Statutory, 14 Tasting, 16 Andante, 17 Soviet, 18 Doffs, 20 Ought, 22 Rue

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

There is always some ___ in love. But there is also always some reason in ___. - Friedrich Nietzsche (7,..7) (same word twice)

KLNAE

SUNIS

EORTDN

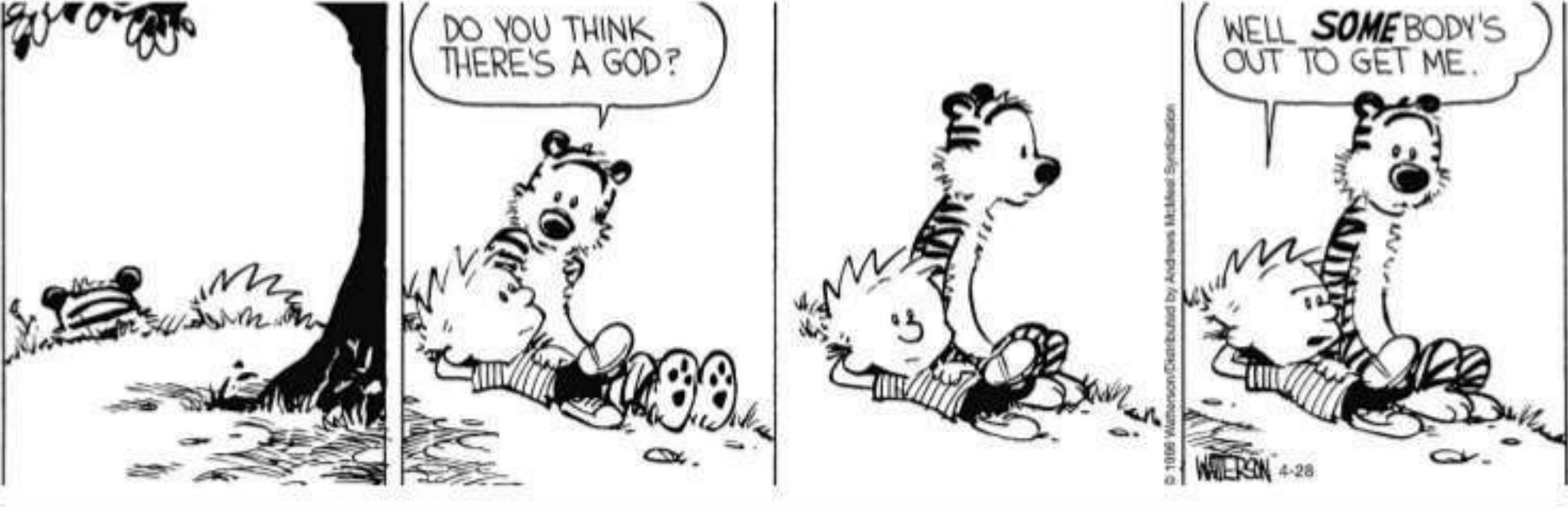
AEKNUM

ANSWER: There is always some madness in love. But there is also always some reason in madness.



CALVIN & HOBBS

BY BILL WATTERSON



MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 4s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6397

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6396

CORPORATE BRIEFS

EDUCATION



RISHIHOOD UNIVERSITY- APPOINTMENT

Rishihood University has appointed Kshitiz Anand as the Director of its School of Design, reinforcing the university's commitment to reimagining design education for a rapidly evolving world. An alumnus of IIT Guwahati and Indiana University, Kshitiz has held leadership roles at prominent organizations such as Paytm and Tata 1mg, Design Village, and others while also founding purpose-driven ventures and educational initiatives. Over the last 20 years, he built products, ventures, and learning initiatives across education, healthcare, fintech, and digital transformation.



NORTHCAP UNIVERSITY- ORIENTATION

NCU welcomed its new undergraduate and postgraduate students with Deeksharambh, an Orientation Program held on 27th July, 2026, marking the beginning of their academic journey. Students from Engineering, Law, Management, Sciences, Psychology, Commerce, English, Media & Entertainment, and other disciplines participated in interactive sessions introducing them to campus life and the University's values. Following the orientation, students are undergoing a three-week induction programme designed for a smooth transition from school life to university life.



RISHIHOOD UNIVERSITY- APPOINTMENT

Rishihood University has appointed Gayatri Anand as the Director of the Mahesh Navani School of Brain, Body & Behavior (MaNaS). An alumnus of Columbia University, Gayatri has worked for the Delhi Government and Teach for America. She is an education leader with ~13 years of experience across India and the US and has led large-scale initiatives impacting over 800,000 learners. At Rishihood, she will lead MaNaS' institutional growth, research ecosystem and strategic partnerships to advance interdisciplinary research and education at the intersection of brain, body, and behavior.



GNIoT - ORIENTATION

GNIoT Institute of Management Studies, successfully organised MERAKI 2026, the Orientation Programme for its PGDM Batch (2026-28), at the India Expo Centre. The event welcomed over 450 students from 23 states, along with parents, industry leaders, academicians, and distinguished guests. Hon'ble Shri Chirag Paswan, Union Minister of Food Processing Industries, GOI, attended as the Chief Guest and inspired students to contribute to the vision of Viksit Bharat through education, skill development, innovation, discipline, and leadership. Stressing the importance of continuous learning, integrity, and perseverance, he encouraged students to become job creators and future leaders. Shri Paswan also commended GIMS for its achievements in education, skill development, and placements over the past six years. The programme marked an inspiring beginning for the new PGDM batch, reflecting GIMS' commitment to academic excellence and holistic management education.



KIET - CONVOCAION

KIET Deemed to be University conferred degrees on 3,821 graduates of the 2025 and 2026 batches of AKTU during its Annual Convocation 2026. Addressing the gathering, Vice Chancellor Prof. Nagaraj Ramrao highlighted KIET's academic excellence, industry partnerships, global collaborations, research achievements, and strong placement record, including an international package of 1.78 crore and 4,600 job offers from over 350 recruiters. University medalists and rank holders were honoured with cash awards. Prof. Virendra Pathak encouraged graduates to uphold integrity and lifelong learning.

NIET - RECOGNITION

Noida Institute of Engineering and Technology (NIET) Pharmacy Institute has secured 1st Rank in Uttar Pradesh and 4th Rank nationally in the QCI-PCI Rankings 2026, besides earning the prestigious 'A' Grade Recognition. The recognition highlights the institute's excellence in academic quality, research, governance, infrastructure, faculty, industry collaboration, and student-centric education. Expressing his delight, Dr. Avijit Mazumder, Director, NIET Pharmacy Institute, said the achievement reflects the collective dedication of students, faculty, researchers, staff, and institutional leadership. He reaffirmed the institute's commitment to delivering world-class pharmaceutical education, fostering innovation, and preparing future-ready pharmacy professionals. The QCI-PCI recognition further strengthens NIET Pharmacy Institute's position among India's leading pharmacy institutions and underscores its continued focus on quality assurance, research excellence, industry engagement, and holistic professional development, while contributing meaningfully to the healthcare sector and society.



AMITY UNIVERSITY - ORIENTATION

Amity Institute of Behavioural (Health) & Allied Sciences (AIBHAS), Amity University Uttar Pradesh, organised a two-day 'Deeksharambh' Orientation Programme for 50 newly admitted students of its RCI-recognised behavioural health programmes for the academic session 2026-27. The programme commenced with a traditional Havan led by Vice Chancellor Dr. Balvinder Shukla. Addressing students, she highlighted the importance of ethical values, academic excellence, and compassion in building successful mental health professionals. Dr. Kalpana Srivastava, Director, AIBHAS, emphasised holistic learning and clinical training, while Group Vice Chancellor Dr. Gurinder Singh highlighted global opportunities in psychology. The programme also featured expert sessions on career pathways, professional ethics, RCI guidelines, alumni interaction, and student support systems.



NDIM - ORIENTATION

The New Delhi Institute of Management (NDIM) inaugurated the Orientation Programme for its 31st PGDM Batch (2026-28) with an inspiring address by Dr. Mahesh Gupta, Chairman & Managing Director, Kent RO Systems Ltd., NDIM Board Member, and a valued recruiter. He urged students to develop leadership, character, and lifelong learning while highlighting that human judgment, creativity, ethics, and curiosity will remain indispensable in the AI era. The highly interactive session witnessed enthusiastic student participation, setting an inspiring tone for their management journey at NDIM.



GURU GOBIND SINGH INDRAPRASTHA UNIVERSITY - EVENT

An educational delegation led Mr. Tazul Islam, First Secretary (Education), High Commission of Bangladesh visited the University. The delegation was welcomed by the VC of the University Mahesh Verma and the team members of Directorate of International Affairs of the University. The discussions focused on expanding the University's international outreach by providing affordable and quality education to students from across the globe, while strengthening academic collaboration with higher education institutions in Bangladesh. The meeting also explored avenues to enhance academic engagement and participation of Bangladeshi students at GGSIPU.

MEDAL Tally

	Country	G	S	B	Total
1	AUS	52	26	40	118
2	CAN	17	14	18	49
3	ENG	15	31	25	71
4	SCO	10	7	16	33
5	NIG	8	5	3	16
9	IND	5	11	4	20

*TILL 31/07, 11:45 PM

INDIA watch



Triple jumper Praveen Chithravel. PTI

ATHLETICS

Men's Triple Jump: Praveen Chithravel, Selva Prabhu **2:40 pm** Men's 1500 T54: Ramesh Shanmugam **2:50 pm** Women's 10000m racewalk: Priyanka, Ravina **3 pm** Men's Pole Vault: Dev Meena, Kuldeep **11:35 pm** Men's 5000m: Gulveer Singh **1:05 am (Sunday)** Mixed 4x400m Relay: Rajesh Ramesh, Vishal TK, Ansa Babu, Neeru Pathak, Rashdeep Kaur **1:50am (Sunday)**



Boxer Preeti will compete in the 54 kg final. PTI

BOXING

Women's 54kg final: Preeti Pawar vs Scarlett Delgado (Canada) **3:30 pm** Women's 57kg final: Jaismine vs Michela Walsh (Northern Ireland) **3:45 pm** Men's 55kg final: Jadumani Singh vs Jye Dixon (Australia) **4:45pm** Women's 70kg final: Arundhati Choudhary vs Chantelle Reid (England) **9:45pm** Men's 80kg final: Ankush Panghal vs Dimeji Shittu (England) **11:15pm**

CYCLING

Men's Sprint Qualifying: David Beckham, Ronaldo Singh, Rojit Singh **2:30 pm** Men's 10km scratch race qualifying: Harshveer Sekhon, Dinesh Kumar **4:19 pm**

JUDO

Women's 63kg round of 16: Unnati Sharma vs Lamuela Malaguga **3:50 pm** Men's 90kg round of 16: Karanjit Singh Maan v Elliott Connolly (New Zealand) **4:25 pm** Women's 70kg round of 8: Inunganbi Takhellambam v TBD **5:10 pm** Men's 81kg round of 16: Harsh Tokas v Odyseas Georgakis **5 pm**

● GOLD-MEDAL WINNING SHOW

Emily, the chef who can cook up a storm and do heavy lifting

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, July 31

NEVER TELL the likes of Erling Haaland or CWG champ Emily Campbell to go back to the kitchen. They might actually enjoy it.

Haaland made cooking by top-tier macho athletes look cool, in June. Videos of his tomahawk steak preparations were viral during the World Cup. Now, England's decorated weightlifter Emily Campbell, a double Olympic medallist, is rounding off her Commonwealth Games campaign winning the 86+ kg gold, coming into the Games straight from the Celebrity MasterChef kitchen where she unfurled her signature dish - a classical Caribbean curried mutton.

The 32-year-old lifted a total of 278 kg (115 Snatch + 163 Clean & Jerk), for a Games record. She was the only British lifter to be sent to Paris Olympics, and returned with a silver. "It was really nice for me to do something without being Emily the weightlifter. Food is something

Cycle mechanic's daughter from Tripura wins first judo gold

A tribute to late father, who introduced her to the martial art; 'Wish he was alive to see his daughter win,' says mother

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, July 31

WHEN 23-YEAR-OLD Asmita Dey won India's first-ever Commonwealth Games judo gold medal on Friday, it gave her mother something to celebrate just months after losing her husband to a stroke.

Asmita's title in the women's 48kg class was part of a memorable day for the Indian contingent in Glasgow as it was followed by Harsh Singh climbing to the top of the podium with a 10-0 win over Joshua Katz of Australia in the 60kg category and Yamini Mourya's silver in the women's 57kg class. Asmita registered a golden

score win over Canada's Heidi Quach in the final. She had earlier beaten Scotland's Eva Ewing in the quarterfinals via Ippon before winning by Yuko over Summer Shaw of Scotland in the semi-finals.

The family lives in a rented accommodation in the town of Belonia in South Tripura district. Apart from Asmita's mother Munna Patari Dey, her brother Debabrata Dey stays there. The last few months have been tough for the family.

"It was a very hard time for us. Her (Asmita's) father ran a cycle repair shop at the village and our domestic expenses too could not be met. But he always dreamt of giving Asmita every



Asmita with her gold medal after winning the 48kg category. PTI
Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mIjMzg1monwealthGamesgoldtoday," Munna told *The Indian Express* from Belonia. It was in 2013 that Asmita was taken to the Belonia Vi-

dyapeeth Coaching Center to train under Bina Debnath. For two years, Asmita would stay mostly at Debnath's home. "Even though they were a very poor family, I could sense a determination. There were days when she would not have the bus fare to go back to her village but I helped her with whatever I could. She was very quick in learning the basics and never complained," Debnath shared.

Two years later, Asmita was selected as a residential trainee at Agartala's Tripura Sports School by coach Manik Lal Deb. Along with coach Pranab Saha, the current secretary of the Tripura Judo Association, he would oversee Asmita's training. "When we selected her for the school, I could sense that this girl had a combat sense. Since she was very thin, we had to work on her strength and stamina a lot. Spending time at

the hostel meant that she had proper meals and nutrition. We had to identify the technique that would suit her and worked on her upper body strength. Sometimes, we coaches also had to pool money for her. To see her win gold is our guru dakshina," an emotional Manik Lal Deb told *The Indian Express*.

Steady progress

Medals in junior state as well as school nationals would be followed by Asmita joining the Sports Authority of India's Regional Centre at Bhopal under coach Yashpal Solanki.

In 2023, she won the 48kg title at the junior Asia Cup in Macau and followed that with a silver in the Asian Open in Kuwait. Then there was a bronze at the 2024 Commonwealth Championships and a title at the African Open in Casablanca last year.

"Training under a coach

like Yashpal Solanki helped her a lot. Sometimes sub-junior or junior judokas don't make the transition to youth and senior levels very well, but Asmita did. Whenever she wins a medal at the national or international level, she sends us a picture to show it to young judokas at the Tripura Sports School. It will be the same this time too," Saha told this paper.

In December, when the youngster lost her father, it was a tough time for her. Deb remembers how her coaches at the Tripura Sports School made sure that she made a quick return to the sport.

"She was dejected after her father's death. It took a lot of time for us coaches to ensure that she got over her grief. She is like a daughter for each one of us and I am sure she would be looking to the heavens to show the medal to her father today," says Deb.

Seema's second innings: A mother's journey to CWG glory

After giving birth, 27-year-old struggled to even release the discus; 3 years later, she is on CWG podium

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, July 31

SEEMA KALIRAMANA hurled the discus 58.65m on a cold Glasgow night to win the first major medal of her career, a bronze at the 2026 Commonwealth Games (CWG). On the field, she is India's fourth athletics medallist, but outside it, Seema plays multiple roles.

She is a mother to three-year-old Rudra and is pursuing her PhD in physical education. "This bronze medal means a lot because it reminds me that every challenge is worth fighting through. The last few years have taught me patience, and moments like these make all the hard work worthwhile," Seema said from Glasgow.

While her release of the discus was smooth during her bronze medal-winning throw, the journey to that moment was anything but.

A promising junior discus thrower, Seema's career hit a roadblock at the senior level when a serious knee injury coincided with the COVID-19 pandemic.

Seema, who was married to Ravinder by that time, planned to have a baby, marking the end of her athletics career. However, the athlete inside her couldn't rest. The pursuit of elite medals, though, came at a cost. In 2023, just 11 months after giving birth to Rudra, she



Seema Kaliramana threw the discus to a distance of 58.65m to win the bronze medal. AP
Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

“Our son won't travel with us to CWG or Asian Games, but that's the sacrifice I have to make for a medal at the world level.”

SEEMA KALIRAMANA, AFTER WINNING BRONZE MEDAL

stepped back into the throwing pit at Bhim Stadium in Bhiwani. It was far from the comeback she had imagined. For the first few days, she was unable to even release the discus.

It took her almost two years to return to active competition, with her husband Ravinder, a former national-level thrower himself, helping her regain

confidence through a carefully planned training regime.

"It was very tough getting back to the field as I was unable to even release the discus properly. But I think the motivation and mentoring of my husband (Ravinder) helped me get back to my normal strength and then improve further," Seema had told *The Indian Express* before leaving for Glasgow.

"My first competition after motherhood was in 2024, where I threw 57.19m to win the Inter State National Championships," Seema, who is backed by IIS, said.

"I could see the potential in her. Despite her knee injury, the technique was fine. So, the next day of marriage I asked her if she is interested and as she said yes, our journey started," said Ravinder. Since then, Seema

has been on a constant rise, winning multiple national titles and improving her personal best three times. Her consistent performances earned her places in both India's Commonwealth Games and Asian Games squads. Bronze in Glasgow was the reward.

Balancing act

For the husband-wife duo of Seema and Ravinder, balancing elite sport with parenthood has required a support system.

"Our son won't travel with us to CWG or Asian Games, but that's the sacrifice I have to make for a medal at the World level," she said.

"In the start, we struggled to find the balance, but eventually we have figured it out now. We have hardly spent time with our son Rudra as he spends

time with his grandparents from both sides. Our families have been extremely supportive in our quest for sporting excellence," Ravinder chimed in.

Seema, who is pursuing a PhD from the Department of Physical Education at Chaudhary Bansi Lal University (CBLU), Bhiwani, treats her academic work as a useful distraction. "The best part is I'm doing a PhD in physical education. It comes as a healthy distraction. I get to know about the biomechanics of the body. That helps a lot, and as I learn more, the results come more quickly," Seema explained.

More than the medal, Seema hoped her journey could break the myth that motherhood ends a sporting career.

"A lot of female athletes have reached out to me after my consistent performances. Some of them even joke that marriage is important, as your performance came after that only," laughed Seema.

"I think it is important that people realise that motherhood is just a phase. Athletes can return to sport easily after having a baby with the right support system."

Bronze in Glasgow may be Seema's first major international medal, but for the discus thrower, the bigger victory is personal - proving that motherhood and elite sport can co-exist.

Relay team qualifies

Led by national record holder Vishal TK, the Indian mixed 4x400m relay team booked a spot in the final finishing seventh overall in the round one heat races.

They clocked 3:20.98 to take the fourth spot in Heat 2 to sneak into the final.

Lovepreet misses out on gold by barest of margins — one kilo



Lovepreet Singh broke the Commonwealth Games snatch record before losing out on gold to New Zealand's David Andrew Liti. PTI

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, July 31

ONE KILOGRAM.

That was the margin by which Lovepreet Singh lost out on the gold medal in the men's 110kg+ weightlifting competition at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow on Thursday. Lovepreet had broken the CWG record in snatch with a lift of 176kg and was leading second-placed New Zealander David Andrew Liti by 10 kg before the contest moved into clean and jerk. The Indian lifted 212kg in his second attempt, taking his total to 388kg, before failing at 217kg.

Liti first lifted 207kg in clean and jerk to get his total to 373kg before the New Zealander listed his second lift at 223 kg. He managed to hoist the bar over his head to snatch the gold from the Indian, who had seemed the odds-on favourite for the yellow metal, by a solitary kilo.

As a result, Lovepreet, a Petty Officer with the Indian Navy, could only improve upon his bronze medal from the 2022 Birmingham Games to a silver.

"I missed out on the gold. Naturally, it hurts. I'll do better in the upcoming competitions, like the Asian Games," Lovepreet, who hails from Bal Sikan-dar village near Amritsar in Punjab, told the media in the mixed zone post the event.

Tailor's son

His father Kirpal Singh runs a small tailoring shop in the village. Lovepreet was inspired by national-level weightlifter Heera Singh, who also hailed from there. "When Lovepreet was young, he would wake up daily at 3am and accompany my brother Satpal Singh to get vegetables from the *sabji mandi* and sell in the village before going to school," Kirpal told *The Indian Express*.

Lovepreet took his first steps in the sport in the village — where he would train with other kids in the evening, a routine that lasted five years — before training at DAV School, Amritsar. A bronze at the Asian Youth Championships and the Junior Commonwealth title in Tashkent in the 105kg category in 2017 were followed by his entry into the national camp.

Lovepreet won the silver at the Commonwealth Championships in 2021 followed by a bronze in Birmingham in the 109kg category. "When Lovepreet

● India's weightlifting medals

Women		
Mirabai Chanu	48 kg	Gold
Gyaneshwari Yadav	53 kg	Silver
Harjinder Kaur	69 kg	Silver
Bindiyanani Devi	58 kg	Silver
Men		
Rishikanta	60 kg	Silver
Ajaya Babu	79 kg	Silver
Lovepreet Singh	+110 kg	Silver
Raja Muthupandi	65 kg	Silver

“When Lovepreet was young, he would wake up daily at 3am and accompany my brother Satpal Singh to get vegetables from the *sabji mandi* and then sell in the village before going to school.”

KIRPAL SINGH
LOVEPREET'S FATHER

reet expressed his desire to become a weightlifter, I did not hesitate for a second to allow him. Even though I used to earn 10,000 to 15,000 per month, I always tried my best to provide the best for him. He would cycle to his school in Amritsar and would then go to his training," Kirpal had said in 2022.

The job with the Navy has helped his sporting career greatly and also got a better life for his family.

"His stipend would take care of his training. Prior to that, I would have to devote extra hours at my tailoring shop to earn some extra money to support him. Now, he has built us a new home and helped me open a new shop," the proud father said.

On Thursday, he set a CWG record in snatch and looked set to bring another gold to the Indian Kitty when Sanele Mao of Samoa, who had listed 175kg in snatch, failed in all his three attempts.

His clean and jerk lift of 212kg propelled him to the gold medal position before Liti came up with a spirited performance to upstage him.

COMMONWEALTH GAMES

Jadumani, a Neymar fan with southpaw elegance, enters final

When he switched from football to boxing, footwork and flair were merely ported to the next sport

Pritish Raj
New Delhi, July 31

JADUMANI SINGH Mandengbam, India's social media sensation with reels of his immaculate footwork and speed going viral. His bout against Sumama Rehman of Pakistan was widely shared after he started teasing his opponent in the last round and won it one-sided.

On Friday, Jadumani defeated PP Haoseb of Namibia in the 55 kg to enter the final of the Commonwealth Games. Jadumani has made it a habit to enthrall the viewers with his speed, movement and a bit of showboating. "A lot of my movements in the ring are to keep myself locked in. More than showing off to the opponents, it is about keeping myself active throughout the bout," Jadumani had told *The Indian Express*.

To understand the flair and showboating in the ring, one has to travel to the Iroisemba village in Imphal of Manipur.

Growing up in the Langol hills, the 22-year-old had a football crazy family and naturally started dribbling the ball. Playing as a winger, Jadumani idolized Brazilian superstar Neymar. Years of following the eccentric Brazilian resulted in Jadumani inculcating some of the flair and showboating in his own bobbing and weaving persona including his celebrations. "I grew up idol-



Jadumani Singh won by a unanimous 5-0 decision to reach the final of the 55kg weight class. PTI

izing Neymar. I support Brazil during World Cups and used to try the skills Neymar would do during my football matches," said Jadumani.

When he was selected for the Boxing World Cup at Foz Do Iguacu in Brazil, his happiness knew no bounds. "Neymar was far away from that city in Brazil I went to. I was just happy to be in Brazil," said Jadumani. However, as unscripted and poetic as it would be, Jadumani's first international medal came in Brazil when he won the bronze medal in the 50 kg category.

Switching sport

Boxing wasn't his first choice though. Football was. His uncle Milan suggested he switch sports to an individual event because that's where the glory is. "I wanted to continue with football as I was playing at

district level but I switched after my uncle insisted," said Jadumani. While he moved sports, the habits, footwork, and showboating stayed with him.

Starting his boxing training under coach Chinglen, the elegant boxer focused on his body movements which were already rhythmic after his days spent playing as a crisscrossing winger for his district team.

"When I started as a boxer, I used to move a lot. I would move while punching. I would move my hands and legs during bouts and punch aggressively," said Jadumani. Soon, he would find that moving a lot can result in getting tired or counter-punched at the elite level. "I got my biggest lesson when I started playing at the elite level. There, you don't always have to show your movements. Now, I don't punch aggressively. I

show my movement when it's needed," he said.

As he rose through the ranks in his boxing career, Jadumani found a new hero this time, Gervonta Davis, the American professional fighter. Known for his high ring IQ and footwork, Davis is also a southpaw like Jadumani. "I watched a lot of videos of Davis. The best thing about him is that he showboats through his punches in the game. I started learning his movements and then implemented them in my game," said the armyman.

The learnings are visible as Jadumani has developed a world class slip where his head movements are not easy to predict for the opponents.

For the whole of 2025, the Manipuri built his game in the 50 kg category but amateur categories started from 55 kg at all

the major events. In 2026, Jadumani made the big decision to jump five kgs and fight in 55 kg.

Standing at 162 cm, Jadumani faces taller opponents. But what he might not have in height, he makes up with a lion heart and grit along with his punching skills. "I know height is a big factor but it doesn't matter. The one who punches more would win. I have faced taller opponents my whole life but it has never mattered. I only lose if I play badly, not because of my height," said Jadumani.

At the Commonwealth Games he has taken down home favourite Aaron Cullen, Pakistan's Sumama Rehman, Zambia's Mwengo Mwale, and Haoseb - all taller than him and with a reach advantage. However, Jadumani has developed a game where this helps him. "My height gives me direct access to the body blows which I keep landing and when the guard of the opponent goes down, I go for the head shot," he explains.

Hari Beniwal, head coach of SSCB boxing team, said that fearlessness makes the ASI boxer stand out. "I know Jadumani might not have the height for this category but he makes it up with punches and speed."

He added, "Another quality that made him best in India is fearlessness. He can take punches and risks which make him different."

When asked if he is afraid that he can get punched while showboating, Jadumani said, "I am not afraid of punches. If you notice, I showboat when I am confident and I know I can deliver. If I am losing, there is no point in showboating."

And with the final still against Jye Dixon of Australia to come, Jadumani has already ensured one thing—win or lose, he will not go unnoticed.

In semis, Arundhati hands Welsh icon Eccles fiery farewell



Arundhati Choudhary beat defending champ Rosie Eccles. AP

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, July 31

THE GLASGOW crowd booed as Arundhati Choudhary walked out onto the ring at the SEC centre.

At a boxing programme where Indians have enjoyed the lack of competition that they face even at the usual Commonwealth level, this was going to be a tough one. Standing in front of India's 70kg entrant was the winner of the previous edition.

Rosie Eccles walked out bearing the Welsh flag at the beginning of the Commonwealth Games. Having announced her retirement before the tournament, she had plans to repeat her gold from Birmingham and walk off into the sunset. Evidently the Glasgow crowd that had come to watch the semi-final bouts wanted the same.

Choudhary brushed aside their plans with a smile. Right from the first bell, Eccles came out swinging. In a classic southpaw vs orthodox battle, the 30-year-old came forward with intent and a lack of worry about Choudhary's power. But the Indian had her bread-and-butter combination locked in.

Starting with a right cross to the body that opened up the face for the left straight - that

was Choudhary's weapon of choice. She had to land it repeatedly while moving back to avoid the intense pressure provided by Eccles. The Welsh boxer was landing her shots, but Choudhary's work was cleaner and landed her a unanimous first round.

With the bout slipping from her hands, Eccles dialled up the intensity in the second round. Her attempts at landing punches grew wilder and took the fight from a controlled position which the Indian preferred, onto a situation where both boxers had to open up and let their hands go. At the end of the frenetic second round, Choudhary was once again awarded a unanimous verdict.

In the third round, the Rajasthan boxer, knowing that victory was largely hers, started by moving sideways along the ring, attempting to avoid her opponent. But Eccles was not going to accept defeat easily.

She succeeded in making the last round into a scrap, forcing Choudhary to hang on and survive. Every judge gave the final round of Eccles' amateur career to her. But the deficit of the first two rounds was too much to come back from. Choudhary won the semis 4-0 and reached her first ever final of a multi-sport event.

Players stunned as Jamshedpur FC quits ISL

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, July 31

WHEN JAMSHEDPUR FC's players were summoned for a team meeting on Friday evening, they expected a tactical discussion ahead of their Durand Cup clash against SC Delhi. Instead, they were told the club would no longer be part of the Indian Super League.

Barely an hour later, the Tata Group-owned club made it official. On their social media channels, Jamshedpur FC posted the statement: "Jamshedpur Football Club would like to confirm that it will not be participating in ISL from the 2026-27 season onwards. JFSPL remains committed, in other capacities, to the continued growth and development of football in India. We will continue in our endeavour to promote and develop the game of football, including at the grassroots level. We will continue to identify and develop young football talent across India to create a strong pathway for young players from grassroots to national and international football."

The announcement stunned a dressing room that had been preparing for the Durand Cup and left players grappling with uncertainty over their future.

"I am devastated. None of us saw it coming," Pronay Halder, captain of the 12-year-old club, told *The Indian Express*. "We were informed about it an hour before the statement was released. We were completely focused on the Durand Cup, and we are playing well too."

It's understood that the decision to withdraw from the competition comes after the club failed to pay the first instalment of the ISL participation fee (Rs 55 lakh), the extended deadline for which was Friday. This newspaper has also been informed that the grassroots project will not be affected by the decision to withdraw from the ISL.

WINGS TO THE DREAMS OF NORTH ANDHRA

GRAND INAUGURATION OF

VIZAG

ALLURI SITARAMA RAJU INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT

GAR AERO

by

SHRI NARENDRA MODI

Hon'ble Prime Minister

Saturday, August 1, 2026

Salient Features

- Phase-1 Capacity of **6 Million** Passengers Per Annum; Scalable to **40 Million** Passengers
- 3,800 m** Code 4E Runway
- 25,000 MT** Annual Cargo Capacity; Scalable to **2,81,000 MT**
- DigiYatra Enabled**; Smart & Contactless Passenger Experience

- 5 MW** Solar Power; **100%** Water Recycling Infrastructure
- Aviation Ecosystem to generate **1.8 Lakh Direct & Indirect Jobs**
- Skill Development Centre to **Empower 1,000 Youth** Annually

Watch Live Telecast on Doordarshan

HIA/75/PREM ASSOCIATES